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In influential union, a lack of political unity

Teamsters affiliate in N.H. backs Democrat for Senate; its leader donates to GOP's Brown

By Sam Brodey
GLOBE STAFF

One of the country's most politically influential labor unions — and perhaps the one most reshaped by the Trump era — appears to be at odds with itself over New Hampshire's closely watched US Senate race.

The local affiliate of the International Brotherhood of Teamsters in New Hampshire has endorsed Representative Chris

Pappas, the leading Democratic candidate, calling him a staunch ally of workers in the state.

But the national Teamsters' general president, Boston-area native Sean O'Brien, personally donated \$1,000 to the campaign of former Massachusetts senator Scott Brown, who's running in the Republican primary in the Granite State. Brown is the only active candidate for federal office anywhere in the country



Sean O'Brien of the Teamsters gave \$1,000 to Scott Brown's Senate campaign.

to whom O'Brien has personally donated in this election cycle.

According to federal campaign finance records, that check came in February, days after Brown appeared on O'Brien's podcast, where the union boss praised Brown as an ally of workers and gave him free rein to slam Pappas's record.

Near the end of their interview, O'Brien told Brown, "Hopefully, people like you can go down there with some common sense and solutions to problems, or work to find solutions to prob-

TEAMSTERS, Page A7

Trump overhauls immigrant system

New judges lack experience in field as push to deport becomes dominant goal

By Giulia McDonnell Nieto del Rio
GLOBE STAFF

The four newest judges appointed by the Trump administration to serve in Massachusetts immigration courts have something in common: They have little experience in immigration law.

One recently worked as a lawyer for the military in Ohio; another for the Internal Revenue Service in Florida. A third served as an assistant district attorney in Bristol County; the last as an assistant attorney general for the Massachusetts attorney general's gaming enforcement division.

Yet they will wield immense influence over the lives of immigrants here and across New England, in many cases deciding whether to allow someone to stay in the United States or to issue deportation orders against them.

The appointees, announced last month, are part of the Trump administration's overhaul of immigration courts in Massachusetts and across the country, a shake-up that appears to be aimed at speeding up case decisions — and forcing more immigrants to leave the country.

Muzaffar Chishti, a lawyer and senior fellow with the nonpartisan Migration Policy Institute, said that he believes the administration is hoping

JUDGES, Page A6



SUZANNE KREITER/GLOBE STAFF

Christopher Edwards, a worker with the nonprofit Tree Boston, watered juvenile trees in Harambee Park in Dorchester.

CLIMATE CONTROL: CITY STRUGGLES TO ADD SHADE

Residential chainsaws offset Boston's bid to plant trees, lower temperatures

By Kate Selig
GLOBE STAFF
and Ilana Zahavy
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

As climate change pushes summer temperatures ever higher, trees are some of the best cooling agents cities have to help overheated neighborhoods. They provide shade and pull heat from the air, lowering urban temperatures by as much as 10 degrees.

Boston has been working hard in recent years to expand its urban forests, including launching a forestry division and prioritizing plantings in the neighborhoods that need them most. But if the city wants to grow more trees, it has to solve a thorny problem: how to stop residents from cutting them down.

SHADE, Page A7

Boston's canopy gains from public tree plantings were almost entirely offset by removals on private land

City-managed land, like rights-of-way and open space, gained tree cover between 2019 and 2024, but residential land lost some of its canopy.

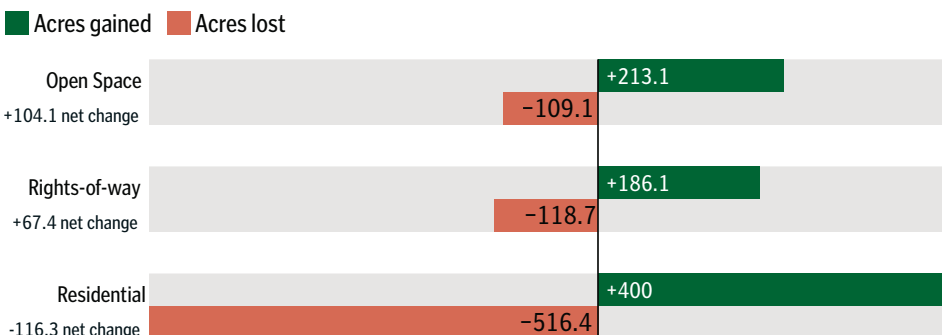


Chart: Ilana Zahavy for The Boston Globe • Source: Boston Parks and Recreation

Offering care to children of vaccine skeptics

Some doctors are rejecting such patients; others seek to find common ground

By Eric Boodman
STAT

LAKEVILLE — She didn't have any trouble with her current pediatricians in Fall River. They were kind. They were great with her newborn daughter. They had helpful answers to most of her new-mom questions.

"My only issue was the vaccines. They push 'em," she said, rocking her 6-week-old's carrier. "They're like, 'Well, she needs them all by 2 or we can't keep her as a patient.' And I'm like, 'OK, but at the same time, like, why?' And they're like, 'It's our protocol!'"

That wasn't a good enough answer for her, and that was why she was here at Middleboro Pediatrics at 4:45 p.m., meeting a new doctor named Aaron Bornstein. They were auditioning each other. She was testing his willingness to take her concerns seriously, without judgment. He, meanwhile, was probing just how wary of his medical advice she might be if her daughter became his patient.

"My argument is —" but then her baby began to fuss, and she reached out to comfort her. "My argu-

PEDIATRICIANS, Page A10

JOE MORGAN 1930-2026

Part manager, part magician, all Walpole

After decades in minor leagues, he crafted a season of joy in the majors

By John Powers
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Joe Morgan, the Everyman manager whose "Morgan Magic" inspired the Red Sox to an unlikely playoff berth in 1988 and enchanted the club's followers, died Saturday at 95, the team announced. No cause of death was released.

"Joe Morgan holds a special place in Red Sox history," said John Henry, Red Sox and Boston Globe principal owner, in a statement. "When he took over in 1988, he changed the course of a season and created

MORGAN, Page C6



TOM HERDE/GLOBE STAFF/1991

Mr. Morgan, overseer of "Morgan Magic" in 1988, was the first Red Sox manager with local roots since the early 1930s.

►The Red Sox win again, sweeping the Baltimore Orioles. C1.

A far-right German party dominated a state election but fell short of a majority to govern. A3.

Any retrial of Lindsay Clancy would encounter the difficult — but surmountable — task of seating an unbiased jury, experts say. B1.

Fire engulfed a cargo plane after it overran a runway in Miami, killing at least five people. A6.

This week marks some big-time changes for many Fidelity Investments employees as they are required to return to the office full time and the firm opens its remarkable headquarters in the Seaport. D1.

For breaking news, updated stories, and more, visit our website:

BostonGlobe.com



That'll work

Labor Day: Sunny, warm. High 77-82, low 61-66.

Tuesday: Warm, some clouds. High 78-83, low 62-67.

Sunrise: 6:16. Sunset: 7:08.

Weather and comics, D4-5.

Obituaries, C9.

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The Nation

Another twist in mail-in voting

Trump renews restriction push before midterms

By Abbie VanSickle
NEW YORK TIMES

WASHINGTON — The Trump administration asked the Supreme Court yet again on Sunday to allow its plans to restrict mail-in voting before the midterms, setting up what will likely be the final legal showdown for the president's push to impose limits on mail voting in the weeks before the midterm election.

In an emergency application, lawyers for the administration urged the justices to clear the way for new US Postal Service rules to go into effect, changing the way the agency handles mail-in ballots.

Each day that passes makes it less likely that the Trump administration can clear the legal and logistical hurdles it would need to put the new rules in place by the midterms.

Justice Ketanji Brown Jackson, who handles emergency applications from the region of the country where the case originated, set a schedule that signaled the court would handle it on a swift, but not immediate, timeline.

Jackson called for responses from the groups challenging the Trump administration rules by 4 p.m. Wednesday. She made no mention of the administration's request that the justices allow the Postal Service rules to go into effect while they consider the case. That means that, at least for now, the administration is blocked from putting its plan into action.

Solicitor General D. John Sauer urged the justices to move swiftly to allow the Postal Service to proceed with its plans, asserting that the new rule “does



PHILIP CHEUNG/NEW YORK TIMES

A processing center in California. It's unclear how quickly the justices will announce a ruling.

not seize control of states' administration of elections — it simply imposes reasonable preparation requirements for certain election-related mail.”

The emergency request marks the latest turn in a legal fight over mail-in voting, even as states begin distributing mail-in ballots to voters. The upshot has become clear in recent days: It will be the Supreme Court that has the final say on President Trump's plans to restrict mail voting in the midterms.

It's unclear how fast the justices will move and announce a ruling. Unlike in the court's routine cases, which unfold over months with full briefing and argument, emergency requests like the one from the Trump administration are typically decided on a short timeline without full briefing or argument.

Sophia Lin Lakin, director of the American Civil Liberties Union's Voting Rights Project, which represents voting rights groups challenging the plan,

called the Postal Service rule “unconstitutional.”

“It is unlawful,” she said in a statement Sunday. “And with fewer than 60 days to go before the November election, there is not a shred of evidence that states could comply with it without disenfranchising voters who rely on mail ballots.”

This latest request came after a federal judge in Boston on Friday announced she was freezing the Postal Service plan indefinitely, while litigation proceeds through the lower courts.

The Trump administration had already filed an emergency request to the justices challenging a shorter-term pause she had imposed on the plan. But the trial court judge acted to extend her freeze before the justices ruled, necessitating a new request from the administration for Supreme Court action.

The trial court judge, Indira Talwani, wrote that the legal challenge to the Postal Service plan by Democratic-led states

and voter rights organizations was likely to succeed. The groups had argued the plan violated the Constitution's separation of powers, which gives states and Congress responsibility over elections, not the executive.

Talwani found that lawyers for the Trump administration sought to “avoid” the separation of powers issue by “denying that the final rule is an election rule.” She added: “This denial rings hollow.”

She also dismissed arguments by the Trump administration that the Postal Service was acting under the authority of Congress, writing that “throughout its body of election legislation, Congress has never delegated its Elections Clause power to the USPS.”

She added that the Postal Service rule “clashes with Congress' statutory scheme, and is unconstitutional where it intrudes not only on Congress's elections clause powers but also that power left to the states.”

Flurry of motions confuses voters

Officials scramble amid changes to rules, court cases

By Anna Griffin, Rebecca Fairley Raney, Kendal Asbury, and David Iversen
NEW YORK TIMES

President Trump's legal and rhetorical assault on voting by mail — and the flurry of contradictory court decisions around it — has left voters confused and local officials scrambling just eight weeks before November's critical midterm elections.

The contortions have county registrars dusting off Election Day contingency plans developed for natural disasters like floods and wildfires. They have struggled to make it through planning meetings before the latest version of the rules change, and many are encouraging voters to avoid the US Postal Service all together.

Among voters, confusion abounds.

“I don't trust mail-in or in-person, to be honest with you,” said Lori Woo, a 53-year-old teacher from Wildomar, Calif. She has voted both in person and by mail and now wonders whether any of her votes were counted.

Arizona officials have been encouraging voters like Antonio Bergier, an 83-year-old retired geologist, to drop off ballots in person. But Bergier said he didn't know whether his hometown, Patagonia, or his county, Santa Cruz, had ballot drop boxes — nor would he use them anyway.

Mail, he said, is “the only way they're getting my vote this year.”

Twenty states are set to mail ballots to voters by Sept. 19,

starting with North Carolina, which began sending out absentee ballots Friday.

“We plan to proceed as planned,” Sam Hayes, the director of North Carolina's elections board, said at a news conference Thursday.

But even election officials were reluctant to issue reassuring encomiums.

“I wish that I could tell my constituents to not worry, and I can't,” said Gabriella Cázares-Kelly, who oversees elections in Pima County, Ariz., where 85 percent of ballots are delivered early or by mail.

In many places with mail-in voting, the bulk of ballots aren't scheduled to go out for another month. But the response has already begun.

In Los Angeles County, one of the largest voting districts in the nation, elections officers have responded to the uncertainty with ballot distribution and collection plans that were deployed after the devastating Eaton and Palisades wildfires of 2025. Ideas include expanding in-person options like pop-up voting sites, places where people could request and fill out ballots.

“If this is a problem, let's make it an administrative problem, not a voter problem,” said Dean Logan, the LA County registrar. “We do not want voters to be deterred from voting.”

In Arizona, Cázares-Kelly described a flood of calls from worried voters. During a briefing this week with Arizona's secretary of state, attorney general, and 15 county recorders about the proposed Postal Service mail-ballot rule, news broke of an emergency filing from the Trump administration trying to reinstate parts of the rule a court had blocked.

DAILY BRIEFING



JOE RAEDLE/GETTY IMAGES

TRAGEDY IN MIAMI — An Amazon cargo plane crashed after overrunning the runway at Miami International Airport Sunday. The plane barreled into vehicles, igniting a blaze that killed at least five people. **A6.**

Hawaii prepares as Lowell passes by

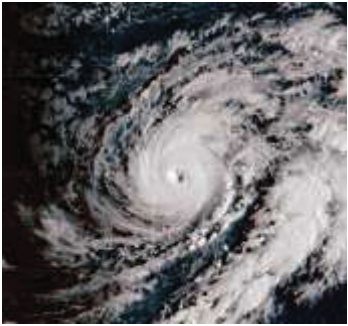
LIHUE, Hawaii — Officials in Hawaii urged residents and visitors to prepare for heavy rains, flooding, and possibly mudslides as Hurricane Lowell, a major Category 3 storm, prompted the National Hurricane Center to issue a tropical storm warning for two islands on Sunday.

The Miami-based center issued the warning for Kauai and Niihau as Lowell was forecast to pass the islands to the west late Monday and Tuesday while traveling north. Forecasters said rainfall totals of 6-10 inches, with maximum totals of 14 inches, were possible.

Hawaii's Big Island is expected to see 4-8 inches of rain, with some areas getting as much as 12 inches.

Lowell had maximum sustained winds of 120 miles per hour and was located about 545 miles south-southwest of Lihue, or about 565 miles southwest of Honolulu. It was moving north at 6 miles per hour, the hurricane center said.

Hurricane-force winds extended outward up to 50 miles from the center, and tropical storm-force winds extended out-



This image released by NOAA shows Hurricane Lowell approaching Hawaii Sunday.

ward up to 175 miles, the center said.

The rainfall could produce significant flash flooding and mudslides, the center said. A combination of storm surge and tides will likely cause normally dry areas near the coast to be flooded by rising waters of up to 3 feet on Kauai.

The Kauai Emergency Management Agency urged residents to fill gas tanks, charge devices, refill prescriptions, and have enough water and food ahead of the storm. It also said residents should be prepared to stay home for several days.

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Assailant lunged at Democratic candidate for Ohio governor, campaign says

WASHINGTON — An armed assailant lunged at the Democratic candidate for Ohio governor, Amy Acton, on Sunday during a campaign stop at the Canfield Fair, injuring several people, campaign officials said.

The suspect knocked volunteers to the ground and was arrested with “multiple weapons,”

Mahoning County Democratic Party chairman Chris Anderson said in a statement.

Acton was not injured, but campaign officials said multiple people were hurt.

She is “grateful for the swift and decisive action of law enforcement and are praying for the recovery of those injured. This kind of violence has no

place in Ohio. Dr. Acton will always stand up to the chaos, hate and vitriol that pits us against one another,” said Addie Bullock, communications director for the campaign.

Acton is facing Republican Vivek Ramaswamy, who has parlayed his national name recognition, tech industry connections, and alliance with Presi-

dent Trump into a record fund-raising haul that he is tapping for advertising spots aimed at the November election. He is using campaign rallies and advertising to criticize Acton, the state's former public health director.

Ramaswamy called the incident Sunday unacceptable.

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Memphis gambling raid became sweeping immigration operation

MEMPHIS, Tenn. — Last week, a crush of agents raided El Corralón, a cantina tucked in the middle of Berclair, a heavily Hispanic neighborhood in Memphis, Tenn., searching for owner Marco Sabillon-Urbina, an immigrant from Honduras, but detaining anyone who was in the country illegally.

In the end, the operation tar-

getting illegal gambling and drugs spiraled into one of Tennessee's largest sweeps of immigrants without legal status this year, as Immigration and Customs Enforcement escalates its operations across the country. More than 120 people were detained, inflaming tensions in Memphis, where many residents were already on edge over

a separate federal anticrime task force that, among other things, has also targeted immigrants.

Tennessee and other Republican-led states have deepened coordination with the Trump administration and immigration authorities. In May, the Tennessee Bureau of Investigation asked ICE for help identifying a man it suspected was in-

volved in criminal activity at El Corralón, court records show.

The man, Sabillon-Urbina, first arrived in the United States in 1994 and received Temporary Protected Status in 1999; that status lapsed in January 2020 after he failed to renew the paperwork, federal law enforcement said in court records.

NEW YORK TIMES

US military sinks boats near Ecuador

WASHINGTON — US forces operating near Ecuador on Saturday intercepted and destroyed several commercial vessels believed to be used for refueling boats smuggling drugs to the United States.

It was the fourth interdiction of vessels used as floating refueling platforms in the eastern Pacific, according to a US official, who said no one on either side was hurt or killed.

The mission was carried out as part of US Southern Command's efforts to hinder narcotics smugglers in the Pacific and Atlantic Oceans, a campaign that began just over a year ago.

A video posted to social media by the command, which directs military operations in Central and South America, shows a US military vessel, an 11-meter rigid-hull inflatable boat, ap-

proaching what appears to be a larger civilian craft with fuel jugs lining a raised open deck. A Marine Corps helicopter hovered off the vessel's starboard side.

The video shows the inflatable boat moving out of the frame, then shows the larger vessel's bow erupting in an explosion.

People aboard the refueling vessel were transferred to the custody of Ecuadorian government officials, who were nearby as part of the operation, said the official, who spoke on the condition of anonymity because he was not authorized to speak publicly about the mission.

The operation was supported by sailors and Marines aboard the amphibious ship USS San Antonio, the official said.

NEW YORK TIMES

The World

Iran says it plans ‘exclusion zone’ near Strait

Experts warn of escalation after missile launches

By **Samy Magdy, Julia Frankel, and Cara Anna**
ASSOCIATED PRESS

CAIRO — The new head of Iran’s Supreme National Security Council on Sunday said Tehran plans to announce an “exclusion zone” outside the Strait of Hormuz aimed at vessels it believes are attempting to transit the waterway.

Mohsen Rezaei’s comments to Iran’s state broadcaster came with few details, a day after the US struck three Iranian oil tankers in response to Tehran launching ballistic missiles at US warships. Experts called the launches a dangerous escalation after Iran’s previous attacks at sea targeted commercial shipping.

The new zone should be announced in the coming days and

weeks and “will begin from the line of the US naval blockade, extend toward the Strait of Hormuz, and from this side continue into the Persian Gulf,” Rezaei said. “Any ship that enters this area with the intention of passing through the Strait of Hormuz and is identified will be placed on our sanctions list.”

It is not clear where Iran defines the location of the weekslong US blockade, which is aimed at Iranian ports and keeping Tehran from shipping out its oil. The US military has said more than 20 warships support the blockade, which as of Sunday had redirected 92 commercial ships and disabled three.

The United States has been introducing new measures to increase the economic pain on Iran after negotiations collapsed, and no end to the intermittent fighting appears in sight. Meanwhile, Iran continues to attack some ships trying to transit the strait, which has become an important source of



VAHID SALEMI/ASSOCIATED PRESS

A man worked aboard a boat as another motorboat left a harbor in Bandar Abbas, Iran, on Sunday.

leverage for Tehran in the war that began Feb. 28 with US and Israeli strikes.

Iran earlier Sunday said it struck an unmanned US vessel trying to enter the Strait of Hormuz, a claim that the US military dismissed as a “total lie.”

The United States and Iran resumed attacks last week, fol-

lowing a month of relative calm, with the Strait of Hormuz and areas along Iran’s southern coast again being targeted. At least five people were killed earlier in the week during a US bombardment that returned attention to the area where a school was hit in the war’s opening strikes.

The Trump administration

appears to have adopted a dual-prong approach to the conflict, responding militarily to attacks on the strait while going after foreign financial institutions that handle Iran’s money.

But Tehran’s hard-line new senior leaders, including Rezaei, have signaled a willingness to dig in after weathering decades of sanctions. Iran has found ways over the years to circumvent sanctions, and now the US blockade of its ports, and get its oil to buyers to help ease growing economic pressures.

On the matter of the collapsed negotiations with the United States, Rezaei Sunday expressed wariness not only of the US but also of the mediators. The memorandum of understanding that the United States and Iran signed in mid-June began to fall apart within days as each side accused the other of violations.

“We had trusted our friends in Pakistan, Qatar, or Oman, thinking that since they had stepped in as mediators, one of a

mediator’s responsibilities is that if one side violates the agreement, they should stop them,” Rezaei said.

The Strait of Hormuz is crucial to global oil and natural gas shipments and was seen as an international waterway before the war began.

On Sunday, US Energy Secretary Chris Wright said that on average, 9 million barrels of oil a day are getting through the strait, which should help to relieve pressure on energy prices. His estimate appeared to exceed average flows over the past 28 days through the strait, according to TankerTrackers.com and other sources.

Wright told CNN that with oil also flowing through pipelines in the region, “we’re probably two-thirds or more of pre-conflict flows.”

But those flows depend on the presence of the US Navy to help escort tankers and provide some protection against possible Iranian attack.

DAILY BRIEFING



PEDRO PARDO/AFP VIA GETTY IMAGES

DRY LAND — Flash flood survivors rested inside a relief shelter at Devighat in Nepal’s Nuwakot district Sunday. The tsunami-like wall of water, ice, and debris unleashed by a massive glacial and rock collapse along the Nepal-China border killed at least 1,362 people and has left more than 5,500 missing across the two countries.

English museum to repatriate colonial-era human remains

BENGALURU, India — After years of negotiations, a British museum has agreed to return a colonial-era collection of human remains to the Indigenous Naga people of the Indian subcontinent, Naga representatives said Saturday.

The partial remains — a warrior’s cranium, a woman’s skull, and a young person’s jaw, and many others — have been in the Pitt Rivers Museum at the University

of Oxford for more than 100 years.

They were included in an exhibit called “Treatment of Dead Enemies,” under the label “head-hunting trophies,” displayed alongside remains from other Indigenous groups. That changed in 2020, when the museum took down 120 human remains, including those of the Naga, and put them in storage.

On Saturday, a Naga delega-

tion announced that the 39 pieces of Naga remains would return to Nagaland, a small northeastern state in India.

“We bring back the light of our ancestors that was dimmed but never extinguished,” said Ellen Konyak of the Forum for Naga Reconciliation in making the announcement. The nonprofit forum worked with the museum, which has the world’s largest collection of Naga cultural objects,

and Naga tribal groups on the repatriation effort.

Representatives of the Naga have sought the remains for years. Formal discussions with the museum began in 2020.

Most of the Naga remains in the museum were donated by J.P. Mills and J.H. Hutton, British officers who were posted in the Naga regions of British India during the early 1900s.

NEW YORK TIMES

Volcanic island in Indonesia erupts

JAKARTA — A volcano erupted in Indonesia early Sunday, prompting the cancellation of all flights at Jakarta’s Soekarno-Hatta International Airport and disrupting other domestic airports as ash drifted across western parts of the country.

The volcanic island of Anak Krakatau, located in Indonesia’s Sunda Strait between the main Java and Sumatra islands, had shown signs of activity since Friday before erupting for 30 seconds at 3:53 a.m. Sunday and for 16 seconds about three hours later, Indonesia’s Geological Agency said. Closed-circuit camera footage showed lava flares from the volcano.

No casualties were reported, and no evacuation order was issued. The nearest settlement is

more than 10 miles away, but authorities warned residents and visitors to stay at least 2 miles from the active crater.

Volcanic ash spread across parts of Jakarta and Lampung province on Sumatra’s southern tip, Indonesia’s Center for Volcanology and Geological Hazard Mitigation said.

AirNav Indonesia closed airspace around Soekarno-Hatta and Halim Perdanakusuma airports in Jakarta, as well as six other airports, because of volcanic ash.

By Sunday evening, the closure of eight airports had affected 170,000 passengers from 1,558 canceled flights, including 963 flights in Jakarta’s Soekarno-Hatta airport alone.

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Fireworks in Mexico kill at least 10

TEMASCALCINGO, Mexico — Pyrotechnic material exploded during the festival for a patron saint in a town in Mexico State, collapsing a wall, killing at least 10 people, and injuring another 64, Mexican authorities said.

The explosion occurred Saturday night next to the Nuestra Señora de la Luz church in Temascalcingo, a municipality in central Mexico with 66,000 residents. Hundreds of them were preparing to watch a fireworks display that is part of a religious festival when the blast occurred.

The municipality is about 100 miles northwest of Mexico City.

The cause of the explosion has not been determined, and

the Mexico State Attorney General’s Office has opened an investigation.

A local bishop said two priests are among the injured.

A video on social media shows the aftermath of the blast, with dozens of people walking through smoke and debris in search of survivors.

Explosions involving pyrotechnics are common in Mexico, where fireworks are frequently used in street celebrations and religious festivals.

Almost four years ago, a powerful fireworks explosion in a village in the municipality of Huejutla, in the central state of Hidalgo, left 17 people injured.

ASSOCIATED PRESS

At least 25 dead in bus crash in Cape Verde’s Fogo Island, officials say

PRAIA, Cape Verde — At least 25 people — mostly teenagers — were killed in a traffic accident in the African island nation of Cape Verde, local media and officials said Sunday.

The accident, which oc-

curred on the Campanas de Cima route, a mountainous area in Fogo Island, happened on Saturday and involved a passenger bus. Several people were also injured.

The president of Cape Verde, José Maria Pereira

Neves, called the accident “a great catastrophe” in a statement on his Facebook page.

Seven bodies were immediately buried due to their condition, local media reported, citing the island’s health authori-

ties. The cause of the accident is yet to be determined by the authorities.

The president and some other officials are expected to visit the island on Sunday, according to a local news agency.

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Far right party tops race in Germany, may share power

Strength of AfD in state election sparks concern

By **Jim Tankersley and Christopher F. Schuetze**
NEW YORK TIMES

BERLIN — The Alternative for Germany party dominated a crucial state election Sunday, according to near-final results, but fell short of the absolute majority that would have made it the first far-right party to govern part of the country since the Nazi era.

If those results hold, the AfD, as the party is known by its German initials, could still assume power in the eastern Saxony-Anhalt state in the coming weeks, depending on the outcome of negotiations among rival parties that have vowed not to support an AfD government.

Saxony-Anhalt is a relatively small state, and the heart of the AfD’s power base in eastern Germany. But the result has sent shock waves through the country’s political system, which was designed after World War II to prevent extremist parties from returning to power.

The political establishment has treated the AfD as a pariah, but the party tapped into voter frustration on a wide range of economic and social issues to win about 44 percent of the vote in the state and was set to claim 39 of the 83 seats in the parliament.

“We’ve made history, and we’re taking our country back,” Ulrich Siegmund, the party’s candidate to lead the state, told a cheering crowd Sunday evening. “It all starts here in Saxony-Anhalt.”

Exit polls suggested that many of the AfD’s gains came at the expense of the center-right Christian Democrats, the party of Chancellor Friedrich Merz that also led the incumbent government in the state. Amid record turnout, the AfD won the support of many Ger-

mans who were casting ballots for the first time, including a wide plurality of young voters.

The far-right AfD has surged to lead national polls, as centrist parties bleed support and struggle to forge the consensus needed to sideline the far-right party.

The domestic intelligence agency has designated the AfD as a “suspected extremist” group. Some of the party’s leaders have played down the Holocaust and adopted Nazi slogans. Others have strong ties to Russia. The AfD has also said that Islam is incompatible with the German Constitution and has vowed to conduct mass deportations of immigrants.

The AfD has rejected accusations of extremism as politically motivated.

The party appealed to voters in Saxony-Anhalt with promises to revitalize a sagging economy, and its supporters, especially in eastern Germany, say the AfD is their best chance to break mainstream parties’ hold on political power.

They delivered such a blow Sunday. Sudha David-Wilp, vice president of external relations at the German Marshall Fund, said the result in Saxony-Anhalt “stands as a harbinger for the inability for mainstream parties to form stable coalitions.”

They will have to build such a coalition in Saxony-Anhalt, if they hope to prevent the AfD from assuming power. The Christian Democrats, who finished a distant second, could end up leading the state if they can build a coalition with four other parties: the center-left Social Democrats and Greens, the far-left Die Linke, and the populist Sahra Wagenknecht alliance, known by its German initials BSW.

But some Christian Democrat leaders in the state have said they would not work with Die Linke, calling it extremist. BSW leaders have also said they would not support the current state leader, Sven Schulze of the Christian Democrats, or the AfD.



RONNY HARTMANN/AFP VIA GETTY IMAGES

Ulrich Siegmund, with his wife, Julia Siegmund, spoke at the AfD’s election party Sunday in Magdeburg, Germany.

Trump’s envoys arrive in Kyiv

Meeting follows talks with Putin in bid to end war

By **Cassandra Vinograd** and **Andrew E. Kramer**
NEW YORK TIMES

KYIV — President Trump’s envoys, Steve Witkoff and Jared Kushner, met with officials in Ukraine Sunday in their first trip to the country and the second stop on a diplomatic tour aimed at reviving efforts to end the war between Ukraine and Russia.

Witkoff and Kushner came straight from Moscow, where they spent several hours Saturday with Russian President Vladimir Putin. Arriving in Kyiv by train, they alighted on a platform bearing a sign that read, “PEACE EXPRESS,” and then were taken by motorcade to meet Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelensky.

The men discussed what was later said to include “new ideas,” though details were scant.

Witkoff and Kushner have traveled to Moscow several times but never before visited Kyiv, despite multiple official invitations.

“We have been waiting for Steve and Jared, Witkoff and Kushner, for a long time,” Zelensky told reporters before greeting the two with hugs on Sophia Square, where photos of fallen soldiers formed a somber backdrop.

The men met for about three hours. In the gilded halls of Mariinsky Palace, they briefly addressed journalists afterward — Witkoff said they were having a “great time” in Kyiv and called its hospitality “unsurpassed” — before entering another round of talks joined by national security advisers from Britain, France, and Germany.

Emerging later, Witkoff said, “We really feel good about” the conversations in Moscow and Kyiv. He said both Russia and Ukraine still “need to make some compromises” but “we think we have the ingredients to get to that place.”

Zelensky, seated onstage with him and Kushner, described the discussions as “positive” and “very substantial,” even as he said “it appears at the moment” that Ukraine faces another winter of war.

The meetings come at a dangerous moment of escalation in the nearly five-year conflict. Rus-



GENYA SAVILOV/AFP VIA GETTY IMAGES

Ukraine’s President Volodymyr Zelensky (third from left) met with US envoy Steve Witkoff (third from right) and Jared Kushner (fourth from right) and others Sunday.

sia and Ukraine have been waging an intensifying air war, at least in part to try to gain the upper hand in settlement talks.

That was reflected in the delicate discussions around the US envoys’ travel. The United States secured an agreement that Ukraine and Russia would suspend attacks on each other’s capitals while the men were in those cities, according to officials familiar with the diplomatic effort.

That gave Kyiv residents a much-needed respite after days of nonstop air-raid alarms — which Zelensky acknowledged Sunday in thanking the Americans for coming. Their visit, he joked, offered better protection than Patriot air defenses.

“Come more often,” he said.

Kushner called the temporary halt in strikes on Moscow and Kyiv “obviously a nice thing to have,” but said the Trump administration was focused on finding a framework for “durable peace.”

“We went through a lot of the ideas that hadn’t worked to date,” he told reporters, later adding that “there’s a lot of new ideas” being put forward. He did not provide further details.

Zelensky was similarly vague, saying that negotiators needed to analyze what were “several genuinely new ideas” before discussing them publicly.

Few were expecting a breakthrough from the envoys’ trip, which was billed as the first step

‘We have been waiting for Steve and Jared, Witkoff and Kushner, for a long time.’

VOLODYMYR ZELENSKY, *Ukrainian president*

toward reviving talks mediated by the Trump administration. Those are expected to resume late this month, days after the Russian parliamentary election and weeks before the US mid-term elections.

Trump returned to office last year pledging to end the war in Ukraine swiftly. He enlisted Witkoff and later Kushner to help with negotiations, which have unfolded in fits and starts.

By February, Witkoff and Russian and Ukrainian negotiators had whittled a 20-point peace plan to two key unresolved points: management of a Russian-occupied nuclear power plant and control of territory that Ukraine still holds in the eastern Donbas region.

Then the United States and Israel attacked Iran, and the White House’s attention shifted away from Ukraine.

On Sunday, Zelensky said the territorial issue had come up with the Americans, as had the subjects of security and economic guarantees for Ukraine after any settlement and “all the possibilities” for resuming negotiations.

He and the Americans ex-

pressed support for a return to the trilateral format for negotiations, with Kushner saying that “hopefully we’ll have progress on that very soon.”

Few in Ukraine, though, expect a speedy resolution. The Kremlin has not indicated it is ready to stop the fighting, and the Ukrainians say they expect Russian forces to try to inflict as much pain as possible during the winter in hopes of pummeling them into submission at the negotiating table.

Russian military gains have slowed in recent months. Yet one of the Kremlin’s foreign policy aides, Yuri Ushakov, told reporters that Putin, in his meeting with the Americans, emphasized that Russia’s forces were advancing and that they would achieve their goals.

Zelensky, in turn, said he made clear to the Americans Sunday that Ukraine’s position on the battlefield had strengthened.

“This gives us the opportunity,” he told reporters, “to be more confident in any format of future discussions with the American side and, of course, with the Russian side.”

Ukraine renewed arms contracts despite fraud

Dud munitions endanger efforts to counter Russia

By **Andrew E. Kramer**, **Bianca Pallaro**, and **Evelina Riabenko**
NEW YORK TIMES

KYIV — As Russian soldiers attacked trench lines in eastern Ukraine in 2024, Ukrainian artillery crews opened fire. But the rounds, instead of exploding near the advancing troops, flopped out of launch tubes or landed with quiet thumps, kicking up puffs of dust.

A Ukrainian arms factory, it turned out, had supplied the military with thousands of defective mortar rounds. A burly weapons factory boss, Leonid Shyman, would eventually be arrested and charged in one of the war’s most public examples of defense industry fraud.

But even as the officials noticed that weapons were arriving faulty, government audits obtained by The New York Times show, Ukraine’s Defense Procurement Agency continued to award Shyman’s factory new contracts.

The case reflects a persistent phenomenon of the war in Ukraine. Seven of Ukraine’s top 10 military contractors won new business despite open criminal investigations for fraud, failures to deliver on earlier deals, or the arrest of chief executives for corruption, according to the government audits obtained by the Times, court records, and Ukrainian news accounts.

Shyman, for example, had been the subject of multiple investigations by anticorruption agencies, including for embezzlement and fraud, when he won that first mortar contract. The government awarded the \$280 million deal while he was out on bail on corruption charges.

Confidential reviews by the State Audit Service and an internal Ministry of Defense auditing department reveal a military procurement system riddled with mismanagement. Warning signs go unheeded, the records show, and there are seldom consequences for overcharging or failing to deliver.

Companies won contracts without demonstrating that they could supply the weapons, or without licenses to deliver them. Auditors identified 18 companies that signed deals despite defaulting on previous agreements. Six of those companies failed to fulfill a single contract.

Contractors around the globe, including the world’s richest arms dealers as well as Ukrainian and US companies, have gotten wealthy through this system. The internal government audits showed that in 2024 alone, Ukraine lost about \$1.2 billion to fraud, waste, and mismanagement.

Those losses, which have not been made public, piled up even as President Volodymyr Zelensky appealed to allies for more weaponry and financial aid.

“The army doesn’t get what it needs and the budget shrinks from nondeliveries and overpayment,” Tamerlan Vahabov, a former adviser to Ukraine’s Defense Procurement Agency, said in an interview. “As a result, we don’t have money to order more weapons. And we don’t have the quantity of ammunition we need. And it is a recurring pattern.”

About \$126 million was lost by bypassing lower bids and overpaying for weapons. Contracts were awarded without legal justification, the auditors said.

The audits obtained by the Times cover the years 2024 and 2025. It is unclear what, if anything, the Defense Procurement Agency did in response to the audits. Because they are classified, they have never been subject to public scrutiny.

During nearly five years of combat, Ukraine’s government has stayed intact as its military fought against the odds. Soldiers resisted Russia’s larger army and reinvented the battlefield with drones and robots. The government rode out the loss of support from its largest ally, the United States, by winning financial backing in Europe.

But the same procurement process that kept Ukraine in the fight and enabled the drone revolution has become a vulnerability in itself, one that has shaken domestic politics.

Revival for Africa’s mother tongues goes beyond just roots

Some yearn to teach, others to win game show

By **Farai Mutsaka** and **Dan Ikpoyi**
ASSOCIATED PRESS

HARARE, Zimbabwe — A television game show in Nigeria’s commercial hub of Lagos has an unforgiving rule: Speak English and you lose. For a US-born millennial in the audience and a student of her parents’ mother tongue, the high-stakes setting is a perfect classroom.

Meanwhile, a 15-year-old Canadian speaks to a teacher about 8,000 miles away in Zimbabwe, learning a language her parents feared she would never speak.

“Mhoroi,” Nyashadzashe Machingura says cheerfully with a pronounced Canadian accent while greeting in Zimbabwe’s vernacular Shona.

The scenes capture a new generation of interest and entrepreneurship around African languages once pushed to the margins by decades of colonialism. Often seen as secondary to English, French, and Portuguese, they are enjoying a renaissance that is also creating business opportunities.

Africa is home to more than 1 billion people speaking roughly a third of the world’s languages, with between 1,500 and 3,000 across 54 countries, according to UNESCO.

Experts say the revival in some of them is driven partly by second- and third-generation Africans in the diaspora finding it easier to reconnect with their roots and communicate with older relatives, thanks to social media, online



SUNDAY ALAMBA/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Game show Masoyinbo, which translates to “Do not speak English,” has revitalized the Yoruba language of West Africa.

learning, and entertainment.

“There were times I definitely felt left out because my family around me were all speaking Shona. And I just couldn’t understand them,” Nyashadzashe said after a lesson covering traditional greetings, proverbs, and ancestral clan symbols. She said she had eaten the food and worn the traditional clothing but still felt left out.

But now her conversations with her grandparents in Zimbabwe are growing longer.

“Being able to connect with them on that level makes me re-

ally proud of my heritage,” she said.

Her Zimbabwe-based tutor, Shungu Chidovi, left her banking career in January to focus full time on ZimbOriginal, an online platform that teaches Shona through storytelling, book clubs, and “buddy pairing” exchanges.

Now she teaches about two dozen learners in Zimbabwe, Canada, Australia, South Africa, Ireland, and Scotland, charging \$50 a month.

The business, part of a small but growing number of online

initiatives teaching African languages, emerged almost by accident. Chidovi began writing a blog about Zimbabwean traditions in 2016. Readers began asking whether she taught Shona.

“I didn’t see it at the time that I was really writing about the Shona language,” Chidovi said.

Like many in Africa, she grew up with the understanding that to get ahead she had to embrace Western languages instead of her mother tongue. English remains the dominant

language for education, business and government affairs in the southern African nation that officially recognizes 16 mostly Indigenous languages.

“When you talk of Africa, you talk of English, French, Portuguese,” said Believe Mubonderi, a linguistics lecturer at Zimbabwe Open University.

His research notes the importance of ensuring that African languages have a place in technologies shaping how people communicate, learn, and trade.

“In most cases, African lan-

guages were sidelined. They were never exposed or modernized to be used in commerce, science, and technology,” he said. “When a language has a very low status, there’s a danger that that language eventually becomes endangered.”

In Nigeria, a game show called “Masoyinbo,” meaning “Do not speak English,” has turned Yoruba, one of the country’s most widely spoken languages, into prime-time entertainment.

Contestants, including diaspora Nigerians, are tested on Yoruba language and culture, with prizes reaching thousands of dollars.

Host Olalekan Fabilola, who started the show in 2024, sees its popularity as part of a wider shift.

“If ‘Masoyinbo’ had started like 10 years ago, it wouldn’t have been what it is now,” he said. “But we are in the age of cultural resurgence. People want to go back to their roots. Everyone wants to know why, where they are from, and so it’s timely.”

Tomi Adeshokan, a New Jersey resident who is learning to perfect her Yoruba with Fabilola as a tutor, was part of the audience during a recent recording of the show. She said she lost daily exposure to Yoruba after moving out of her father’s home before the pandemic. During the pandemic, she joined Clubhouse just to hear the language and later began taking classes. Now she was back visiting family.

“It’s very important for us to immerse ourselves in our culture and not to fully identify with other cultures, like the American, the Western culture,” Adeshokan said.

Where’s the beef? Not on this farm

Meat allergy gives rise to ostrich as an alternative

By Dylan Lovan
ASSOCIATED PRESS

DANVILLE, Ky. — When a friend approached Brent Williams four years ago with a business proposition to start an ostrich farm, he was more than intrigued — he had a personal motivation as someone who developed a life-threatening allergy to red meat, triggered by tick bites.

The problem, known as alpha-gal syndrome, was first linked to a particular species of ticks about 15 years ago. But cases are on the rise as more people report symptoms such as hives, diarrhea, and itchiness after eating as little as a mouthful of red meat.

And so is ostrich meat. The flightless bird’s meat, red in color and high in iron, has a look and taste similar to beef.

“The people that have alpha-gal that I talked to that have tried an ostrich burger, most of them are almost in tears,” said Williams, a nutritionist and partner at Alpha Roost Farms in Danville, Ky. They say, “You just don’t know how bad I missed this.”

The farm is looking to nearly double its herd by next year. It recently built a new barn for hatchlings of the birds, which are native to Africa and are the world’s largest, standing at nine feet tall and weighing more than 300 pounds. The farm has more than 400 birds, and expects that number to grow to 700 by next year.

Alpha Roost Farms owner



DYLAN LOVAN/ASSOCIATED PRESS

After contracting alpha-gal syndrome from a tick bite, Brent Williams took up ostrich farming to provide himself and others like him with a red meat alternative.

W.D. King, who approached Williams with the idea of raising ostriches, said the interest from those with alpha-gal is helping drive the demand.

“People who haven’t had a hamburger in six or seven years really want one,” King said.

And they are willing to pay: A pound of ground ostrich can cost more than \$20, and choice cuts can sell for more than \$40.

“We have people that drive here from all over the state to get the ostrich,” said Leah Gibbs, who runs Dry Branch Farm market in Danville that sells ostrich cuts from Alpha Roost Farms.

“They are elated to have something that’s an alternative to beef,” Gibbs said. “I mean, it tastes exactly like beef.”

The Alpha-Gal Association, a nonprofit advocacy group that provides online resources to people with the allergy, recommends ostrich as a dietary substitute that tastes like beef.

Boyd Clark, who runs a large ostrich farm in Texas, said he expects to increase his herd of about 1,200 birds by 50 percent next year. Clark has raised the big birds since the 1980s, and

said the few full-scale ostrich farms around the country are trying to meet a growing demand.

“We get calls weekly from various restaurants or even small stores in different parts of the country that you wouldn’t think would even want to carry ostrich, but they’re looking for it because they’ve got customers wanting it,” said Clark, who runs Clark Ostrich Farm, about 90 miles northwest of Austin.

Lehman estimated there are only about 10 to 15 farms operating today that have large ostrich herds, and those producers have a better understanding of the animals’ behavior and free-range needs.

Williams was diagnosed with alpha-gal seven years ago. His first allergic reaction came in 2017 after eating a steak sandwich while traveling for work, something he had done hundreds of times before.

He went to see an allergist for help in diagnosing the puzzling and painful flare-up.

“The very first visit, he asked me, ‘Have you been bitten by a tick?’ I just laughed and said, ‘Sure, hundreds,’”

said Williams, who has spent most of his life raising livestock on farms where ticks thrive.

The tick that bit him was carrying the alpha-gal sugar, which is found in the meat of most mammals, but not in humans.

The sugar is harmless when eaten directly, but not when exposed via ticks’ saliva. When it entered Williams’s bloodstream, it caused an immune system reaction. The antibodies created from the reaction learned to identify and attack alpha-gal sugar molecules, making meat from mammals toxic to his system.

Alpha-gal syndrome is relatively new to medical study after a research paper linked it to tick bites in 2011. In 2023, a government report said there were about 100,000 people in the US with the allergy, though experts said many people don’t know they have it and the number of sufferers could be closer to a half-million. Last year, researchers said they documented the first known case of a death related to alpha-gal, after a 47-year-old New Jersey man died in 2024.

United Methodist Church sues large congregation

Texas group looks to break away from mainstream

By Ruth Graham
NEW YORK TIMES

DALLAS — The United Methodist Church is suing one of its largest and wealthiest congregations, pitting a shrinking mainline denomination against a powerful individual church in a clash over who controls the congregation’s future.

Highland Park United Methodist Church is what counts for “old money” in Dallas, a cheerfully capitalist city where new money tends to be welcomed without much fuss. George W. Bush is a longtime member, and Ross Perot’s funeral was held in its Gothic-style sanctuary. More than 19,000 people attended Easter services there this year.

The church’s growth and financial health place it in contrast with the United Methodist Church, which it has belonged to since the congregation was established on the campus of Southern Methodist University in 1916. In a yearslong schism primarily over LGBTQ+ issues, about 7,600 mostly conservative churches around the country departed the denomination between 2019 and 2023, including at least 40 percent of the churches in Texas.

Highland Park opted to stay, but it quietly revised its bylaws in 2022, a period in which no one was sure which side would take control of the denomination. The new bylaws granted Highland Park the power to make decisions typically made by the denomination, such as hiring clergy. They also removed all mentions of the United Methodist Church and the Book of Discipline, its governing text.

The conflict reflects something broader going on in American religion: Mainline denominations such as the United Methodist Church are declining in both members and influence, making denominational identity less powerful than it was once was. The effect is that denominational leadership has lost some of its leverage over individual churches, especially the largest ones.

What leverage the national leadership does have is often ultimately based in a denomination’s governing texts. The United Methodist “trust clause” means that if an individual church leaves, the denomination retains ownership of its property, for example.

Highland Park’s changes to its bylaws went too far, according to the suit filed last month in a Dallas civil court by the Horizon Texas Annual Conference, a regional body that oversees United Methodist congregations in North Texas and the state’s panhandle.

The lawsuit accuses the church of quietly severing important legal ties to the denomination while continuing to present itself as a United Methodist institution.

“Since last fall, conference leaders have sought to resolve this directly with Highland Park’s leadership, but that request has not been accepted,” Bishop Ruben Saenz Jr., the leader of the conference, said in a video statement after the suit was filed.

Highland Park’s refusal to acquiesce has confused observers who know the church well.

“Everyone is having difficulty understanding it,” said George Mason, who sits on the board at Southern Methodist University’s school of theology with Saenz and Tuggle.

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As midterms near, GOP finds no Trump escape

WASHINGTON — In the White House Rose Garden, President Trump recently gathered

POLITICAL NOTEBOOK

some of the most politically endangered House Republicans for a dinner where he promised to make himself the face of the party's uphill battle to keep control of Congress.

He was with them “100% — all the way until November,” Trump told the roughly two dozen lawmakers as they dined on prime aged beef burgers at tables adorned with bouquets of yellow roses. The president said he would travel to 35 key districts “to see if we can get everyone elected.”

The scene encapsulated the box that GOP lawmakers have found themselves in as they stare down a bleak political environment.

They cannot afford to snub Trump, needing help from his enormous financial reserves and strong turnout from his base to win their campaigns. But they also do not want the election to be a referendum on the president, whose popularity is at a record low. And so far, he has shown little appetite for focusing on anyone's political needs besides his own.

Two months before the mid-term elections, Trump and the Republicans who have long tied their political fortunes to him appear to be at cross-purposes as the party struggles to keep the House and Senate in GOP hands.

As Republicans work to distance themselves from the president's unpopular decisions, Trump is headlining a splashy convention in Dallas this week and has said that voters should “pretend, please, that I'm on the ballot.” As the candidates work to show they are focused on the concerns of everyday Americans, the president is spending much of his time in Washington focused on the construction of a White House ballroom, a 250-foot arch, and a golf course on a public park alongside the Potomac River. And as they brace for the final costly weeks of their campaigns, he has yet to dole out hardly any of the nearly \$1 billion he says his political action committee has raised.

“This is my money that I control,” Trump said Friday, suggesting he would spend between \$400 million and \$500 million on “Republicans that I think are good.” His political operation reported Saturday that it had made its first expenditure, to defend a Senate seat in Texas. But beyond that, Republicans have received little information about when or where the money may come.

For now, Trump appears to be focused primarily on promoting himself and boosting his popularity.

NEW YORK TIMES

Pentagon gives polygraph tests to Joint Staff members

US government investigators have taken the extraordinary step of subjecting roughly 50 members of the US military's Joint Staff to polygraph tests over leaks to journalists, including about how the Iran war has created a shortage of crucial munitions, according to officials briefed on the move.

The investigators asked military officers and civilian employees on the Joint Staff if they disclosed classified information to members of the press, and about whether they provided information about diminished US munitions stocks.

The polygraph tests were conducted in August after a flurry of news reports detailed diminished stocks of crucial munitions, including of long-range missiles and Patriot interceptors. The show of force appeared aimed at not just ferreting out anyone who may have shared information, but intimidating others who might do so in the future, according to people with knowledge of the effort.

Between 1,500 and 2,000 officers and officials work for the Joint Staff, which coordinates operations, policy, and war plans with combatant commanders around the world.

In a statement, Pentagon spokesperson Sean Parnell said that the department “does not comment on internal personnel or investigative matters but takes all leaks of classified national security information extremely seriously and investigates accordingly.”

NEW YORK TIMES

Construction on Trump's arch remains unclear

The Trump administration told a federal judge that it was not preparing to start construction on the president's planned triumphal arch in Washington, D.C., a day after Interior Secretary Doug Burgum announced that excavation work for the project would begin within the next two weeks.

The work the government plans to do, the Department of Justice said in a court filing Friday, consists of archaeological excavation of the site necessary for the required historic review of the project. And it stated, despite President Trump's frequent promotion of the project, that no final decision had been made to begin building the arch, which would stand near Arlington National Cemetery.

That starkly different message follows a pattern across other cases in which the administration has made one pronouncement in public and another in court.

Responding to the conflicting messages, Judge Tanya S. Chutkan of US District Court for the District of Columbia ordered the administration late Friday to give her at least 48 hours' notice if it proceeds with anything other than archaeological work.

NEW YORK TIMES

Missouri asks court to allow map benefiting Republicans

Missouri's attorney general on Friday asked the Supreme Court to clear a path for the state to use a congressional map in the November election that was redrawn to benefit Republicans.

The emergency request from Catherine Hanaway, a Republican, came one day after the Missouri Supreme Court said that the map used in last month's primary election was invalid, and that voters should have had an opportunity to weigh in on the new district lines.

The state court's ruling raised questions about how Missouri could hold a general election using a different map from what was used in the primaries. At least for now, it halted Republican efforts to gain a House seat in the Kansas City area.

NEW YORK TIMES



CHANDAN KHANNA/AFP VIA GETTY IMAGES

Officials investigated the scene where vehicles were destroyed after a Prime Air cargo plane overran the runway Sunday at Miami International Airport.

Cargo jet smashes vehicles

Fiery collision kills at least five at Miami airport

By Anthony Izaguirre and David Fischer

ASSOCIATED PRESS

MIAMI — An Amazon cargo plane barreled off a runway at Miami International Airport on Sunday, killing at least five people and injuring five others as it struck vehicles and was engulfed in flames, authorities said.

The aircraft overran the runway around 2 p.m. after arriving from San Juan, Puerto Rico, and plowed across a road used by warehouse workers and other businesses that surround the airport. Five people were killed, three critically injured and two others hospitalized with less severe injuries, Miami-Dade County officials told a news conference.

Miami officials said on Sunday it was too soon to say whether the people who died were on board the plane or in the vehicles the plane hit.

The crash, which sent thick black smoke billowing, trapped the pilot and copilot in the cockpit and some occupants in cars, said Miami-Dade Rescue Fire Chief Ray Jadallah. The agency said crews also had to extricate a person who was trapped under a vehicle.

The crash halted flights at

the busy travel hub for much of the afternoon.

Some 200 emergency personnel responded, finding the plane encased in heavy flames and smoke from a complex engine compartment fire, the department said. Firefighters used foam from specialized airport firefighting units to extinguish the fire, and crews were still dealing with a fuel leak on the plane hours later.

The Prime Air plane eventually stopped beside a roadway near two semi-trucks, images showed. The aircraft appeared to be on its belly and was largely intact despite the fire.

The cause had yet to be determined, and it was not clear if weather had played a role. Thunderstorms and wind gusts up to 30 miles per hour were recorded in the area at the time, according to the National Weather Service.

The flight had been operated by 21 Air, a cargo carrier based in North Carolina. The 32-year-old Boeing 767 was originally built to carry passengers and flew for several airlines for more than two decades before being converted to a cargo plane in 2015, according to flight-tracking site Flightradar24.

More than 160 flights were canceled and nearly 325 delayed by late Sunday, according to FlightAware, a website that tracks flight disruptions. Officials from Orlando International Airport, more than 200 miles

north of Miami, said some flights were diverted there.

The National Transportation Safety Board said it was sending a team to Miami led by Chairwoman Jennifer Homendy to investigate.

Amazon said in a statement that it would cooperate with any investigation.

“We're heartbroken to learn that five people lost their lives in today's incident at Miami International Airport,” the company said.

Last year, a UPS plane crashed after losing its engine while accelerating down the runway at Louisville's Muhammad Ali International Airport. The crash killed all three pilots and 12 people on the ground. Twenty-three more were injured.

Aviation safety expert Steve Arroyo said that a 767 cargo aircraft would typically be staffed only by a pilot and copilot on domestic flights. A third pilot would be added for an international flight, and a long-haul international flight would require a fourth pilot.

Arroyo, a retired longtime United Airlines pilot, said he wants to know whether the Amazon plane landed in the touchdown zone of the runway, and if it was beyond that area why it didn't simply abort that landing and go around to line up for another attempt. Typically, the landing zone is within the first 3,000 feet of a runway.

Newest immigration judges have scant experience in field

► JUDGES

Continued from Page A1

to “create a huge infusion of people” who will view their job function as helping the executive branch execute its immigration enforcement policies — instead of acting as independent judges.

“Obviously, they think that some people are more prone to follow the instructions to a T, than others who are more inclined to challenge them,” said Chishti, who has extensively researched immigration courts. “At some level, the conventional wisdom is that people with prosecutorial or military backgrounds will tend to support the executive.”

Still, it remains to be seen whether the strategy will work, he said — and if the appointed judges will carry out the administration's priorities. “Some judges, when they sit in that chair, just assume that their job is to be an independent arbiter,” Chishti said.

Immigration judges are employees of the Executive Office for Immigration Review, the Department of Justice agency that operates the immigration courts. Under the executive branch, they can be summarily dismissed by the administration during their probation period.

Since last January, at least 17 immigration judges in Massachusetts have been fired or have left their posts, according to a Globe analysis of public staff directories. Many of the fired judges had backgrounds as immigration lawyers.

The administration has replaced them with what it refers to as “deportation judges,” appointees who were often previously working as military lawyers, ICE attorneys, or as state or federal prosecutors.

“After four years of the Biden

Administration forcing Immigration Courts to implement a de facto amnesty for hundreds of thousands of aliens, this Department of Justice is restoring integrity to our immigration system and continues to bring on talented legal professionals who are committed to protecting national security and public safety,” a spokesperson for the Department of Justice said in a statement.

Immigration courts across the country have been understaffed and unable to meet rising demand for review for years; a massive surge of new cases during the Biden administration only added to the court's rising backlog, which hit a peak of about 3.7 million cases in fiscal year 2024.

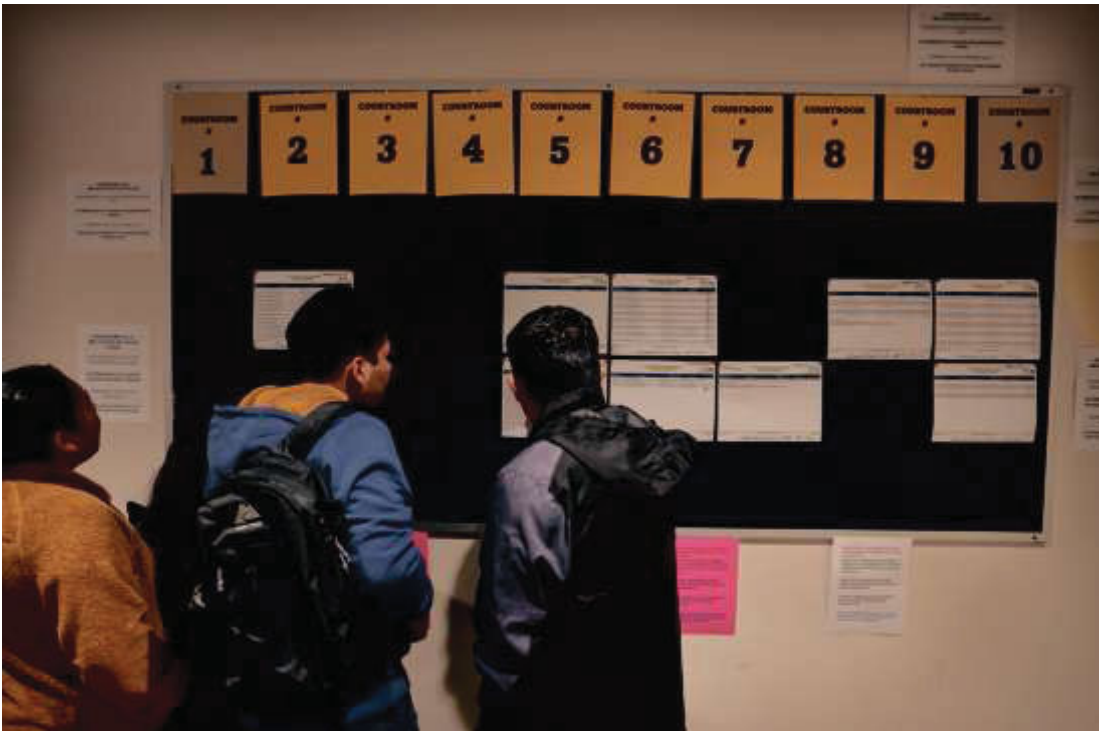
“Reducing the immigration court backlog remains one of the highest priorities for this administration,” the Justice Department spokesperson said.

The immigration court in Chelmsford, which opened in the spring of 2024 to help ease the backlog of cases, has been transformed by these hiring practices. Seventy-five percent of the immigration judges at the court, 12 out of the 16 judges, were hired under the second Trump administration, with four of them previously working as lawyers for the military.

“It's a complete meltdown of due process,” said George Pappas, a former judge at the Chelmsford immigration court who was fired in July 2025, after being appointed to the bench in 2023. The immigration courts in Massachusetts and elsewhere have essentially become tools for the administration to carry out its mass deportation agenda, Pappas said.

“They're part of the enforcement mechanism,” he said.

Immigration judges in Mas-



CRAIG F. WALKER/GLOBE STAFF

The immigration court's hearing calendar at the John F. Kennedy Federal Building in Boston.

sachusetts issued a record number of removal orders earlier this year, serving 1,692 deportation orders in June, according to data collected by the Transactional Records Access Clearinghouse at Syracuse University, compared to 238 removal orders in June 2024 under the Biden administration.

The uptick in removal orders, which represent the conclusion of an immigration case unless the decision is appealed, has reduced the national case backlog to about 3.2 million in the 2026 fiscal year, which ends Sept. 30, according to the clearinghouse data.

In Massachusetts, the backlog has decreased from about 160,000 pending immigration court cases in the 2024 fiscal year to approximately 152,000 cases this fiscal year.

In a statement to the Globe, a spokesperson for the Executive

Office for Immigration Review said that the agency “prioritizes the timely completion of all cases and makes scheduling adjustments as needed to ensure cases do not languish.”

“Unnecessary delay,” the spokesperson said, hurts both immigrants with valid claims and Americans who want to see immigrants with non-valid immigration claims “removed as quickly as possible.”

“As it continues to add new immigration judges, EOIR will continue to make scheduling adjustments to ensure all cases are handled in a timely and lawful manner,” the spokesperson said.

The administration has also been finding other ways to expedite immigration court cases. Across the country in recent months, including in Boston and Chelmsford, the courts have been holding what immigration attorneys sometimes refer to as

“mega” master calendar hearings.

In these sessions, the court schedules dozens of initial hearings each day before a single judge, and instead of allowing months or longer before the next hearing, the court asks immigrants to come back just a few weeks later — accelerating their future court dates, too.

Attorneys say this is an apparent effort to speed up deportations; it also gives respondents less time to find an attorney and prepare for their cases. On a recent weekday in Chelmsford, one judge had about 100 cases on her docket.

Pappas, who has returned to practicing immigration law, said the new judges' lack of experience, combined with the sped-up judicial process, means little review is happening at all in these cases.

Nationally, more than 110

judges have been fired since January of 2025, according to the International Federation of Professional and Technical Engineers, a union that represents federal workers, including immigration judges.

This spring, the Trump administration fired the immigration judge who terminated the government's deportation proceedings against Rümeyssa Öztürk, the Tufts University graduate student who was arrested last year by ICE agents on a Somerville street. And in Chelmsford, Judge Nina Froes, who earlier this year terminated the government's deportation proceedings against Columbia University student and Palestinian activist Mohsen Mahdawi, was also fired.

In an interview with the Globe, Froes said the administration's recent hires could be in danger of being fired at will, too — just like she was.

Froes previously worked as an immigration attorney in Massachusetts and was appointed to start hearing cases in May 2024, months before President Trump was reelected. Once officials began dismissing immigration judges under the Trump administration, she remembers having a “constant” worry that she was going to be let go.

“I felt like if I don't do what they want me to, I'm going to be fired immediately,” Froes said.

When Froes was a judge in Chelmsford under the Trump administration, the message from higher-ups was obvious, she said: Get through cases fast, and issue decisions swiftly.

“Just push things along as expeditiously as possible.”

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Teamsters union remains politically divided

►TEAMSTERS

Continued from Page A1

lems, not draw lines in the sand.”

The apparent divide between O’Brien and local Teamsters may not be entirely political: Brown and O’Brien have known each other for years, thanks to their shared roots in Massachusetts politics.

There’s a clear big-picture pattern, however, and it speaks to potent fissures within the Teamsters and organized labor more broadly. In recent years, most union leaders have largely hung with Democrats as rank-and-file members, especially in blue-collar trades, drifted to Donald Trump’s movement. But O’Brien has stood out among his cohort for his willingness to court the MAGA right — epitomized by speaking before the 2024 Republican National Convention — which has drawn internal criticism as Trump and his congressional allies largely maintain the GOP’s anti-labor union stance.

A spokesperson for O’Brien did not respond to a request for comment, nor did officials with Teamsters Local 633. The Brown campaign did not respond to a request for comment. The Pappas campaign declined to comment.

The stakes are high in New Hampshire’s Senate contest. With Democratic Senator Jeanne Shaheen retiring, her party is hoping to protect the seat on their way toward retaking a Senate majority, while Republicans are seizing on the race as a valuable opportunity to go on offense. In the Sept. 8 primary election, Pappas faces progressive activist Karishma Manzur, while polls show Brown a

clear underdog against former senator John E. Sununu, who is endorsed by Trump.

But New Hampshire is not the only sign of strong political cross-currents within a union that has symbolized how Trump’s right-wing populism is changing the labor movement.

In April, the Pennsylvania Conference of Teamsters voted to endorse Paige Cagnetti, the Democratic mayor of Scranton, who is challenging Republican Representative Rob Bresnahan in one of the most competitive congressional races in the country.

But Bresnahan has been a favorite of Teamsters leadership, with O’Brien hosting him on his podcast in January. In May, the national Teamsters PAC gave \$5,000 to Bresnahan. By June, the Pennsylvania Teamsters had reversed course and backed Bresnahan.

In Texas, two prominent Teamsters locals endorsed Republican Governor Greg Abbott, historically a foe of organized labor, over Democratic challenger Gina Hinojosa, who is backed by the vast majority of Texas unions. The move went over poorly in some corners: John Palmer, a senior national Teamsters official from Texas, said the endorsement was “embarrassing and appalling.” He accused O’Brien of putting his thumb on the scale to appeal to Abbott, which he called a “fool’s errand.”

Raised in Medford, O’Brien is a fourth-generation Teamster. He joined the union’s Local 25 in Charlestown at the age of 18, then swiftly climbed the ranks of union leadership. (He still lives in Massachusetts and serves as vice chairman of the Massport Board of Directors.)



ASSOCIATED PRESS FILE

Scott Brown, former senator representing Massachusetts, is taking on John Sununu for the GOP nod in New Hampshire.

In 2022, O’Brien was elected to lead the Teamsters, who represent 1.3 million workers in the US and Canada. Most come from the transportation and logistics sectors, but a wide array of blue-collar and white-collar workers are members of the union.

Though O’Brien is a registered Democrat, in 2024, he became the first-ever Teamsters chief to address a Republican National Convention. (He did not speak at the Democratic National Convention but said he requested to do so.) The national Teamsters did not endorse either Trump or former vice president Kamala Harris, but the union’s affiliates in several key battleground states vocally supported Harris.

Since 2024, O’Brien has often pointed out that over 60 percent of Teamsters members voted for Trump. He says he speaks with Trump regularly. He has argued that Republicans have a clear opportunity to overtake Democrats as the true party of work-

ers but is urging them to follow through with policies that deliver results that match their rhetoric.

The national Teamsters union, meanwhile, is a major campaign money player through its political action committee, which has contributed nearly \$8 million to candidates and party committees in this election cycle. They support both parties but tend to favor Democrats. Pappas received \$4,000 from the Teamsters PAC last September.

No Teamsters organization, either local or national, formally endorsed Brown in any of his previous three campaigns for Senate. The union strongly backed Senator Elizabeth Warren in her successful challenge to Brown in 2012, but Carl Gentile, the former leader of the Teamsters in Worcester, got some attention for endorsing Brown in that campaign.

On his podcast in January, O’Brien noted Pappas has “some union support” but asked

‘I believe that the Republican Party is now the party of the working people, and that the Democratic Party is the party of the elites, the billionaires, and trillionaires.’

SCOTT BROWN

Brown whether it was “accurate” his possible Democratic opponent is pro-union.

Brown began by talking about his own longtime membership in performing arts and media union SAG-AFTRA, which he leaned on to burnish his worker credentials when running against Warren.

“There’s still people who are contributing dues, which I did for decades,” said Brown. “Chris Pappas has never done that. ... What has he done for the unions? Like, what has he actually sponsored and passed that helps unions?”

O’Brien noted Pappas’s co-sponsorship of the Faster Labor Contracts Act, a key legislative priority of labor unions. Brown and O’Brien both agreed it was “easy” for Pappas to do so, but when O’Brien asked him whether he would support the legislation, the Republican didn’t give a definitive answer, saying he would “learn more about that particular issue.”

In their endorsement of Pappas, Teamsters Local 633 said

the Democrat “stood shoulder to shoulder with working families, fought for fair wages and benefits, and defended workers’ right to organize and bargain collectively.” They credited Pappas for “support[ing] infrastructure investments, protect[ing] pensions, and work[ing] to lower the cost of health care and prescription drugs.”

Also in their hourlong conversation, O’Brien and Brown discussed the big-picture political shifts taking place among union members.

“I believe that the Republican Party is now the party of the working people, and that the Democratic Party is the party of the elites, the billionaires, and trillionaires,” Brown said.

O’Brien said the GOP “could be” the party of workers but said they had yet to prove it, and expressed some frustration with Republicans who talked a big game on supporting labor but eventually failed to support key bills when faced with pressure from their own party leadership.

“There’s issues where the Republicans right now could take the ball and really run with it, and I’m encouraging that every single day because, clearly, the Democrats lost the support of the rank and file, not necessarily the leadership, but the rank and file of all our unions,” O’Brien said.

Addressing Brown — who O’Brien said has “proven over time and time again” that he supports working people — the union boss gave some advice. “I’d be out there saying, what are your issues?”

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Residents undercut city’s bid to boost shade, lower temperatures

►SHADE

Continued from Page A1

“We’re not going to plant ourselves a robust and vibrant urban forest,” said David Meshoulam, the executive director of Tree Boston, an advocacy nonprofit. “We need to preserve those trees that we have.”

According to Boston’s latest tree assessment, the tree canopy — the branches and leaves that cover the ground when viewed from above — grew modestly by 0.5 percent between 2019 and 2024, covering 28.5 percent of the city when excluding the airport. This marked an improvement from the previous five-year period, when there was no net change in canopy coverage. But the city’s gains on open space and rights-of-way land were largely offset by removals on residential properties, which contain the largest share of tree canopy.

Behind those losses are everyday decisions made by developers and residents: Trees are cut down to make room for housing, meet the stipulations of an insurance company, or create a better view. The problem comes when these collective choices constitute a significant loss of trees.

“There is no regulation, no ordinance, or state protection in place over private trees,” said Diana Fernandez Bibeau, the city’s parks and recreation commissioner, though she noted that Boston’s antiquated zoning laws give the city some room to engage with private landowners about their trees.

Some Massachusetts cities and towns have implemented local laws that regulate the removal of trees on private land, including Somerville and Lexington.

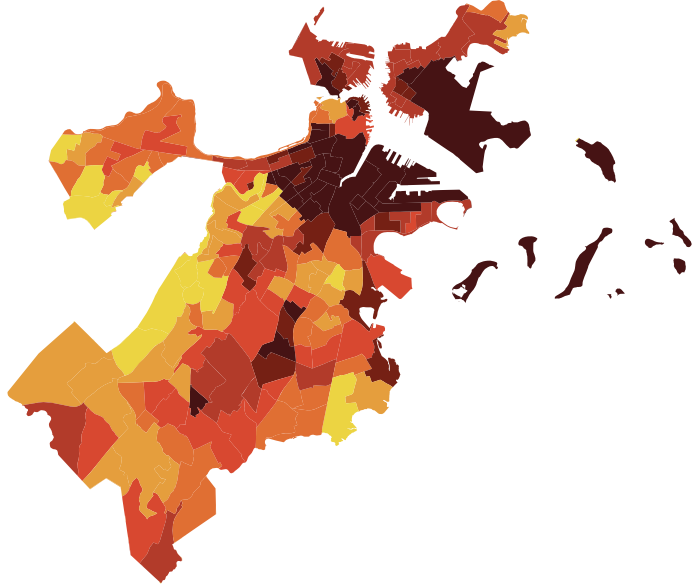
In Cambridge, the City Council passed strict protections for private trees in 2019. The city’s most recent tree report, spanning 2018 to 2024, found that residential properties experienced the most canopy growth, increasing by 4.5 percent.

“That difference is hard to ignore,” said Nasser Brahim, the Mystic River Watershed Association’s director of climate resilience, noting that Boston saw a roughly 1 percent decrease in residential tree canopy around the same time.

Cambridge requires residents to seek a permit to remove a tree that has a diameter of 6 inches or more at roughly chest height. Barring special circum-

The mean afternoon heat index in July 2019

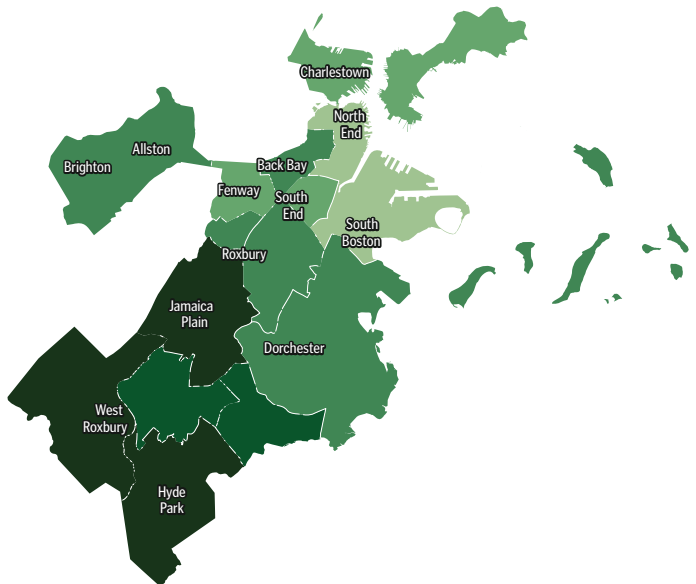
■ <95.4 ■ 95.4–95.9 ■ 95.9–96.3 ■ 96.3–96.6 ■ 96.6–96.9 ■ 96.9–97.3 ■ ≥ 97.3



Map: Ilana Zahavy for The Boston Globe • Source: Boston Parks and Recreation Department with the University of Vermont Spatial Analysis Lab

Boston’s 2019 tree canopy coverage

■ <10% ■ 10%–20% ■ 20%–30% ■ 30%–40% ■ 40%–50% ■ ≥50%



Excluding Boston Logan International Airport
Map: Ilana Zahavy for The Boston Globe • Source: Boston Parks and Recreation

stances, such as if the tree is dead or threatens a nearby home, residents must plant replacement trees or pay into a city fund if they want to cut one down.

David Lefcourt, the city arborist, said the private tree protections required extra staff time but did not necessitate standing up an enforcement division. Cambridge hired an assistant city arborist who is responsible for managing removal permits from private property owners and handling the tree planting side of the program.

Lefcourt said residents help keep an eye out for anyone trying to skirt the law: “It’s pretty tough to get away with,” he said. He tells contractors: “It’s going to be the next-door neighbors, it’s going to be the person walking their dog down the street, saying, ‘Hey, something doesn’t look right in this parcel.’”

An effort to pass a similar measure by Boston’s City Council did not gain traction. In 2023, an ordinance was filed that would have included protections for both public and private trees. The language regarding private trees did not make it into the final policy.

The city said at the time that it was adopting a “phased approach,” allowing it to “lead by example before engaging with the community to extend regulations to trees on private property.”

But Brian Swett, Boston’s chief climate officer, said a private tree ordinance is no longer being explored as a solution in



SUZANNE KREITER/GLOBE STAFF

Harambee Park in Dorchester has very little tree cover, a problem that the city of Boston and the nonprofit Tree Boston are trying to rectify.

the near term.

Instead, officials said, Boston is looking at other approaches, such as “pedestrian easements” that would allow homeowners to plant trees that the city then takes care of. It is also working with community partners to plant more trees on private land.

“We’ve turned the corner where before 2019, the previous decade, we lost canopy coverage,” Swett said, adding, “We’ve shown the art of the possible in the last five years.”

In the meantime, tensions

have flared between landowners seeking to remove trees and some residents who say city regulations on these trees are overdue.

In Hyde Park, several trees were cut down behind an apartment complex in June, including one so large that Becky Shuster, 64, couldn’t get her arms around it.

Shuster, who has lived in a house behind the apartment complex for nearly three decades, said, “I sat there and wept.” She said her deck and home are hotter and sunnier,

but she is more concerned about the citywide consequences of trees on private property.

“They destroyed a piece of the tree canopy in Boston, and there’s absolutely no accountability,” she said.

Oleg Uritsky, director of Advanced Property Management, which manages the apartment complex, said the company does not want to remove healthy trees, but the trees that were removed were in bad shape and dropping branches on neighbors’ yards.

Uritsky said new regulations

on removing private trees would add bureaucracy, expense, and delays to cases when property owners need to move quickly to protect safety and homes.

A few years ago during a winter storm, a tree fell on Uritsky’s home in Newton, narrowly missing a window by his young son’s crib. He has since sought to have a large branch removed from a second “dangerous” tree in front of his house, but he said a company refused to do it, saying a city inspector “would not be happy.” Newton requires residents to seek a permit to remove trees that have a trunk diameter of 6 inches or more.

“Safety comes first, and to have additional red tape — I don’t think it’s a good idea,” Uritsky said.

While Boston figures out its next steps to protect private trees, advocates said the city’s gains on public land, aided by community partners, are nothing to scoff at.

Life as a city tree is an uphill battle, fought against depleted soils, pollutants like car exhaust and dog urine, and sometimes even vandalism. Planting the tree, by comparison, is the easy part.

Tree Boston plants trees and cares for them for two years before turning them over to the city. On a recent weekday morning in Harambee Park in Dorchester, two watering trucks staffed by a crew from the nonprofit moved from tree to tree, pumping 30 gallons into watering bags. Despite temperatures hovering in the mid-70s, the team was sweating. The park has very little tree cover, even along the pathways that run between playing fields.

Marco Lomax, the tree care coordinator for Tree Boston, knelt by a young London plane tree and gave it a shake to check how well it had rooted in the rocky soil. He pointed to the nearby roadway, where cars spew pollutants that coat trees’ leaves and send toxic runoff into the ground. One time, he said, the nonprofit visited a tree it planted to find a pile of beer bottles and the stakes keeping the tree upright torn out and flung across the grass.

“We’re throwing these trees in the deep end,” he said.

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INBOX

Civics lessons for an election season

Law school teacher will treat Election Day as a field assignment

The right to vote is essential to a healthy democracy. One of the greatest threats to that democracy has been the continued false claim that the 2020 election was stolen. Despite a lack of credible evidence, some lawyers advanced those claims before courts and legislative bodies, violating their duty of honesty and candor. Several, including Rudolph Giuliani, lost their licenses to practice law.

I teach professional responsibility to mostly second-year law students at Suffolk University. A question I am often asked is whether lawyers can be ethical. My answer is yes, and most lawyers are. Yet the conduct of those who promoted baseless election fraud claims

Democracy is a participatory endeavor.

has forced me to reflect on whether the legal profession must do more to protect our democratic institutions. For that reason, I will not hold class on Election Day in November. Instead, I have committed to serving as an election worker in my community, as I have done before, and I will encourage my students to do the same. In the class that follows, we will discuss what we saw and whether the experience affected our confidence in the electoral process.

Democracy is a participatory endeavor. We all have a responsibility to support and strengthen this vital institution of our Republic.

ROBERT V. WARD JR.
Milton

Should 16-year-olds have a vote in Mass. municipal elections?

Kiran Bhatia argues that Massachusetts should let towns and cities lower the voting age to 16 (“The Legislature should stop blocking 16-year-old voters,” Opinion, Aug. 17). I am 16, and I would drop his strongest-sounding pitch from his argument.

Bhatia says that 16- and 17-year-olds are cognitively ready to participate in elections. That starts a fight over how much we understand about the issues — one that nobody wins, because we don’t hold adults to the same test. Someone who followed the campaign closely for months gets one vote, and so does someone who decided that morning to take an interest in the election. Voting is a right, not a reward for scoring well.

The better argument is that this stopped being hypothetical years ago: 16-year-olds vote for the Scottish and Welsh parliaments and in council elections there. Britain is now legislating to extend the vote to 16- and 17-year-olds across all UK elections.

Massachusetts lawmakers are dragging their feet over letting a handful of municipalities try what young voters in Britain have done routinely for years. If there is a good reason to hold the line at 18, it should be better than saying teenagers don’t know enough. Plenty of adults don’t either.

EMAD REHMAN
Epsom, England

Kiran Bhatia criticized the Massachusetts Legislature for not granting approval to cities and towns to allow 16- and 17-year-olds to vote in municipal elections. On the contrary, I think allowing such a practice would be foolhardy.

Despite Bhatia’s argument, I think it should be self-evident that 16-year-olds lack the life experience and maturity to be allowed to have a say in important municipal decisions. Furthermore, since they are still in school, they are often under the influence of schoolteachers. Teachers unions are highly partisan organizations that constantly lobby for higher government spending.

The last thing we need in Massachusetts is more voters under the influence of public employee unions promoting more municipal spending and higher property taxes.

ROCCO CONTE
Revere



ADOBE STOCK PHOTOS/GLOBE STAFF PHOTO ILLUSTRATION

Teacher urges young voters to focus on local, state races

Re “Here’s how to get your son to vote” (Opinion, Aug. 31): John Della Volpe’s excellent op-ed is a subject close to my heart. I have taught government and civics in high school, at a community college, and at a county jail. I urge all of my students to vote, but I emphasize that it is not about the national political circus that they see on TV, where so much is just for show and power. Rather, I advise, pay heed to the local and state elections, where you and your vote can make a real difference.

For my men in jail — and indeed for the jail itself — politics is local, as is government. For example, educational and reentry programs are directly important to them and their situation, as is the district attorney race this fall.

I also tell my students that city councilors and state lawmakers are based nearby and that students can get to know them, work on their campaigns, get involved in other ways, and become an agent rather than an object of politics and government. I tell them that candidates seeking office may be their neighbors and that, for the most part, they are good men and women trying to do their best for the community.

Remember that in 2019 Julia Mejia won her Boston City Council seat by a single vote. Voting and participation do matter at this level.

RANDY FOOTE
Roxbury

Opinion

BOSTONGLOBE.COM/OPINION



FACEBOOK; COURTESY SHALEA SANDERS

Lindsay Clancy, left, and Latarsha Sanders

EDITORIAL

If DA retries Lindsay Clancy and Latarsha Sanders cases, he should downgrade charges

Few would want to walk in the shoes of the jury in the Lindsay Clancy case, a collection of nine women and three men who for five weeks had to listen to the heart-wrenching testimony about whether the Duxbury woman should be held criminally responsible in the deaths of her three young children she killed in 2023.

And no jurors should ever have to again.

On Friday, Plymouth County Superior Court Judge William F. Sullivan declared a mistrial after the tired, divided jury was unable to reach a verdict despite a week of deliberating.

The Plymouth County distict attorney, Timothy Cruz, now faces a decision. He could drop the charges entirely. Or he could retry the case. If he does choose to charge Clancy again, he should choose charges that would allow a judge, not a jury, to render a verdict.

Clancy did not deny killing her children, but her lawyer argued she did so in the throes of postpartum psychosis and should, therefore, be judged not guilty by reason of insanity.

Even the 80 witnesses, including expert witnesses often offering conflicting opinions, and more than 300 exhibits could not help this jury reach a unanimous verdict.

No jury should be put in this position again — not in the Clancy case and not in the case of Latarsha Sanders, a Brockton mother convicted of killing two of her children in 2022 and recently granted a new trial by the Supreme Judicial Court.

And, yes, the cases, however different the defendants may be, are inextricably linked.

Cruz, who charged both women with first-degree murder, has now been given a chance to do better, to make an honorable and equitable decision, and charge the two mothers with no more than second-degree murder.

That would allow a judge rather than a jury to weigh the evidence. Defendants in first-degree murder cases aren’t allowed to waive their right to a jury trial.

Long before the Clancy trial ever began, Cruz was in the tricky position of having earlier charged Sanders, a poor, Black woman, later diagnosed with schizophrenia spectrum disorder, with first-degree murder. Could he treat a white Duxbury mom suffering from postpartum-related mental illnesses any differently? Cruz was in a box of his own making.

But the very nature of a jury trial — the drama, the effort to play to the jury — involves its own level of distortion.

“She left them discarded on the basement floor like broken toys because she was done play-

ing the game,” Plymouth Assistant District Attorney Jennifer Sprague said, describing the scene in her closing argument in the Clancy murder trial. “You know to a moral certainty she is guilty,” she told jurors.

Just as Plymouth Assistant District Attorney Amanda Fowle told jurors that Sanders was “evil,” “playing the crazy card,” and had crafted her “lies” from an episode of “Law and Order” — something the SJC took particular notice of, finding it “impermissible.”

But mostly the high court found fault with Sullivan — the same judge presiding over the Clancy trial — for failing to allow the jury to hear evidence about Sanders’s deteriorating mental state during the four years she awaited trial, first in prison and then in a state psychiatric facility.

Unlike Clancy, who defense lawyers argue was likely overmedicated by a variety of health care professionals, Sanders was reported by her family to have exhibited increasingly bizarre behavior prior to killing her two young boys, but she had no mental health treatment until those pre-trial stays.

Clancy, now paralyzed from the waist down from a suicide attempt the night of the killings, has been held at Tewksbury Hospital, a state public psychiatric hospital, before and during her trial.

Jurors are notoriously reluctant to acquit a defendant of an admittedly heinous killing, even though an acquittal could mean years in a mental hospital with periodic reviews for potential release. (Would-be Reagan assassin John Hinckley, acquitted by reason of insanity, spent 35 years in mental institutions before his conditional release in 2016.) It offends the sensibilities of many people that some how, some day, however far down the road, this person will be free.

But experienced judges have the expertise to weigh the evidence and to see all of the possible sentencing outcomes and consequences in a way jurors — thrown into the legal system often for the first time in their lives — can’t.

The jury in the Clancy case appeared to be split 11-1, with one juror apparently holding out for a conviction. The trial ended in an unusual way, with an emergency appeal from defense attorneys seeking to dismiss the juror to clear the way for a not-guilty verdict, a request a single justice of the SJC, Dalila A. Wendlandt, rejected.

Cruz now has an opportunity to do the right thing in both cases by downgrading the charges and letting a judge make the final determination. These cases should be about delivering actual justice, and the district attorney can now help make that happen.

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Legalizing recreational marijuana was a mistake, and we know it

By Jeffrey Morgan

Jeffrey Morgan is a retired oncologist.

A decade ago, Massachusetts embarked on a sweeping social experiment by legalizing commercial recreational marijuana. As a retired physician and oncologist who spent decades treating patients in Massachusetts, I watched this transition with profound concern.

Today, the data is in, and the consequences are undeniable. The state is currently grappling with rising workplace injuries, dangerous roads, pediatric poisonings, and a severe youth mental health crisis.

On the November ballot, voters have an opportunity to eliminate commercial recreational marijuana sales, which will protect vulnerable populations while preserving the medical marijuana infrastructure.

Massachusetts has prioritized commercial marijuana corporations over the safety of the state's workforce, the brains of our youth, and the lives of our drivers.

The initiative requires the Cannabis Control Commission to establish a streamlined, expedited pathway for existing recreational dispensaries to transition into licensed medical treatment centers. What the initiative dismantles is a predatory, commercial market driven by corporate profits.

As a researcher, my primary obligation is to the facts. Since Massachusetts legalized marijuana in 2016, THC content in products has continued to rise. Modern concentrates and edibles boast extreme potencies that have been directly linked to severe mental health conditions like psychosis, severe anxiety, and schizophrenia, particularly in young adults. The developing human brain did not evolve to withstand this level of neurochemical inundation.

This aggressive commercialization is driving a spike in workplace injuries. This trend hurts local businesses, degrades young careers before they can truly begin, and directly threatens public safety.

The financial argument for legalization has entirely crumbled under empirical scrutiny. While the marijuana industry claims recreational tax sales help the state, studies from other legalized states like Colorado show for every dollar gained in tax revenue taxpayers spend \$4.50 to mitigate the societal harms. In-

creased rates of workplace injuries, higher health care costs, increased turnover, and lost productivity mean the costs to businesses and taxpayers have far outweighed what the state brings in from taxes.

Legalization failed its primary promise to eliminate the black market. Because Massachusetts imposes some of the highest marijuana taxes in the country, legal prices are high and the black market is thriving because the prices are lower. The criminals that legalization was supposed to put out of business are still operating; legalization gave them room to grow.

The physical threat in people's homes is equally severe, especially regarding accidental ingestion. Children under 5 accounted for more than 40 percent of all poison exposures linked to marijuana edibles in 2020. Nationally, in-home THC exposures among kids have risen exponentially in the years after legalization took hold. Massachusetts families are living these harrowing statistics right now in emergency rooms, in poison control calls, and in pediatricians' offices across our state. Pets are also paying the price; drug poisonings of pets have been on the rise nationwide, putting innocent dogs and cats at high risk and forcing families to seek expensive veterinary care to treat them

Beyond homes, public safety on the roads has severely degraded since recreational marijuana was legalized. Marijuana is now the most common drug found in fatal car accidents in Massachusetts. The behavioral data is alarming: In a survey of 2,000 cannabis users, 85 percent admit to driving after consumption, and more than 50 percent drive within an hour of consumption.

Opponents of the measure frequently rely on scare tactics, claiming a repeal will trigger mass incarceration or destroy individual liberties. This is fundamentally untrue. The initiative carefully preserves an adult's right to possess up to one ounce of cannabis without any legal or civil penalty, and ensures that gifting small, non-advertised amounts between adults remains entirely legal. It does not criminalize consumers; it halts corporate exploitation.

Massachusetts has prioritized commercial marijuana corporations over the safety of the state's workforce, the brains of our youth, and the lives of our drivers.

No state has ever voted to repeal a recreational cannabis market once opened, but Massachusetts can and should be the first. By voting to end recreational sales while keeping medical marijuana stores open and maintaining basic adult possession, voters can dismantle a predatory commercial apparatus. It is time to let data, medical reality, and economic truth guide our laws. Let us vote to protect our families, our businesses, and the health of our commonwealth.



Don't let outside fearmongering kill legal cannabis

By Jacqui Lipson

Jacqui Lipson is a breast cancer survivor, cannabis consumer, homeowner, and mother living in Braintree, Massachusetts.

I am the face of modern, regulated cannabis use: a menopausal woman, a breast cancer survivor, a parent, a homeowner. And that's terribly inconvenient for the Virginia-based group bankrolling this November's ballot question to repeal recreational marijuana in Massachusetts.

I have a mortgage. I have a job. I parent, I work, I pay my bills on time. I volunteer at my children's schools. I know my dispensary's owners by name, and I move through my days with a clear head.

And yes, when my work day is done, I simply enjoy it. The same way millions of adults enjoy alcohol, only without the hangover or the regret.

Like most mothers, I think constantly about what could hurt my children. That's exactly why I have so little patience for campaigns that ask parents to worry about the wrong things, which is exactly what this year's ballot question asking Massachusetts residents to repeal access to recreational marijuana would do.

If this campaign were really about protecting families, it would be homegrown (pun intended), driven by Massachusetts residents responding to the problems we actually face, not bankrolled by Smart Approaches to Marijuana, a national organization from Virginia that has launched the local ballot effort through funding the Coalition for a Healthy Massachusetts. A local campaign would confront the public health failures harming families every day, not a tightly regulated industry that, according to the US Drug Enforcement Administration, has never been linked to a documented fatal overdose.

I found the lump in my breast in 2020 while nursing my younger child. It was hormone-positive breast cancer. Treatment included a double mastectomy and medically induced menopause years before my body was ready. The cancer is gone, but the risk isn't.

Health care is finally taking menopause seriously, and many women my age are weighing hormone therapies for relief. For me, most of those options are off the table; they'd feed the same hormone-positive cancer that could still kill me if it returns. Between that reality and a medical system that too often shrugs at women's pain, the most consistent relief I've found hasn't come from another

prescription, or a medical marijuana card.

It comes from my local, woman-owned recreational cannabis dispensary, where the staff know their products and treat me with curiosity, not judgment. A medical card would route me right back through the system that I'm describing — where my access depends on insurance approvals, physical gatekeeping, and someone else's profit margin. What I have works. Legal cannabis isn't broken and I shouldn't have to medicalize a solution that's already safe, accessible, and effective just to satisfy a campaign with no real evidence of harm.

Alcohol kills thousands of Massachusetts residents every year. Opioids have devastated thousands more families. Millions of underage Americans report binge drinking, and excessive alcohol use kills thousands of people under 21 every year. Women in menopause still struggle to find

I've spent enough years watching women's pain minimized while others decide they know better than patients, physicians, and families.

physicians who take their symptoms seriously. Those are the public health challenges that deserve our attention.

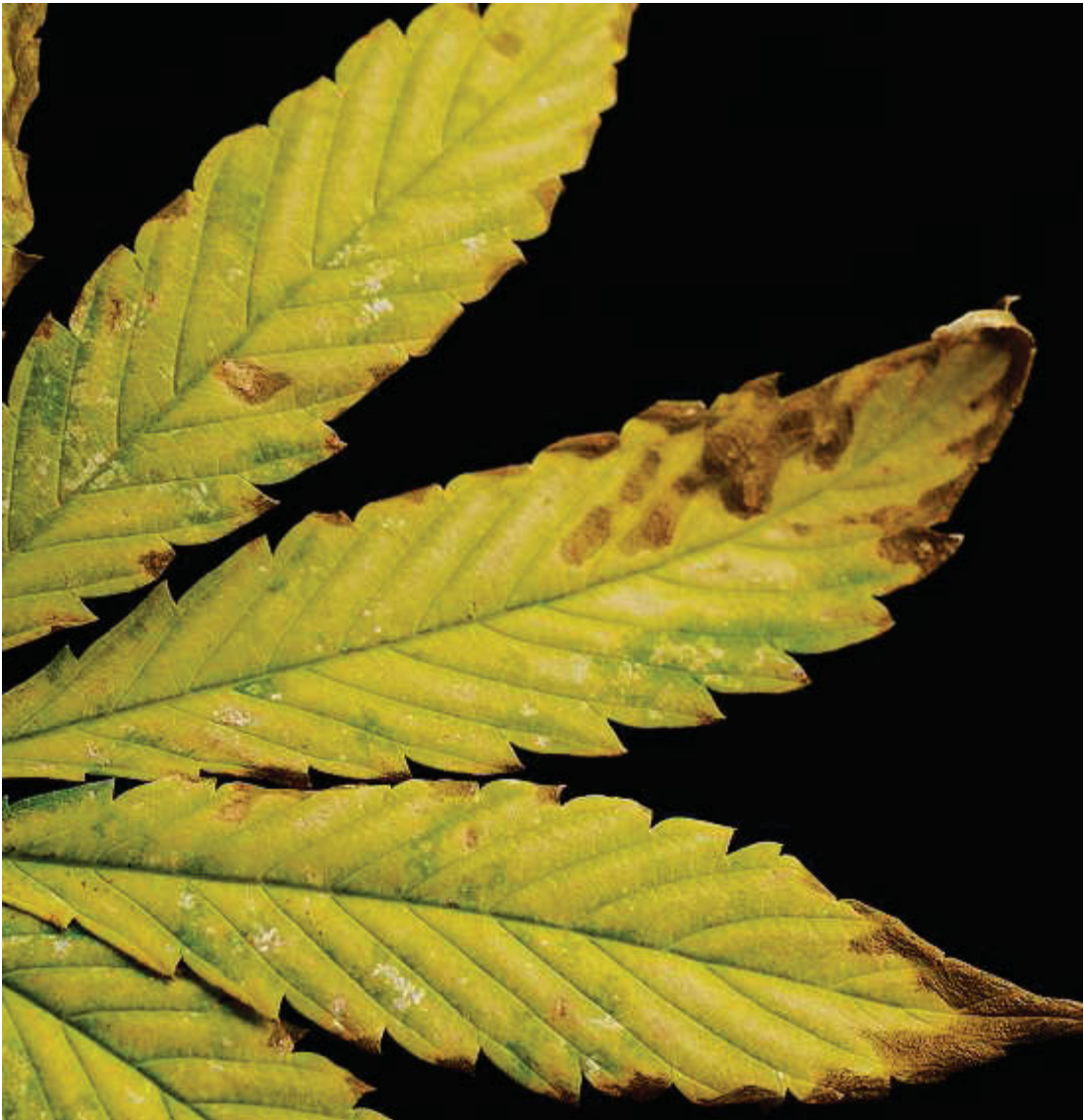
Yet we're being asked to believe that the urgent threat is the regulated cannabis dispensary where I buy the product that has done more to relieve my post-cancer nerve pain and menopausal symptoms than almost anything else I've tried.

Legal cannabis generates hundreds of millions of dollars in tax revenue for Massachusetts. But that's not why I'll vote to keep it legal.

I'll vote no because I've spent enough of my life being told to ignore what my own body was telling me. I've spent enough years watching women's pain minimized while others decide they know better than patients, physicians, and families.

Massachusetts families deserve better than selective outrage dressed up as public safety. We deserve policies grounded in evidence, compassion, and the realities of the communities we actually live in — not campaigns built on old stereotypes or imported fear.

I'll trade my pink ribbon for a fresh joint — or a cannabis seltzer — before I trade away one of the few things that has consistently made life after cancer easier to live.



VASILY/ADOBE



JONNY/ADOBE

The pediatricians who take in vaccine skeptics

►PEDIATRICIANS

Continued from Page A1

ment is, what happened to my body, my choice?”

She looked at Bornstein. He was leaning back in his arm-chair, wearing a blue button-down, a Popsicle-pattern tie, and butterfly-pattern socks — professorial with a dash of Ms. Frizzle. It was an outfit selected for the pressures of his job, which could involve explaining statistics for a parent while discussing zoo animals with a 5-year-old. The work had been getting harder. Conversations about vaccine hesitancy that might have happened once a month were now happening two or three times a week. Rhetoric that had lurked in conspiracy-minded corners of the internet was now coming from the federal government.

In January, the Trump administration bypassed normal procedures and slashed the number of recommended childhood vaccines, a change that public health experts saw as a dangerous deviation from evidence-based practice. A judge struck down the new schedule, but last month, President Trump signed an executive order demanding that life-saving combined immunizations be separated. Vaccine confidence is lowest in the MAGAverse — 80 percent of Democrats report trusting immunizations, while only 48 percent of Republicans do — but the trend is visible even in Massachusetts. Bornstein couldn’t help but notice “We The People” tattooed on this mom’s forearm.

This conversation was a compromise. Many independent pediatrics practices had dismissal policies like the one this mom had come up against in Fall River. But amid these federal changes, some doctors wondered about the best tack. Should they double down? Should they allow parents wiggle room, given that the government was recommending one vaccine schedule and the American Academy of Pediatrics another?

Middleboro Pediatrics wouldn’t tell parents to go elsewhere if they didn’t vaccinate. They welcomed those families. When a nearby clinic formalized a dismissal policy earlier this year, Middleboro got a flood of new patients. “Almost like a practice of last resort,” said Martin Gross, one of Bornstein’s partners.

They did have some stipulations, though. One was a meet-and-greet, so the pediatricians could understand a parent’s concerns — but also just how far that fear had spread. “If I think your child’s got a bad infection, will you reject my recommendations for antibiotics? Are you going to reject my ability to do an adequate evaluation?” Bornstein said. “I need a level of trust that you’re coming here because you want my guidance. If you’re going to reject all of that upfront because you don’t trust anything about my incentives or my expertise, then this is not a match.”

Misleading averages, alienated families

On the face of it, everything might not look so dire for vaccines. Most parents report trusting childhood immunizations, and the most recent national coverage rate for the measles, mumps, rubella vaccine is 92 percent, a seemingly small drop from the 95 percent around which it hovered from 2015 to 2020.

Not too shabby, you might



PHOTOS BY LUCY LU FOR STAT

Dr. Aaron Bornstein at Middleboro Pediatrics in Lakeville. One of his patients received a vaccine (top).

say. Then again, 95 percent is the level of uptake needed to prevent outbreaks. More measles cases were recorded in the US in 2025 and 2026 than in the previous 24 years combined, leading to the first measles deaths in nearly a decade. “The average is not really representative,” explained Rochelle Walensky, former director of the Centers of Disease Control and Prevention. “I always say: Your head is in the fridge, your feet are in the oven, and on average, you’re fine.”

Take the measles outbreak that engulfed Spartanburg, S.C., from October to June. The state’s MMR vaccination rate was 94 percent. The county’s was 89 percent. But at the school linked to the first cases, only 17 percent of students had proof of required immunizations.

Like politics, disease risk is local: a vast public health problem that often fell to each doctor as an individual, no matter if each appointment was only supposed to last 15 minutes. “The amount of time and effort involved in dealing with these families became untenable,” said retired pediatrician Jesse Hackell, who has authored The American Academy of Pediatrics reports on vaccine hesitancy.

That is one argument for dismissal. Another is the contagion risk posed by having an unvaccinated child in a waiting room alongside infants and kids with immunodeficiencies. Yet another is to convey that getting your child vaccinated is the cornerstone of modern medicine and the best advice a pediatrician can give.

“Over 20 years, we probably only dismissed a handful of families — because drawing a line in the sand seems to indicate to most families how seriously we take this,” Hackell said.

But that could push away others who might’ve come around. “Families have been brave enough to come to health care, often feeling alienated from it, and then they get this coercive declaration, which then alienates them even more,” said

Julie Leask, professor at the University of Sydney.

Middleboro’s meet-and-greets were a middle ground. They were inconvenient — uncompensated conversations, longer than appointments. They could be frustrating. There were sometimes insults, even threats. Practices could be penalized for taking such patients. Vaccination rates are among the metrics on which insurers measure physicians’ success.

Then again, dismissal is unenforceable for any Massachusetts physician who sees patients on Medicaid. But Middleboro’s reasoning was mostly philosophical. Kids don’t choose their families; vaccine-hesitant parents are not a single bloc. Taking this unpaid time, Bornstein hoped, might even help persuade some to vaccinate once there was a sense of trust.

“We don’t kick people out. We work with people,” he told that mother, who asked not to be named in this article. “The one thing I will say is this. If we have a family who chooses not to vaccinate, there’s a form that we have you sign that just says we had that conversation. It helps protect us from liability.”

“Understandable. In case something did happen and she did get something that a vaccine could have ...” she paused, “postponed, or, you know... prevented.”

She laughed, as if the idea were absurd. Bornstein didn’t correct her. “That’s exactly it,” he said, going on: “So whooping cough and measles are both very contagious diseases —”

She interrupted him: “Yeah, but it’s not just the measles vaccine, is it? It’s MMR.”

“It’s MMR,” he agreed. “But for those two, if a child has not been immunized by a certain age, we don’t let you in the waiting room, we room you directly from the car.”

She might have balked, or accused him of treating unvaccinated people as second-class citizens. There was still time for that. But now, all she said was, “OK.”

‘I want my child healthy’

Bornstein could still feel the horror, over 25 years later. He was a medical resident in Chicago, working in the emergency room, when an unvaccinated infant arrived. The trouble was an abscess on the child’s neck, swollen, red. This wasn’t an illness that would have been prevented by a vaccine, but Bornstein could detect a through line of distrust. He needed to admit the kid, do blood tests, and start antibiotics, but the parents refused. Bornstein wasn’t sure what to do. Without treatment, the illness could be fatal. Treating against the parents’ wishes would entail calling authorities and requesting an emergency removal.

That was the sort of scenario he hoped to avert with these meet-and-greets. In that case, the conflict was resolved without child protective services. “An older, sager ER physician asked, ‘Is this their first kid?’” Bornstein recalled. “I said, ‘Yeah.’ He said, ‘Have them call the grandparents’ — and the grandparents made the kid stay in the hospital.”

The worry he had about mistrust extending beyond vaccines wasn’t just theoretical. More parents are now refusing the routine vitamin K shot to help newborns’ blood clot, leading to an uptick in hemorrhages.

“I got her vitamin K shot in the hospital because I’m not dumb. I want my child healthy,” the mother told Bornstein. “But I was like, can’t I just do the preservative-free one?” To her, the fact that they made shots without preservatives seemed like proof that the normal shots had unnecessary ingredients. She worried about those chemicals. But she also worried about seeming stupid for worrying, or being judged a negligent parent. She’d hated how the nurses made her feel bad for refusing the first dose of the hepatitis B vaccine.

She was 29, a truck driver living in a former shipping hub in Southeastern Massachusetts. “I was actually in school to be a

doctor. I started college at 16,” she told Bornstein.

“You are someone who clearly pays attention to detail,” he said. “You’ll be the right person for our practice, I think.” He started gesticulating as he described the vaccine schedule, how whooping cough was most dangerous under the age of 1, which meant it was important for that vaccine to be given in infancy.

“But at the same time, everyone’s body is different,” the mother said. “You could have a majority of people that react perfectly fine to it, but there’s still going to be people that probably don’t react fine to it. But what happens if they just didn’t test those people?”

Bornstein smiled. Now he was getting somewhere. He wanted parents to bring up their specific concerns, something he could engage with. If they wouldn’t tell him what they were worried about, there was little he could do. He explained that her question was one scientists had to address in designing vaccine trials: Did they have enough people enrolled to look for those rare side effects? Last year, for instance, there’d been a big Danish study of data from 1.2 million people over 24 years; it showed that the conditions vaccine-skeptical groups often blamed on immunizations — autism, say — were no more common in the vaccinated group than in the unvaccinated.

The mom piped up. “I just feel it’s weird. Like my baby’s healthy. Why am I gonna then inject her with stuff?”

“It’s a great question,” Bornstein said. “Our job for you is to help interpret risk and benefit, right?”

He was a father himself, he said. He wouldn’t recommend anything that he wouldn’t give his own kid. He wanted to talk through the risks and benefits of every vaccine with her — yes, the risks, because vaccines, like medications, could indeed have side effects, and she should know about them — while also weighing that against what might happen if her child caught

a preventable disease that she hadn’t been vaccinated against. But the choice would always be hers.

“I don’t have the authority to do anything to your child, right? I have the authority to give you advice,” he said. “We encourage vaccines. But it’s equally important that you feel comfortable with why we’re doing it, and that the risks are low enough. Your question: Why would we give it to a healthy kid? You know, the silly analogy is, it doesn’t help putting the seat belt in after the car crash has happened.”

Statistical risks, anecdotal anxieties

The example that always jumped to mind for Bornstein was an earlier version of the rotavirus vaccine, first recommended as a routine immunization in 1998, to prevent tens of thousands of infants needing to be hospitalized for severe, potentially life-threatening diarrhea annually. But doctors noticed an uptick in a condition called intussusception in which one bit of intestine slides inside another, like the segments of a pirate’s telescope. A study found the increase was linked to the vaccine, and it was taken off the market in 1999.

Newer rotavirus vaccines are now available. They’re associated with a slight increase in intussusception risk, but that risk is a sliver of what it had been for the earlier vaccine, and the benefit was thought to outweigh it: Per one Australian study’s estimation, the vaccine might be linked to 14 cases of intussusception a year, but would prevent 6,500 gastroenteritis hospitalizations.

This mom was generally worried about undisclosed or undiscovered risks, but this episode hadn’t come to her attention. Her anxiety came from a more recent anecdote she’d heard.

Bornstein was explaining that the rotavirus vaccine was oral, that the disease had once been a leading cause of hospitalization in infants, that it caused severe vomiting and diarrhea and —

But then the mom interjected: “I don’t like that it’s oral. She chokes on her damn formula, I don’t need her choking on a vaccine.”

“It’s like 1 milliliter. It’s tiny.”

“My friend’s son just had that and choked on it. The nurse grabbed him from her and had to sit there and smack his back like crazy.”

“I would say that has not been our experience. Some of it ...”

“That was in Maine, though.” “Some of it is how you administer it. If you put a dropper in the back of the throat, it’s like putting a turkey baster in the back of your throat. You’re going to gag. You have to tuck it in the cheek.”

She kept telling this story, even as he explained that this had more to do with how that nurse had given the vaccine rather than the formulation itself, that pediatricians used to see a ton of kids hospitalized with rotavirus but now it was much rarer because of these newer vaccines.

Eventually, the discussion quieted down and moved on. She had a few insurance questions. Then it was time for her to go. She picked up the carrier, and headed out to the car.

Not everyone who did a meet-and-greet came back. Some didn’t want to talk so much about vaccines and stormed out. Others never called to book a first appointment. Bornstein walked down the hall back toward his desk, past patients’ artwork: a painting of stick figures with what looked like flowers for hands, a Thanksgiving drawing expressing gratitude for the existence of chorizo. He wasn’t sure whether this mother would enroll her daughter as a patient. But if he had to guess, he’d be seeing her soon.

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Clancy retrial would face challenge finding jurors

Notoriety of case creates problems, experts say; impartiality is key

By Chris Van Buskirk
GLOBE STAFF
and Bryan Hecht
and Chloe Craft
GLOBE CORRESPONDENTS

PLYMOUTH — While District Attorney Timothy Cruz hasn’t said whether he’ll push for a retrial in the Lindsay Clancy case, if prosecutors and defense attorneys meet in a courtroom again, they’re likely to undertake a “painstaking” process to find 12 people to decide the case, legal experts said. It’s possible another group of 12 men and women could serve as impartial jurors, experts say, even after the case crescendoed into a national media

circus. A person can know about a case and still not have an opinion about it, they say. But finding a new jury of Plymouth County residents who would endure weeks of grueling testimony and evidence — including Patrick Clancy’s 911 call and autopsy photos of the three Clancy children — could make the task even more difficult. And would a potential retrial take place in Plymouth County? These are some of the unknowns left lingering after a Plymouth County Superior Court judge declared a mistrial Friday after jurors deliberated for 37 hours over three first-degree murder

charges in the deaths of Clancy’s children — Cora, 5, Dawson, 3, and Callan, 8 months. If a retrial does occur, attorneys on both sides will closely screen potential jurors for whether they can maintain impartiality despite what they know about the case, said Thomas Drechsler, a retired Superior Court judge. “The process of selecting a jury is a painstaking process in which the lawyers and the judge examine the jurors to make sure that they could put aside anything they’ve read or heard and be open-minded,” Drechsler said Saturday. “I would expect a detailed inquiry

CLANCY, Page B4

‘The process of selecting a jury is a painstaking process in which the lawyers and the judge examine the jurors to make sure that they could ... be open-minded.’

THOMAS DRECHSLER,
retired Superior Court judge

A SLICE OF YESTERYEAR



DANIELLE PARHIZKARAN/GLOBE STAFF

An idyllic scene at the Public Garden as Swan Boat passengers floated by people relaxing onshore. Next year will mark the 150th anniversary of the iconic Boston tradition. The enterprise has been run by the same family since 1877. **B2**

‘Something is not right in this collection of cases and I don’t know exactly where the malingering odor is coming from.’

PROVIDENCE COUNTY SUPERIOR COURT JUDGE MELISSA E. DARIGAN

As lawsuits plague R.I.’s ‘The Conjuring’ house, judge suggests cases should be consolidated

By Christopher Gavin
GLOBE STAFF

PROVIDENCE — The lawsuits plaguing “The Conjuring” house have become so complicated that a Rhode Island judge last week called them “a mess” and suggested that they all be brought before a single judge. “Something does not smell right,” Providence County Superior Court Judge Melissa E. Darigan said during a hearing on Tuesday. “Something is not right in this collection of cases and I don’t know exactly where the malingering odor is coming from.”

The 18th-century Burrillville farmhouse at 1677 Round Top Road was made famous by “The Conjuring” horror movie franchise. It has been entangled in a web of legal actions filed in Rhode Island and Massachusetts after Jacqueline Nuñez, who owned the supposedly haunted house through her company, Bale Fire LLC, defaulted on her mortgage last year. The loan was later purchased from Needham Bank by YouTuber Elton Casteo through his Summit & Stone LLC. But the bank alleges that it mistakenly discharged the mortgage after

the sale. A lawsuit filed by Needham Bank brought the saga back into court last week. Also involved in this lawsuit is Jason Hawes, the Rhode Island-based star of the SyFy television series “Ghost Hunters.” He is listed as an interested party because Nuñez signed an agreement to sell the property to Hawes in December 2025. Hawes filed a warranty deed for the house in June. But in court on Tuesday, Darigan denied a motion filed by Hawes that sought to compel Summit & Stone to

issue a payoff statement so Hawes could pay the remaining mortgage balance. The motion was denied without prejudice, meaning it could be filed again. Darigan said she is “extremely concerned” and suggested several cases surrounding the property be assigned to a single judge who could better keep tabs on “all of the different tentacles.” “This case and all the affiliated cases are a mess,” she said. There are “too many open ques-

HOUSE, Page B4

State Police to resume training

Academy reforming after injuries, death of recruit in 2024

By Allyson Chiu
GLOBE STAFF
and Aayushi Datta
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Massachusetts State Police will resume training recruits next month after delaying the start of this year’s class to launch a sweeping overhaul of its academy following the death of a recruit two years ago. The State Police plans to welcome its 93rd cadet class Oct. 26 — after an originally scheduled June start date — amid ongoing efforts to address the findings of an independent review released earlier this year that described an “overwhelmingly punitive” environment at the academy. The law enforcement agency also announced Friday that it has hired an outside consulting firm to oversee the extensive changes to its training approach. The department recognizes the “need for urgent training reform,” State Police Colonel Geoffrey Noble said in a statement. “Public safety depends on the Massachusetts State Police Academy’s ability to train the next generation of Troopers and prepare them for a fulfilling career in law enforcement,” Noble said. The decision to begin training this year comes as the law enforcement agency seeks to implement all 103 recommendations made by the International Association of Chiefs of Police in its May assessment, which found that recruits have experienced excessive physical exertion, harassment, and intimidation at the academy. The wide-reaching recommendations aim to change how recruits are trained, with an emphasis on curriculum, leadership, trainee wellness, safety, and accountability. The department said the reforms are intended to create a more consistent and evidence-based training environment and better prepare recruits for the challenges of modern policing. PFM Group Consulting, a national consulting firm based in Philadelphia, will act as an independent monitor and provide public annual reports on the department’s progress for five years, Noble said. The consulting group has worked with law enforcement agencies around the country, including in D.C. and Oakland, Calif.

STATE POLICE, Page B4

Allergy season isn’t letting up anytime soon

By Ken Mahan
GLOBE STAFF

If you’ve spent much of this summer rubbing your eyes and wondering why your allergies seem to have gone completely off the rails, you’re not imagining it. This has been a rough allergy year across Greater Boston and much of New England, and it doesn’t look like we’re quite done with those pesky allergies just yet. The late-summer-to-fall allergies have now kicked into high gear, and the surge in weed pollen is the main offender — think ragweed and plants like sagebrush. How did we get here? We didn’t really start with a bang. Spring actually got off to a cooler start, which delayed the initial release of tree pollen. Then after an early visit to 90-degree weather in mid-May, the trees essentially hit the accelerator. We didn’t experience a gradual pollen release, but an explosion of pollen in a shorter window. This means we saw excessive tree pollen overlapping with the release of grass pollen. Dr. Paul J. Maglione, an allergist-immunologist at Boston Medical Center, says the delayed start was widely noticeable. “This spring’s pollen season

ALLERGIES, Page B5

INSIDE

One dead, 7 hurt in Taunton shooting

Police are investigating a shooting Sunday at a house party in Taunton that left one person dead and seven others injured, police said in a statement. **B2**

Nahant blocks NU

The state’s highest court has ruled against Northeastern University’s bid to expand its Marine Science Center on coastal land in Nahant, saying the town was within its rights to use eminent domain to block the development. **B2**

Holiday closings

Monday is Labor Day. For a list of what’s open and closed, **B2**



JOHN TLUMACKI/GLOBE STAFF

A FEATHERED REFLECTION — A laughing gull cast a mirror image of itself in a puddle left by overnight rain on Castle Island in South Boston last month.

Swan Boats end another season Monday

By Sam Shipman
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Dozens of people lined up to take one of the last rides on the iconic Swan Boats on Sunday at the Public Garden lagoon, before the 2026 season ends on Monday.

Bill Garrity, from the North Shore, who was among the throng waiting to board, said he was here for the nostalgia. The last time he was on a Swan Boat was back in 2009.

“It’s ending tomorrow; you almost forget about it until you come into town,” Garrity said. “It’s just tranquil. It’s like nothing else.”

The sun peeked in and out of the clouds, providing the occasional glow to the lagoon and the weeping willows beside it. Over a dozen Swan Boat workers ushered people who were celebrating the end of summer to their feathered vessels.

Lyn Paget, one of the owners and operators of the Swan Boats, was already gearing up for next season: the Swan Boats’ 150th anniversary.

“We’re super excited; next year is a big milestone,” Paget said.

“We’re looking forward to celebrating that anniversary.”

Paget is the fourth generation of the Paget family, which has owned and operated the Swan Boats since 1877.

“This was started by my great-grandfather in 1877. He then quickly passed away from tuberculosis, and so my great-grandmother, Julia Paget, took the helm in 1878, which is a pretty remarkable thing,” Paget said. “So I’ve been digging into the history and learning more about her and what Boston was like during that time, and it was a pretty exciting place.”

Instead of making the anniversary a one-day celebration, Paget and other leaders are planning a “season of celebration,” Paget said.

“These are the only boats of their kind in the world, as far as we know, and we have three boats that are over 100 years old and still in operation,” Paget said. “This is a great part and cultural amenity in the city of Boston.”

Sam Shipman can be reached at sam.shipman@globe.com.



DANIELLE PARHIZKARAN/GLOBE STAFF

A Swan Boat floated under the Public Garden Foot Bridge on Sunday as people lined up for a ride before the final day of the season on Monday.

One dead, seven injured in Taunton house shooting

By Katie Cressman and Collin Robisheaux
GLOBE CORRESPONDENTS

Police are investigating an early morning shooting at a house party in Taunton that left one person dead and seven others injured, police said in a statement Sunday.

Around 12:35 a.m. Sunday, Taunton police received several reports of shots fired and that multiple people had been shot in the area of Weir and Sumner streets in Taunton, police said.

At the scene, officers located

eight gunshot victims, all in their early twenties, and determined the shooting took place in the yard of a home at 261 Weir St., police said.

One of the victims, 22-year-old Zirovick Depina of Brockton, was pronounced dead early Sunday morning, police said.

Police said one of the remaining seven victims is in serious but stable condition, and all other victims were hospitalized with non-life-threatening injuries.

Police did not say if any ar-

rests have been made.

Taunton Mayor Shaunna O’Connell released a statement on the shooting, stating that it appeared to be an isolated incident and that the investigation is ongoing.

“Our thoughts are with the victim, the families affected, and everyone who has been impacted,” the statement reads. “I want to assure residents that our Police Department, working with State Police and the Bristol County District Attorney’s Office, is actively investigating

what happened. At this time, there is no indication that this was anything other than an isolated incident, and there is no known ongoing threat to the broader community.”

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What’s open and closed on Labor Day

Holiday observed: Monday, Sept. 7
Retail stores: Open at owners’ discretion.
Liquor stores: Open at owners’ discretion.
Supermarkets: Open, except Costco.
Convenience stores: Open at owners’ discretion.
Taverns, bars: Open at owners’ discretion.
Banks: Closed.
Stock market: Closed.
Municipal, state, federal offices and courts: Closed.
RMV: Closed.
Libraries: Closed.
BCYF Community Centers: Closed.
Public Schools: Closed.
Mail: US post offices closed.
MBTA: Subways, buses, and The Ride will run on a Sunday schedule. Commuter rail lines will run on a weekend schedule. Hingham/Hull/Logan to Boston ferry will run on a Sunday schedule. All other ferries will run on a weekend schedule. For more information, visit <https://www.mnba.com/holidays>.
Boston traffic rules: Parking meters will be free with no time limit. All other parking rules apply.
Street cleaning: Daytime street cleaning is canceled. Overnight street cleaning will run on a normal schedule.
Trash/recycling collection: Collection may be delayed by one day and is neighborhood-specific. To monitor your neighborhood’s trash and recycling schedule, visit <https://www.boston.gov/trash-day-schedule>.

This day in history

Today is Monday, Sept. 7, the 250th day of 2026. There are 115 days left in the year.

Birthdays: Singer Gloria Gaynor is 83. Actor Julie Kavner is 76. Rock singer Chrissie Hynde (The Pretenders) is 75. Actor Corbin Bernsen is 72. Actor Michael Emerson is 72. Pianist-singer Michael Feinstein is 70. Singer-songwriter Diane Warren is 70. Actor J. Smith-Cameron is 69. Actor Toby Jones is 60. Actor-comedian Leslie Jones (TV: “Saturday Night Live”) is 59. Actor Evan Rachel Wood is 39. Olympic gold medal swimmer Ariarne Titmus is 26.

►In 1630, Massachusetts Bay Colony Governor John Winthrop announced the foundation of the town of Boston on the Shawmut peninsula.

►In 1774, rebel leaders in Worcester assumed government responsibilities after militia men ousted British Crown-appointed judges and officials from the county court.

►In 1775, the rebel ship Hannah captured the Unity, a British sloop loaded with naval stores and lumber, supplies that aided the rebels besieging British regulars holed up in Boston. The Hannah, a fishing and trade vessel owned by John Glover of

Marblehead, was considered the first ship of the nascent Continental Navy and the capture its first success. Its crew members were mostly fishermen angered by the decision of the British Parliament to prohibit them from fishing in the Atlantic.

►In 1813, during the War of 1812, the Troy (New York) Post newspaper first used the term “Uncle Sam” to refer to the United States; the nickname was linked to a local meatpacker, Samuel Wilson, who supplied the US Army with beef.

►In 1822, Prince Regent Pedro of Braganza declared Brazil’s independence from Portugal. (Portugal formally recognized Brazil’s independence in 1825.)

►In 1901, the Boxer Rebellion, an attempt to expel foreigners from China involving clashes with a multinational force that included troops from Japan, Russia, Britain, and the United States, ended with a protocol calling for reparations to the foreign powers.

►In 1921, the first Miss America Pageant was held in Atlantic City, N.J.

►In 1940, Nazi Germany began an intense bombing campaign of Britain during World War II with an air attack on Lon-

don; known as The Blitz, the eight-month campaign resulted in more than 40,000 civilian deaths.

►In 1943, a fire at the Gulf Hotel, a rooming house in Houston, claimed 55 lives.

►In 1963, the Pro Football Hall of Fame opened in Canton, Ohio, and enshrined its first 17 members.

►In 1977, the Panama Canal Treaty, which called for the United States to turn over control of the waterway to Panama at the end of 1999, was signed in Washington by US President Jimmy Carter and Panamanian leader Omar Torrijos.

►In 1986, Bishop Desmond Tutu was installed as the first Black clergyman to lead the Anglican Church in southern Africa.

►In 1996, rapper Tupac Shakur was shot and mortally wounded on the Las Vegas Strip; he died six days later.

►In 2005, police and soldiers went house to house in New Orleans to try to coax remaining residents into leaving the city shattered by Hurricane Katrina.

►In 2021, El Salvador became the first country in the world to make Bitcoin legal tender.

Nahant wins legal challenge to block Northeastern’s campus expansion

By Camilo Fonseca
GLOBE STAFF

The state’s highest court has ruled against Northeastern University’s bid to expand its Marine Science Center on coastal land in Nahant, saying the town was within its rights to use eminent domain to block the development.

The ruling by the Supreme Judicial Court last week reversed a 2024 appeals court decision in favor of Northeastern, which found that the town had “no reasonable expectation” the university would ultimately dedicate land for public use as an ecological preserve.

“It is for a town to decide if and when to take property for proper conservation and open space purposes, and such a taking may not appear warranted so long as a private landowner leaves open space undeveloped,” Supreme Judicial Court Justice Elizabeth Dewar wrote in the decision released Thursday.

The ruling also ends an eight-year legal battle between the North Shore town and the university, which has operated its marine research center there since the 1960s.

Town officials in Nahant celebrated the ruling, which they said would preserve the land’s open character and its recreation and conservation uses.

“The Town looks forward to moving forward with this process,” town administrator Alison Nieto said in a statement.

Renata Nyul, a university spokesperson, said that Northeastern was “deeply disappointed” by the decision, “given the evidence of improper motive.” She added that, should the land be taken, there could be a “devastating impact” on the university’s ability to conduct “cutting-edge research” to benefit Nahant and other coastal communities.

“We hope today’s judgment will prompt town officials to pursue a collaborative path forward before Nahant taxpayers bear the steep cost of eminent domain,” she said last week.

The university first announced plans to expand its marine science center in 2018 by building a 55,000-square-foot addition on an undeveloped part of the property. The decision drew fierce opposition

from local advocates, who argued it would ruin the natural beauty of the town’s East Point peninsula; Northeastern owns most of the area, while the town owns the easternmost tip.

In 2021, the town’s Board of Selectmen moved to take 12.5 acres of undeveloped land on East Point by eminent domain, in an effort to block the construction project. Northeastern filed a legal challenge, arguing that the land was being taken in bad faith.

But in Thursday’s ruling, Dewar wrote that “the town’s stated purpose for the taking is a proper public purpose.”

“Contrary to Northeastern’s argument, preserving or enhancing the scenic character of an area is a valid public purpose,” she wrote.

Northeastern also argued that the taking of land was influenced by private actors in the town who stood to benefit from blocking the campus expansion. But the court cited a deference to the select board’s “legislative judgments.”

“As we have already discussed, a town’s exercise of its eminent domain authority is a legislative act and as such is entitled to a presumption of validity,” Dewar wrote.

The court also found that Nahant’s use of eminent domain was not merely a pretext for other action — unlike a previous case cited by Northeastern — because even before the dispute, the town had long expressed its intention to keep the land in question undeveloped.

“There is no material dispute that the taking in fact will be used for the town’s stated public purpose,” Dewar wrote.

In the 1960s, Northeastern acquired about 20 acres that had been used for military purposes since World War II and into the late 1950s. In 1964, Nahant residents voted against buying the main parcel, but in the 1970s they obtained more than eight acres of former military property that is now Henry Cabot Lodge Park.

In 1966, Northeastern opened the marine research center and in 2018 announced plans to expand it by 55,000 square feet, drawing sharp opposition.

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The Boston Globe

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Lottery

SUNDAY MIDDAY	5484
Payoffs (based on a \$1 bet)	
EXACT ORDER	
All 4 digits	\$3,925
First or last 3	\$549
Any 2 digits	\$47
Any 1 digit	\$5
ANY ORDER	
All 4 digits	\$327
First 3	\$91
Last 3	\$183
SUNDAY NIGHT	3876
Payoffs (based on a \$1 bet)	
EXACT ORDER	
All 4 digits	\$5,178
First or last 3	\$725
Any 2 digits	\$62
Any 1 digit	\$6
ANY ORDER	
All 4 digits	\$216
First 3	\$121
Last 3	\$121
MILLIONAIRE FOR LIFE	
Sept. 05	08-22-24-38-58
Millionaire Ball 03	
Jackpot: \$1 million a year for life ; winners	

MASS CASH		
Sept. 06	04-19-21-26-31	
<i>Jackpot: \$100,000; one winner</i>		
MEGABUCKS		
Sept. 06	02-09-12-23-31-34	
<i>Jackpot: \$29.7 million; winners</i>		
PREVIOUS DRAWINGS		
	Midday	Night
Saturday	9129	5562
Friday	0034	7110
Thursday	1822	2966
Wednesday	7701	0554
Tuesday	6069	5205
WEEKEND NUMBERS AROUND NEW ENGLAND		
Sun. Maine, N.H., Vermont		
Day: 3-digit	566	4-digit 8233
Eve: 3-digit	425	4-digit 9950
Rhode Island		
Sunday	1484	
Saturday's Powerball		
15-40-47-53-59		
Powerball 09		
<i>Jackpot: \$190 million; winners</i>		

EAR FOR THE MUSIC

— David Curran and his wife, Cindy, sat at the back of Midway Cafe in Jamaica Plain as Mystical Misfits, a Boston-based jam band, played a rendition of “Deal” by the Grateful Dead. The cafe often hosts “Hippie Hour” on Friday nights, as well as other events.



MELECK ELDAHSHOURY FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

‘Unusually aggressive’ animal attacks multiple people in N.H., police say

By Bryan Hecht
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

An “unusually aggressive” wild animal believed to be a fisher or a gray fox attacked multiple people near a park in Lebanon, N.H., in recent days, according to police.

Three attacks have been reported since last week, with the latest coming last Monday night, police said.

The first person attacked was taken to a hospital, Police Chief

Phillip Roberts said by email. A second victim was able to kick the animal away before being bitten or scratched.

Witnesses said that either a fox or fisher had “displayed unusually aggressive behavior toward people,” according to police.

Officers “have not personally observed or encountered the animal, and therefore we cannot confirm what type of animal is involved,” police said.

Video shared by police shows the animal running across a parking lot and attacking someone who was approaching their vehicle. The person jumped and backed away, but the animal continued to charge.

At one point, the animal became tangled up in the person’s feet, and they kicked it off, sending it flying a few feet across the lot.

Police cautioned the public not to approach, feed, or try to

capture the animal. Roberts said they have not yet located or identified it.

Residents, employees, and visitors to the area around Centerra Park should be aware of their surroundings, especially when walking near wooded or brush-covered areas, police said.

People should seek safety and notify officials if they see a fox, fisher, or other wild animal approaching people or behaving in an unusual and aggressive man-

ner, police added.

Officials also shared information on how to deal with rabies exposure, but did not confirm if the animal is considered rabid.

No additional information on injuries caused by the attacks was immediately available.

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Officers ‘have not personally observed or encountered the animal, and therefore ... cannot confirm what type of animal is involved.’



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Jury choice would be tricky in 2nd Clancy trial, experts say

►CLANCY
Continued from Page B1

of any prospective jurors.”

In the post-trial media scrum Friday afternoon, Clancy’s defense attorney, Kevin Reddington, said he doubted it would be possible to find a juror in a retrial who was unaware of the Clancy case. But that wouldn’t disqualify them from serving on a jury, he said.

“We have faith in the impanelment process,” Reddington said. “We ask the jurors under their oath if they have heard about the case, or know about the case. Obviously in this case, they will. ... They still are able to be good jurors if they feel they don’t have an opinion that would deprive the person of a fair trial.”

Julia Hanson, 28, said many people in Plymouth could serve as impartial jurors even though a mass of media attended Clancy’s trial.

“Just because you’ve heard something does not mean that you know what’s happened in the case,” Hanson, who lives in Plymouth, said Friday.

Juries in high-profile cases also typically face scrutiny, and their identities often become the subject of public fascination. That was the case in the two trials to determine whether Karen Read killed her boyfriend, Boston police Officer John O’Keefe. She was ultimately acquitted last year.

In Clancy’s case, the names of the nine women and three men who found themselves deadlocked are likely to remain a secret, the Globe has reported.

But their identities nonetheless became an issue during the trial after a Sutton woman was accused of using her cellphone to video jurors after they left the courthouse.



JOSEPH PREZIOSO/AFP VIA GETTY IMAGES

Dawn Light, charged with witness intimidation, was arraigned during the Lindsay Clancy trial in Plymouth last week.

Bella Levine, a 24-year-old living in Plymouth, said she would fear the public scrutiny that would accompany serving on a jury for a potential second Clancy trial.

“That would be a bit scary,” she said, especially “knowing what people might say or do if they knew you were on it.”

Levine said she followed the case and was struck by how those involved were thrust into the public eye. In Plymouth, she added, “everyone’s talking about it.”

It’s also unlikely that a second Clancy trial would move out

of Plymouth County, though her defense team could make a motion to change the trial’s location or bring in jurors from other parts of the state if they are concerned that attention to the case could imperil impartiality.

Janice Bassil, a criminal defense attorney in Boston, said judges are “notoriously reluctant to move trials,” and whoever oversees a potential second trial for Clancy is likely to find that “this case had such widespread publicity, it doesn’t matter what county you’re in.”

“Although you can move to

change venue, I really don’t see that happening,” Bassil said in an interview Saturday.

Drechsler said Clancy could waive her right to a jury in the location where the alleged crimes occurred. But a judge would need to agree, and prosecutors could weigh in on the matter, he said.

“The only times I’ve seen that procedure employed is in ... high-profile cases where there’s a concern as to whether or not you could get a group of independent-minded ... jurors, notwithstanding the publicity,”

Drechsler said.

In Read’s second trial, attorneys did not make a motion to move the case despite the widespread media attention it received, including on individual jurors in her first trial.

But Drechsler pointed to the 2012 retrial for a man accused of killing four people in Mattapan two years earlier.

In that case, a jury from Worcester County was bused in after defense lawyers had argued for a change in venue to ensure a fair trial after the killings “shocked Boston and generated

headlines,” the Globe reported at the time.

The judge, the Globe reported, said fairness could be ensured by bringing in jurors from another part of the state.

“The other way of doing it is to move the trial to a courthouse in that other county. And again, in my view, the defendant would have to waive her right to a jury from the county in which the ... alleged conduct occurred,” Drechsler said.

Lawyers for Dzhokhar Tsarnaev, the man convicted in the 2013 Boston Marathon bombing, unsuccessfully tried to change the location of his federal trial because of concerns that an impartial jury could not be empaneled in Boston.

The trial of Matthew Farwell, the Stoughton police detective accused of killing Sandra Birchmore, a young pregnant woman at the time of her death, is scheduled to be held in Massachusetts next month after a judge rejected a request to move proceedings to Rhode Island because of “prejudicial” news coverage.

Bassil said even if you could find jurors who know nothing about a high-profile case like Clancy’s, a prosecutor or defense attorney may not want them empaneled.

“Does that mean they just don’t pay attention to the news?” Bassil said. “Do you want people who are so completely oblivious to what’s going on in the world? I don’t know.”

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State Police in ongoing efforts to revamp training academy

►STATE POLICE
Continued from Page B1

Dan Linskey, a law enforcement consultant and former Boston police superintendent-in-chief, said the State Police’s decision to work with the firm over the five-year period is a sign that the department appears committed to making changes.

“The fact that they’ve engaged them for a five-year program shows that it’s not just that we’re checking a box and had somebody come in and say we did something and then go away,” said Linskey, who leads the global law enforcement practice at Kroll, a consulting company. “You can’t change culture overnight, especially police culture.”

The consulting group will assess the department’s progress and examine outcomes, including recruit attrition, injuries, and performance.

Seth Williams, who heads the firm’s law enforcement practice, and Ronal Serpas, a former police chief in New Orleans, Nashville, and Washington State, and now a professor at Loyola University New Orleans, will lead the team.

Serpas is known in the law enforcement community for leading police reforms, Linskey said.

“Any team that he’s associated with has got a proven track record of doing good things in other police departments,” he said.

The ongoing reckoning of the State Police’s training academy was largely sparked by the death of Enrique Delgado-Garcia, 25,



ERIN CLARK/GLOBE STAFF/FILE

Massachusetts State Police and recruits at a funeral home during visiting hours for Trooper Enrique Delgado-Garcia in 2024.

who suffered critical head injuries while participating in a boxing exercise during training in September 2024. An autopsy report found that blunt-force trauma caused hemorrhaging in Delgado-Garcia’s skull. Four academy instructors have been indicted on involuntary manslaughter charges. They were all suspended from the agency and have pleaded not guilty.

A Globe investigation in 2025 found that the State Police had a history of using a military-style boot camp system at its academy that often pushed recruits physically and emotionally to their limits. At least 100 recruits were injured in just the four most recent training classes, with at least two dozen ending up in the hospital or urgent care, the investigation found.

Critics, including some former recruits and troopers, have said the training approach could have lasting repercussions on policing and how officers engage with the public.

They highlighted several recent scandals weathered by the department, such as schemes to steal overtime pay and illegally sell commercial driver’s licenses, as well as financial fraud within

the troopers union. The department has also faced scrutiny of its handling of high-profile cases, including a case involving Karen Read, who was acquitted in June of charges that she murdered her boyfriend, in part because of discoveries of State Police incompetence in the probe.

Following the independent review, the department identified about two dozen improve-

ments, which largely concerned the training environment and daily practices at the academy, that had to be addressed before recruits could return. Work on longer-term changes involving leadership, professional culture, trainee wellness, and safety, among others, needed to be underway before training resumed.

The department has developed curriculum, policy, and new civilian leadership roles that serve to create “a more consistent, supportive, accountable, and evidence-informed training model” for this year’s recruits, Noble said in Friday’s statement. The academy’s updates are aligned with “national best practices,” he said.

Linskey said he hopes the wide-reaching changes attract more people to want to become recruits and complete their training. He noted that he had a family member resign from the academy in recent years after being “hazed and injured” during training.

“That was a young man who would have loved to have been a state police officer,” he said. “I’m glad that reforms are happening and that’s not going to happen to anyone else’s family member again.”

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Sean Cotter and Lea Skene of the Globe staff contributed to this report.*

Judge says ‘Conjuring’ house cases are a mess as suits pile up

►HOUSE
Continued from Page B1

tions,” Darigan said. Hawes’s ties to the property have not been determined by a court, and it’s still unclear what Summit & Stone “is holding and what is owed,” she said.

“That [is] a fundamental issue that needs to be resolved,” Darigan said. “Is the deed from December a valid deed, and how do we go about consummating the sale completely?”

Hawes’s claims to the property have been challenged before.

Nuñez’s sister, Elizabeth Greenhalgh, of Utah, filed a lawsuit last year alleging Nuñez had been “experiencing serious

mental health issues” that impaired her judgment when she signed a warranty deed and power of attorney agreement last year authorizing Julia Demay, a woman described in court documents as her friend, to sell the property to Hawes for \$1.3 million. The complaint alleged Hawes was taking advantage of “Nuñez’s lack of legal capacity” for his own personal and financial gain.

Nicole M. Labonte, an attorney for Hawes, said earlier this year that a notary involved in preparing the documents in October 2025 later indicated she had not notarized the documents properly. Nuñez then signed a deed in December with

a different notary, Labonte said.

Greenhalgh’s lawsuit was dismissed in April, after a judge found she did not have legal standing. In an affidavit filed in August, Greenhalgh wrote Nuñez has maintained she did not sell the house to Hawes.

Greenhalgh had also petitioned the Suffolk County Probate and Family Court in Massachusetts to appoint her as Nuñez’s guardian and conservator so she could manage her sister’s affairs. On Tuesday, however, a stipulation was filed indicating Greenhalgh and other parties involved — including Nuñez and Demay — had agreed to drop the matter.

“It wasn’t sustainable,” Isaac

H. Peres, an attorney representing Demay, said Thursday.

Peres said a medical evaluation for Nuñez was not completed, and a required medical certificate was never filed.

“In the future, if they ever got a certificate, they can come back,” Peres said.

Court filings state Nuñez, who was listed as living in Dorchester, now resides in Utah. Attorneys for Nuñez and Greenhalgh did not return requests for comment.

Summit & Stone also accused Hawes of fraud and exploitation. Labonte, in court in Rhode Island on Tuesday, called those claims “defamatory.”

Summit & Stone filed a peti-

tion in January asking a court to place Bale Fire into receivership, a process similar to bankruptcy in state court, citing an outstanding balance on the mortgage of approximately \$1.2 million. A judge denied the motion in February.

On Tuesday, Vincent A. Indeglia, an attorney for Summit & Stone, said the company bought the house with the thought that “it was either going to get cash or it was going to get the property, one or the other.”

Darigan said she is “very skeptical about Summit & Stone’s motivations.”

“I don’t buy the arguments that they are concerned about liability to Bale Fire, or to Nu-

ñez, or to anybody else,” Darigan said. “... In a contested property situation, [it] seems to me that people would sit down, particularly a lender, would sit down and have a conversation That’s not happening.”

“Fundamental questions about who has what rights and what interests” need to be answered, Darigan concluded at the end of Tuesday’s hour-long hearing.

“Once that’s decided, I think some things can fall into place,” she said. “This case is a problem.”

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Two die in Ludlow plane crash

By Katie Cressman
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Two people died in a plane crash in Ludlow Saturday night, officials said.

Local and state authorities responded to the Ludlow area around 9 p.m. following a report of a missing aircraft, officials said. Around the same time, officials received reports of a low-flying aircraft that appeared to be in distress, with some callers hearing a crash, officials said.

A search of the area was conducted using a portable beacon receiver and drones, officials said, and the plane was located in a remote wooded ar-

ea off of Center Street.

At the scene of the crash, two victims were located and pronounced dead, officials said.

The Federal Aviation Administration and the National Transportation Safety Board were notified and are investigating, officials said.

The plane crashed in a swampy area with about 4 feet of water, according to the Massachusetts Department of Fire Services. Emergency responders put down planking to access the plane and retrieve the victims, officials said.

“Our thoughts are with the families of those lost in last night’s crash,” Ludlow Fire

Chief Ryan Pease said in a statement. “I also want to recognize the first responders who have been working tirelessly during this recovery mission.”

Emergency crews were still working to remove the plane from the crash site as of Sunday night, with the process expected to continue on Monday, officials said.

The names of the victims have not been released as of Sunday evening, and the investigation is ongoing.

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Allergy season may last into autumn

► **ALLERGIES**
Continued from Page B1

seemed to have a slightly delayed onset due to cooler temperatures early in the season. However, by late May, it had become quite intense, possibly because the pollen was released over a shorter period,” said Maglione. “Many of our patients experienced more severe symptoms than usual.”

This lines up. Once temperatures jumped across New England, pollen counts climbed quickly, with oak, birch, and maple as the major contributors.

“Tree pollen seemed to be particularly problematic this year,” said Maglione.

So, was this actually considered a bad year for allergy sufferers? I’d say yes — our weather has consistently produced warmer and muggier conditions, which keep pollen suspended and floating about. And that has remained the case as temperatures and humidity have remained elevated through the summer. This certainly has made this season feel considerably worse.

As we head into autumn, don’t expect a drop in allergies as we move deeper into the ragweed season, the dominant irri-

tant from late summer into fall.

We’re expected to see a bit of a warming trend across New England through September as the jet stream holds on to a northern track, allowing for warm air to build over our region more often.

In addition, we’ve had an overall very warm summer, actually a lock for the top 10 hottest summers for Boston, and the elevated temperatures will take more time to cool as the season changes, so we’ll naturally run warmer than normal as we begin September.

As these temperatures run above average, there’s a good chance we’ll again see allergies hang around longer than we would like.

“If trends from previous years continue, we can expect a longer fall pollen season, which could mean symptoms lasting later into the autumn for those sensitive to ragweed and other weed pollens,” said Maglione. One ragweed plant can produce up to 1 billion pollen grains, according to the Asthma and Allergy Foundation of America.

Sure, rain can temporarily knock pollen out of the air, but we’ve seen a very dry August across the region, so that doesn’t help things much.

The expected warm, mostly dry — and breezy — weather will continue to keep the pollen abundant over the next few weeks.

Boston’s growing season is getting longer as the climate continues to warm, which means that allergies stick around longer. In short, warmer temperatures allow plants to grow, flower, and produce pollen for longer periods.

Boston has seen allergies last over two weeks longer than they did in 1970, according to data from Climate Central.

And it’s not just Boston; nearly all of New England has seen the allergy season expand at both ends.

Warmer springs can get some plants producing pollen earlier, while warmer autumns allow plants such as ragweed, which starts flourishing during the summer, to keep producing pollen until the first frost.

So, unfortunately, it doesn’t seem that the allergy “season” is ready to call it quits just yet. We’ll have to wait a couple of months for that.

Ken Mahan can be reached at ken.mahan@globe.com. Follow him on Instagram @kenmahantheweatherman.



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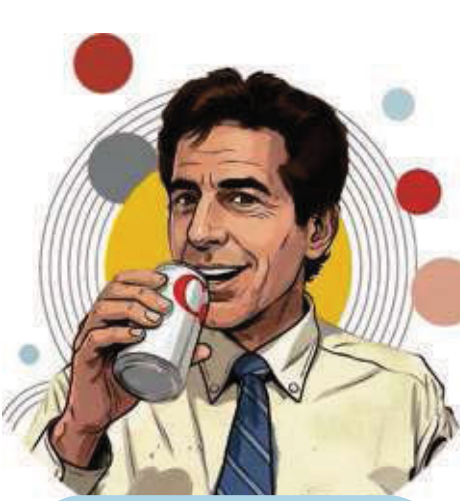


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LivingArts

By Daisy Levine
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

It was only about 15 minutes before Adam Wilson’s son, Logan, had a “melt-down” at Boston Comic Con about 10 years ago. They tried again, taking a lap around Seaport, then returned to the annual pop culture convention, now known as Fan Expo Boston. Logan only lasted another 10 minutes. Wilson reluctantly took his family home.

But Wilson had a hunch. There’s no way Logan is the only one who struggles with the event’s overwhelming nature, he thought.

His suspicion became Calmer Con, a sensory-friendly alternative to Comic Con, first presented in 2018. Its name is a nod to its accommodations for the neurodivergent community and brings “nerd culture,” as Wilson puts it, into a less overwhelming atmosphere. Wilson says he launched the calm-oriented event for kids like his son, who are fans of superheroes, comics, science fiction, and pop culture — but also have specific social needs.

This year’s free convention, presented by Wilson’s event accommodations nonprofit Calm Passion and the Boston Comic Arts Foundation, will be held on Sept. 12 at the Meadowbrook School in Weston. In addition to cosplay, booths and other interactive activities, this year’s guests will include graphic novelist and illustrator Ellen T. Crenshaw and cartoonist Judd Winick.

Wilson originally began work on the event after he had contacted the organizers of large-scale conventions targeting fans like Logan to ask about sensory spaces — rooms designed to calm overstimulated persons — at their events. He was told they don’t exist.

“One of the greatest joys of my existence is to be able to get this thing up and running,” Wilson, who now develops sensory-friendly spaces for other conventions through his nonprofit, said. “We connect on so many different levels with people.”

He says he loves when parents see different sides of their children, like: “I’ve never seen my kid sit still for more than 15 minutes.” Or, once, during a game of Star Wars-themed tee-ball, a father had told him, “This is the most athletic thing my son has ever done.”

“It’s a great way for parents and kids to connect on something that they might not otherwise,” he said.

The father, who played baseball growing up, never thought he could share his love of the sport with his son, Wilson recalls. He says the son went on to play youth baseball after his visit to Calmer Con.

Brendan Mahan, a member of Calmer Con’s board of directors and a keynote speaker this year, said there’s a demand for neurodivergent space at pop culture conventions.

“It’s really significant to be at this event where people who don’t feel like they fit in anywhere [can] fit in,” said Mahan, adding he often sees an overlap between those with intense special interests — to the level of spending an entire day at a convention dedicated to the interest — and people who are neurodiverse.

Mahan, an ADHD researcher who has ADHD, said it’s also an excellent opportunity for parents to find community.

It’s a day for the parents, too, he said, noting information on resources like ADHD consultants, expert functioning coaches, tutoring services, and mental health clinicians are part of the convention programming.



PHOTOS BY LAUREN MILLER

Scenes (above and below) from a previous edition of Calmer Con, a sensory-friendly pop culture and comics convention.

A sensory-friendly Comic Con, born from one father’s hunch



“When I was a kid, you couldn’t let your geek flag fly,” he said. “But now you can.”

At Calmer Con, Mahan continued, kids can find a much-needed community, and he encourages parents to allow their child to explore just how “geeky” they can get.

“With the world being difficult like it is, it’s nice that there’s a place that’s not that,” Mahan said. “Even if it’s only for a day.”

Stacy Berndt, who first attended as a parent and is now a volunteer, says Calmer Con means the world to her superhero-loving son, Andrew, who’s on the autism spectrum.

“It’s such a needed thing, and it’s such an ap-

preciated thing,” she said. “Unless you’ve been down that route, you don’t understand how needed it is.”

There’s accessibility everywhere at conventions, she said, but often those focus on mobility accommodations, not ones that address needs that sometimes appear invisible.

“There’s lots of colors and noises and chaos and everything with the type of things that go on,” she said. “[It’s] so much to take in at a convention like that.”

Berndt says she was awestruck when she saw her son, now 15, go up to an artist and ask for an autograph after years of going to Calmer Con and getting more comfortable.

For the neurodiverse community, she said, they can go about what could be a challenging day in any other space and feel “for lack of better terms, normal.”

“They deserve to be able to have a Comic Con experience like anyone else,” said Jesse Lundberg, a New Hampshire-based comic artist who tables at the convention. “And feel safe and seen.”

Lundberg has been at larger conventions before, and he said this one really allows you to read people and assess their comfort level when interacting with them.

CALMER CON
Sept. 12. 10 a.m. to 4 p.m. Meadowbrook School, 10 Farm Road, Weston. Free, registration required. calmercon.org

“For some of them, it’s a really big step to be able to go to something like this,” he said. “You really want to make it as fun and accessible, and make it feel like they’re appreciated for taking the step to come out.”

Winick, a featured guest for this year, said he learned from larger conventions how overwhelming the space can be for much of the audience, whom he also noticed were a part of the neurodiverse community.

The artist called large comic conventions like “if Times Square was crowded with people, shoulder to shoulder.”

“Sometimes it was a little bit of a struggle to be in such a large social setting, a loud social setting,” he said. “All anyone wants to do is just embrace something they love and actually just be a part of it.”

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When the wedding RSVP comes with a hefty price tag

By Sarah Lyon
NEW YORK TIMES

Andrew Schleeter will make every effort to attend a friend’s wedding — even when the celebration is taking place abroad.

“I love weddings, and I think weddings are such a fun way to travel,” said Schleeter, 32, who lives in New York City and is a founder and the chief revenue officer of the merchandising agency MerchCamp. “People work a year of their entire lives to plan their wedding, and they want to include you in it. I think it’s very special, so I always try to go.”

Americans *want* to attend weddings. In a PayPal survey conducted in May, 90 percent of respondents said they would rather cut back on dining out, shopping, and gym memberships than miss a best friend’s nuptials. But attending a wedding doesn’t come cheap: American guests estimate spending an average of about \$1,400 per celebration, according to a Bank of Montreal United States survey.

While reducing everyday expenses can help ease the burden, budget-minded wedding guests like Schleeter are implementing other clever hacks to trim spending on lodging, flights, and attire.

Since May 2025, Caroline Sacks, a content creator living in New York City, has gone to 16 weddings. Sacks, 30, views most of these celebrations as opportunities to reconnect with long-distance friends rather than romantic get-aways for her and her fiancé, Jack Bushell, an account executive. So the two will often split the cost of a hotel room with another couple in order to curb their expenses.

“The hotel room is really the lowest priority,” said Sacks, who would rather allocate funds toward other costs such



SHUTTERSTOCK

Weddings are expensive for couples, but also pricey for guests.

as airfare, rental cars, or pre-celebration beauty treatments. Besides, she added, a shared room is often favorable because it can become a gathering place for others who “want to be in the mix” throughout the weekend.

For guests who aren’t as interested in staying at hotels, home-swapping communities such as Kindred are becoming increasingly popular. Operating on a “give to get” system, Kindred members receive one credit for each night they host guests. They can use these credits to book stays across Europe and North America, paying only a small service and cleaning fee. Founded in 2021, Kindred has recently experienced major growth — 150,000 of its 400,000 members joined last year.

For some guests attending multiple weddings, or for whom missing the celebration is simply not an option, open-

ing a new credit card with a significant cash back or rewards offer can be a strategic way to help offset some of the costs.

Sacks and Bushell did exactly that before attending weddings in Greece and Mexico last summer. “We knew we needed to hit a minimum spend within a certain amount of days,” Sacks said. “We’re like: ‘Perfect. We have to spend this money anyway. This is the best time to do it.’”

But attendees considering this route should first evaluate their overall financial situation carefully. “Try to avoid letting tangential benefits be the primary motivation for undertaking key financial decisions,” said Vincent Birardi, a senior wealth adviser at Halbert Hargrove in Long Beach, Calif. “People should be mindful of opening too many new credit card accounts too quickly, as

doing so can potentially lower your credit score temporarily. Carrying unpaid balances on multiple cards can have an even larger negative impact on your credit score.”

Sacks also tries to be intentional with her flight choices. “We’re currently loyal to Delta,” she said. If it’s significantly cheaper to depart the morning after the wedding rather than in the evening, she recommends doing so, even if that means missing a farewell brunch. “Unless you’re the maid of honor, I promise no one is scanning the room looking for you,” she said.

The idea that it’s more economical to buy flights on certain days of the week is outdated, said Brian Kelly, founder of the Points Guy, a travel advice website. Rather, Kelly said, “it’s all based on demand.” Booking a domestic flight four to six weeks ahead of time is

“the sweet spot,” he added. “The airlines penalize nervous Nellies, and then they penalize last-minute travelers.”

In addition to booking lodging and travel, wedding guests also have to consider apparel. The PayPal survey revealed that millennials and Gen Zers considered attire to be the biggest expense when attending a wedding. Many attendees are choosing to rewear favorite outfits to multiple celebrations, and some of them even let friends borrow their attire.

For the past two years, Maura Judge, 29, has mostly worn the same two dresses to weddings: a black, strapless gown from Reformation, and a blue tulle dress from Hill House. Judge, who lives in New York City, first purchased the blue dress to wear as a bridesmaid at her friend Katie Sweeney’s wedding in 2024. Sweeney recently wore the dress to Judge’s wedding in June.

In 2021, writer Caitlin Poole, 37, ordered a bright pink Farm Rio dress from the resale marketplace Poshmark after a friend requested that close friends wear either hot pink or red. “It came, and it was so perfect and comfortable, and I felt good and confident in it,” said Poole, who lives in Durham, N.C., and paid \$250 for the dress. It was new with tags, and she has worn it to eight weddings.

For Poole, repeatedly wearing the same dress is more than a money-saving technique. “I’ve always been interested in sustainable and ethical fashion,” she said.

Having a go-to option also alleviates decision fatigue. “Leading up to weddings, I used to feel this amount of stress,” Poole said. “Am I going to feel comfortable? Is this going to work? How is it going to look?” Now, everybody just knows, “Oh, that’s Caitlin’s wedding guest dress.”

TV HIGHLIGHTS

Tennis: US Open, 11 a.m., ESPN; 7 p.m., ESPN2
Baseball: Angels-Red Sox, 1:35 p.m., NESN
Women's basketball: FIBA World Cup, US-Czechia, 2:45 p.m., TNT
College football: SMU-Florida State, 7:30 p.m., ESPN
Baseball: Cardinals-Giants, 8:10 p.m., NBC
Listings, C7

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Sports

C



Former manager Joe Morgan (seated) was honored by members of the “Morgan Magic” squad of 1988 with a Fenway celebration on July 30, 2013. Morgan died Saturday night at age 95.

2013 FILE/JIM DAVIS/GLOBE STAFF

DAN SHAUGHNESSY

No one did it like Morgan, a one-of-one who was one of us



It was around 1990. The Red Sox were staying at the Cross Keys Inn in Baltimore, and manager Joe Morgan had done a radio show with the Orioles flagship station on the first night of a three-game series. After the interview, he'd been handed a \$50 gift certificate for free clothing at Jos. A. Bank.

When Morgan saw me doing the same radio show in the O's dugout the next night, he hunted me down and gave me his certificate, saying, “They know

►Remembering Joe Morgan, Walpole's hardball hero. A1

I'm never going to use this thing, but maybe you know how.”

I did. I'd worked in Baltimore, had rented a car for the series, and knew the store.

Late in the morning the next day, I drove there, picked up \$50 worth of stuff for myself, then called Joe at the hotel and asked if he'd like me to grab him a sweater or something.

“Thanks,” he said. “What I could really use is some new underwear. Size 42.”

At a moment like this,

there's only one more question.

“Boxers or briefs, Joe?”

“Boxers,” said the manager.

An hour later, before the team bus left for the final game of the series at Memorial Stadium, I went to the third floor of the Cross Keys Inn and presented Morgan with a bag of free underwear.

Joe smiled and thanked me.

I can't remember who won any of those games, but I've never forgotten the time I bought underwear for the manager of the Boston Red Sox.

Ninety-five-year-old Joe Morgan died Saturday night, while Chad Tracy's playoff-

SHAUGHNESSY, Page C6



NFL WEEK 1

PATRIOTS AT SEAHAWKS

Wednesday, 8:20 p.m., NBC

Patriots RB depth could be an issue

By Nicole Yang

GLOBE STAFF

Five thoughts on the Patriots ahead of their season opener . . .

1. One position where the depth could be tested right away: running back.

TreVeyon Henderson once again did not practice on Sunday, decreasing the likelihood of him suiting up for Wednesday night's season opener. Henderson, who is entering his second season, has remained sidelined since exiting practice early on Aug. 24.

Without Henderson, the Patriots will be relying on newly acquired Corey Kiner and/or a practice-squad player (Lan Larison, Hassan Haskins) to round out the running back room behind Rhamondre Stevenson. Even if Henderson is active for Wednesday's game, it would be

surprising to see him shoulder a full workload because of the amount of time he has missed.

Coming out of training camp, Stevenson was on track to serve as the featured back. The effectiveness of the run game can be difficult to gauge during camp, given the lack of tackling, but Stevenson looked productive and consistent as a pass-catcher. Coach Mike Vrabel also praised his ability in pass protection.

Stevenson was set to out-snap Henderson, as he often did when healthy last season. But there's certainly still a role for him, who can serve as an explosive play threat. Although Vrabel noted Henderson needs to work on his pass protection, which was a weakness last year, he and Stevenson would have formed a strong one-two punch.

PATRIOTS, Page C2

INSIDE



EBRAHIM NOROOZI/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Goodell extended

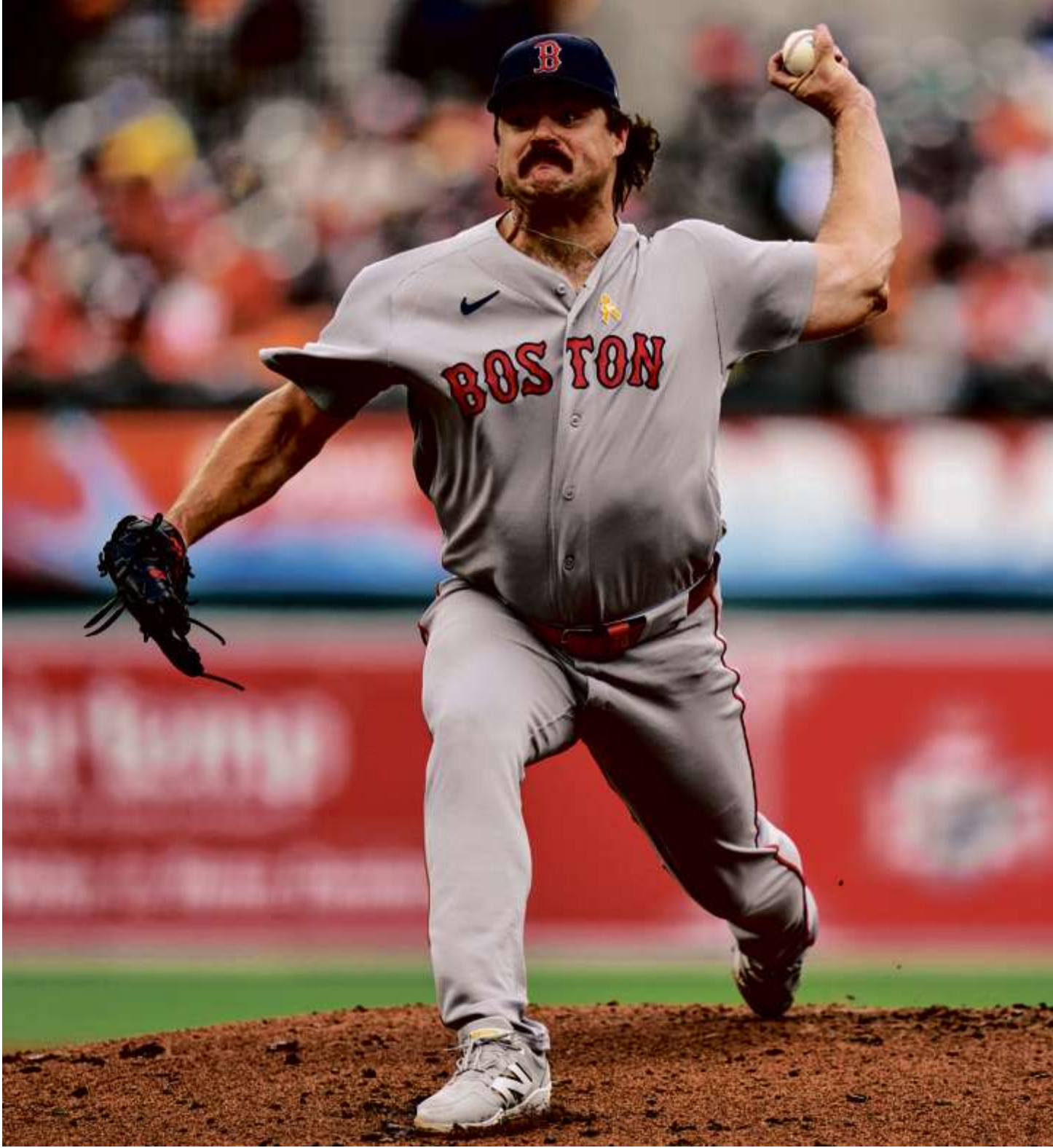
NFL commissioner gets new contract through 2030. C2

Americans hang on

Young (above), Team USA struggle past Italy. C6

Second thought

Western Michigan taking high road on timing debate. C6



STEPHANIE SCARBROUGH/ASSOCIATED PRESS

The Red Sox had quality starts from all four starters in their sweep of the Orioles, including one Sunday from Payton Tolle.

More fun times for Tolle

Lefthander strikes out 12 batters as Red Sox complete four-game sweep

By Peter Abraham

GLOBE STAFF

Red Sox 3
Orioles 1

BALTIMORE — Sunday afternoon's start against the Orioles went so well for Red Sox lefthander Payton Tolle that even slipping off the mound in the third inning

turned into something fun.

Tolle caught himself before hitting the dirt and did a perfect push-up before popping back up and striking out Pete Alonso.

“That's the first time, and that'll be the last time,” Tolle said after pitching six dominant innings in a 3-1 victory. “That's as

many as I'm getting out there.”

With Tolle, pitching is only part of the show.

The rookie wrapped Dominic Canzone of the Mariners in a hug when he tagged him out going to first base last week.

RED SOX, Page C4

US OPEN

Americans make run at ending drought

Tiafoe, Michelsen, and Shelton reach quarters

ASSOCIATED PRESS

NEW YORK — Frances Tiafoe and Alex Michelsen will meet in the US Open quarterfinals. Ben Shelton is there as well, set to face defending champion Carlos Alcaraz.

The American men are making a real run at ending their lengthy Grand Slam drought.

The United States hasn't had a men's major champion since Andy Roddick won in Flushing Meadows in 2003, and there haven't even been many great opportunities in the more than two decades since.

But backed by the home crowd and in good form, the Americans had five players in the final 16 of a major for the first time since 1995 and will be a real threat in the second week of the final Grand Slam of the season.

“We play so much outside of the States obviously, a lot of time in Europe,” Tiafoe said Sunday. “This sport's so international, so to be able to play in front of friends, family, loved ones, is amazing. They don't get to see you much, so you want to put on a show.”

The No. 11 seed beat 2021 champion Daniil Medvedev 7-6 (1), 6-4, 7-6 (6) to move within a victory of his third appearance in the US Open semifinals. To get there he'll have to beat Michelsen, who has been the dominant

player in this year's tournament.

The 22-year-old from California beat No. 27 Tomas Etcheverry 7-6 (6), 6-4, 6-4 and is the only man who has yet to drop a set in the tournament.

“We've been working really hard to get to this point and I'm really happy but not super surprised because of all the work I put in my whole life,” Michelsen said after reaching his first Grand Slam quarterfinal.

The winner of his match against Tiafoe will face No. 2-seeded Alcaraz or No. 8 Shelton, who beat Stefanos Tsitsipas 6-2, 6-3, 6-4 in his best performance of the tournament. Shelton predicted “fireworks” in the matchup

US OPEN, Page C2



FRANK FRANKLIN II/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Frances Tiafoe will be part of an all-American quarterfinal after ousting past champ Daniil Medvedev.



STEPH CHAMBERS/GETTY IMAGES

The Seahawks will raise their Super Bowl banner before the opener vs. the Patriots.

In preparation, Vrabel cranks up the volume

By Christopher Price
GLOBE STAFF

FOXBOROUGH — This summer, you couldn't help but hear it.

Patriots coach Mike Vrabel would signal the audio crew, and they'd crank the music — which occasionally included some vintage Mötley Crüe — to uncomfortable levels, hoping to stress the offense and replicate the sort of ear-splitting decibel levels typically heard inside Seattle's Lumen Field.

The hope? Drake Maye and the Patriots will be better prepared to maintain a suitable level of communication in Wednesday's opener, even if they have a wall of sound drowning out any calls at the line.

As a former assistant with the Rams, Patriots special teams coordinator Jeremy Springer made annual visits to divisional rival Seattle. He said the noise is legit.

"Loud. Very loud," Springer said of the venue and fan base that once forced a remarkable 11 false starts in a 2005 game against the Giants. "It's loud. The fans are great. They love their football team, and [there's] great fan support there.

"It's going to be awesome to go into that environment with our guys and get some good experience. But that's always part of the game there. That's what makes us so exciting."

Taking the crowd out of the game will go a long way toward success in Seattle. Creating some early offensive momentum — steady, sustained drives in the first half — will help. There's also using the silent count, something Maye will lean on.

Maye — who said they used a silent count at some point in every road game last season — believes they have "got a good grip" when it comes to dealing with the noise.

"I think there's advantages and disadvantages to working in the silent [count], and I think it's mostly just us repping it," he said. "I think Coach Vrabel and the offensive staff did a great job preparing us. And I think we've got a lot of work at it.

"I think those guys got a good grip on it. So we've got to stay out of penalties — avoid penalties — and keep the positive plays going."

But there's still a lot to consider when it

comes to individual matchups along the offensive line, namely at tackle, with Will Campbell and Morgan Moses.

"It's thinking about Will and Morgan who are trying to look inside and block a guy getting paid a lot of money; a big dude outside," Maye said. "They've got to look and can't really get a jump on it."

It's also not just the offensive line that has to account for the noise. A silent count necessitates a hyper-focused group of skill position players, particularly those along the boundary. If you can't hear the call, you have to keep your eyes open.

"You like to think that it's easy, but they've got to get lined up. You know if they have a motion, know what the route is, know if they see the alert and all while watching the ball," Maye said of the receivers and backs. "So they've got a tough job. It's simple to say, 'Hey, watch the ball,' but they've got a lot of thinking to do while watching the ball."

"I know the count, but when you can't hear it, that's different, because I'm trying to get off the ball," said wide receiver A.J. Brown. "So you've got to watch the ball and make sure you're watching your guy in front of you as well, because they may be changing where they are on the field or getting closer to you to maybe put hands on you.

"All that stuff goes into it to their advantage. But we have things that we can use to our advantage as well."

Ultimately, regardless of whether Maye is calling out signals at the line of scrimmage or the Patriots are going silent, the goal doesn't change.

"I just think it's the communication; getting guys on the same page," said quarterbacks coach Ashton Grant. "You know, a lot of what we do is verbal communicating. So when you go into a loud environment where you can't use your voices, I think just trying to get everyone on the same page when we're trying to snap the ball and what other communication we're trying to get done, I think it becomes important."

Christopher Price can be reached at christopher.price@globe.com. Follow him on Bluesky at christopherprice.bsky.social.

With Henderson still ailing, running back depth lacking

►PATRIOTS
Continued from Page C1

Now, the Patriots will have to rely on Kiner, who joined the team just eight days ago, and/or temporarily elevate Larison or Haskins to the game day roster. Perhaps fullback Reggie Gilliam, who logged just two carries and caught two passes last year, could also see some looks out of the backfield.

A team can elevate two practice-squad players to the game day roster each week, so chances are only one of Larison and Haskins is chosen. Larison projects as a versatile pass catcher, while Haskins is more of a traditional power back able to run between the tackles. Both can contribute on special teams. Larison and Kiner are second-year players, so Haskins, a 2022 fourth-round pick, boasts added experience.

"Whatever we need," Vrabel said. "Some guys have a little bit of different strengths than maybe the other guys. There's a little bit of everything. We'll see who we end up using for the game."

2. As for the position where the Patriots might use their second practice-squad elevation? Punter is the leading candidate. After placing starter Bryce Baringer on injured reserve, forcing him to miss at least four games, they have not signed another punter to their 53-man roster. Mitch Wishnowsky, signed to the practice squad on Aug. 31, would be the next man up. The 34-year-old has considerable NFL experience, starting his career in 2019.

3. It doesn't appear that Christian Gonzalez took any issue with his trainer's recent comments on 98.5 The Sports Hub's "Felger and Mazz."

Christian White, also known as "Coach Flight," said during the radio appearance that the language of the Patriots' initial offer was "kind of trash." He also said that there's been "a little bit more movement," and that he expects Gonzalez to play Week 1 even without a new deal.

"That's my guy," Gonzalez said Saturday. "We have two different opinions. I mean, he's a grown man. If he wants to go talk to the media, he's going to go talk to the media. He's my guy. I trust him with everything. He trusts me with everything. We talk every day. It wasn't anything to me

that was bad. I mean, he went and talked to them. I talked to him maybe two hours after I came back and saw all that."

Gonzalez's potential contract extension continues to loom over the Patriots. He has stayed mum about several aspects of the negotiations, including whether he will play Week 1 and whether he would consider requesting a trade.

Not signing Gonzalez to an extension would be rather antithetical to how Vrabel and executive vice president of player personnel Eliot Wolf have said they want to build their team. The two have stressed the importance of drafting, developing, and retaining talent.

4. As the Patriots embraced their "road warriors" identity last season, Vrabel incorporated a variety of motivational tactics into his week-to-week messaging.

Ahead of the season opener in Seattle, it will be interesting to see whether he leans into the fact that the game is a rematch of Super Bowl LX, or whether he treats it as any other Week 1. The latter might be difficult. Some players already admitted there's going to be some extra motivation because of the opponent.

"Starting off with a bang like that, a chance to get an opponent that left a bad taste in our mouth, I think it's something for us that's going to really make us work," quarterback Drake Maye said in May. "We've got to bring it Week 1 on the road in a tough environment.

"They're going to be hanging their banner, and that's part of it. So, I think it's going to be interesting. It's going to be fun. It's going to be a tough task."

5. After some additional transactions following the roster cutdown deadline, the final tally of new faces stands at 23. Headed into Week 1, 43 percent of the 53-man roster was not with the team last year. Moreover, the Patriots lost 14 players that started at least one game for them last year. The fact that the Patriots did not shy away from turnover, after an unexpectedly successful year, reflects the shocking nature of their postseason run.

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SportsLog

Goodell receives new contract

NFL commissioner **Roger Goodell** has agreed on a four-year contract extension that runs through the 2030 league season, ending on March 31, 2031. The NFL's Compensation Committee notified the full ownership of the agreement on Sunday. In a memo sent to owners that was obtained by The Associated Press, Patriots owner **Robert Kraft** said: "We believe we are very fortunate to have Roger at the helm for the next four years." Kraft is the chairman of the league's compensation committee. Financial terms of Goodell's new contract weren't immediately known. He reportedly earned \$63.9 million for the 2019-20 and 2020-21 seasons . . . The Giants signed backup quarterback **James Winston** to a two-year, \$13 million contract extension. Left guard **Jon Runyan** received a two-year extension, too, with \$21.5 million guaranteed.

SOCCER

Infantino to seek re-election

FIFA president **Gianni Infantino** will stand for re-election despite growing calls for him to step down from his position as the head of world soccer's governing body. Infantino has faced increasing pressure after his controversial plan to sell stakes in the World Cup was met with a furious backlash. But FIFA said he plans to stand again in next year's elections for a final term in office through 2031. "The FIFA president announced in April that he will stand for re-election in 2027. Of course, nothing has changed. Mr. Infantino will be standing for re-election," a FIFA spokesperson said. Nov. 18 is the deadline for candidates to enter the next presidential contest, exactly four months ahead of the vote.

Arsenal holds off Chelsea

Arsenal joined Man City at the top of the English Premier League standings by coming from behind to defeat Chelsea, 2-1, in a big early test of its title defense. **Martin Odegaard** scored a 50th-minute winner after **Morgan Rogers** had given Chelsea an early lead and **Kai Havertz** equalized for Arsenal in the first half. The Gunners have won their first three EPL matches, while the Blues lost after two opening wins . . . Manchester United, which has only one victory in three EPL games, conceded a stoppage-time goal to draw at Everton, 2-2, after twice holding the lead. Deadline-day signing **Ainsley Maitland-Niles** came off the bench to make his debut and score a long-range shot into the top cor-

ner to salvage a point for the Toffees . . . American international **Giovanni Reyna** got his first goal with Strasbourg in his new club's 6-2 trouncing of Troyes in France's Ligue 1.

GOLF

GB&I regains Walker Cup

Connor Graham and **Josh Hill** each won the 18th hole in the final two matches at Lahinch in County Clare, Ireland, as Great Britain & Ireland capped off a stunning comeback against America to win the Walker Cup for the first time since 2015. Graham birdied the last two holes to earn a precious halve against 17-year-old **Miles Russell**. It came down to Hill, all square in his match with 18-year-old **Tyler Watts**, his Tennessee teammate. Hill hit a long bunker shot to 3 feet and holed the birdie putt for a 13½-12½ victory. The Americans swept the morning foursomes matches in the fierce wind to build a 3-point lead going into the 10 singles matches, where they needed to win only 3½ points to keep the cup. GB&I, however, quickly turned the tables on the leaderboard by winning the opening four matches. The key was getting 3 points from four matches in the middle — two wins, two halves — that proved the difference . . . **Thriston Lawrence** of South Africa overcame a six-shot deficit with an 8-under-par 62 and denied **Paul Casey** his first victory in five years by making an 18-foot birdie putt on the fourth playoff hole to win the European Masters in Crans Montana, Switzerland.

AUTO RACING

Bell wins to begin Chase

Christopher Bell passed **Kyle Larson** with 18 laps to go and held on to win the Chase-opening Southern 500 at Darlington Raceway. Bell had seven second-place finishes this season and had not won since last September at Bristol, a stretch of 33 races . . . **Kimi Antonelli** took a big step to becoming the youngest champion in Formula 1 history with a fightback for the ages at his home Italian Grand Prix, storming to victory despite starting 19th. It took the Mercedes driver fewer than 17 laps to move in front. The rest of the race was spent tussling with teammate and title rival **George Russell** for the lead. Antonelli passed him for the final time with three laps remaining, going on to become the first Italian to win in front of the rabid Tifosi in 60 years.



SETH WENIG/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Alex Michelsen is in the US Open quarterfinals as the only man who hasn't dropped a set.

American men making run at title

►US OPEN
Continued from Page C1

with the two-time champion.

"I think it will be a great match. I'm excited for the battle," Shelton said.

All four men's matches Sunday had a United States player, and the Americans grabbed three of them. Only Alcaraz was able to turn back a player from the host country, beating No. 20 seed Tommy Paul in the afternoon.

The Americans still have a chance to get one more quarterfinalist Monday when No. 14 seed Learner Tien faces Karen Khachanov.

Defending champions Aryna Sabalenka and Alcaraz made returning to the quarterfinals look easy. The top-ranked Sabalenka solved some early

struggles holding serve and overpowered Taylor Townsend 6-4, 6-3. Alcaraz also advanced in straight sets, beating Paul 6-4, 6-3, 6-4.

"I'm happy with that performance," Alcaraz said. "I played my game. I tried to play my style. Tommy's such a talented player. His shots are pretty dangerous and it's sometimes pretty difficult to control the ball when it comes to you, so I just tried to be ready."

Townsend broke Sabalenka three times in her first four service games as she looked to spring the upset. Sabalenka found a groove, regained her confidence, and did not lose another point after falling behind, 3-1, in the second set.

"I love matches like that because it was really challenging,"

Sabalenka said.

Townsend gave her opponent fits in the first set of their first meeting, but struggled to find her rhythm.

"This was the most comfortable and confident I've ever been playing against a No. 1 player in the world," Townsend said. "From the beginning, I felt like I belonged."

Next up for Sabalenka is Wimbledon winner Linda Noskova, who needed six match points to get past Marta Kostyuk 7-5, 5-7, 6-4.

There also will be an all-American matchup in the women's quarterfinals. No. 3 Jessica Pegula got there by beating No. 16 Sorana Cirstea and will face 26th-seeded Emma Navarro, who ousted No. 21 Anna Kalinskaya in straight sets.

The Boston Globe

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Baseball

Milestone puts Chapman in celebratory mood

By Peter Abraham
GLOBE STAFF

BALTIMORE — There's always music playing in the clubhouse after the Red Sox win a game. But it was drowned out on Sunday by teammates celebrating the latest milestone by closer **Aroldis Chapman**.

The 38-year-old lefthander came off the field to chants of “Chappy! Chappy!” after recording his 400th career save with a scoreless ninth inning in a 3-1 victory against the Orioles.

Chapman allowed a one-out single by **Pete Alonso**. Then he struck out **Coby Mayo** swinging at a slider and **Christian Encarnacion-Strand** waving at a 101-miles-per-hour fastball.

Fittingly, it was Chapman's fastest pitch of the day.

“I was happy to celebrate my accomplishment with my teammates,” Chapman said via a translator.

Chapman became only the ninth pitcher with 400 saves. He became the fifth member of that club to have pitched for the Sox, joining **Kenley Jansen**, **Craig Kimbrel**, **Lee Smith**, and **Billy Wagner**.

Chapman was an All-Star closer for much of his career, then fell into more of a setup role from 2022-24 with the Yankees, Royals, Rangers, and Pirates.

He signed with the Red Sox for the 2025 season and has experienced a career renaissance, picking up 65 more saves while posting a 1.55 earned run average.

Chapman said reaching 400 was meaningful to him because of the struggle involved.

“It's very special,” he said. “A few years back I lost my role as a closer. I wasn't able to close a game. When I came [to the Red Sox] they gave me the opportunity to win the job.”

How many more saves can he get? “I don't know. As long as I can do the job, it's something I want to do,” said Chapman, who is signed through next season. “If I can help the team



STEPHANIE SCARBROUGH/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Aroldis Chapman became just the ninth pitcher to reach 400 career saves when he finished a scoreless ninth inning in Sunday's win over Baltimore.

win, that's what I want to do.” Sox interim manager **Chad Tracy** appreciates knowing he has a pitcher like Chapman to finish games. “I'm blessed to be along for the ride,” he said.

Rafaela on injured list

The Sox placed center fielder **Ceddanne Rafaela** (quad) on the 10-day injured list before the game. The move was retroactive to Sept. 3, which means Rafaela could return to the roster as soon as next Sunday.

“That's my expectation,” Tracy said. But even if Rafaela needs a few extra days, that's fine. The Sox recalled outfielder **Nate Eaton** and already have **Eli White** performing well in center field in Rafaela's absence. White was 2 for 4 with a three-run homer on Sunday. Rafaela said he was feeling better, but has yet to start swinging a bat or running. There was no setback; he just needs time to fully heal. “We're just being careful,” he said. The Sox also faced a deadline for

Red Sox 3, Orioles 1

At Oriole Park at Camden Yards, Baltimore												
BOSTON	AB	R	H	BI	BB	SO	Avg.					
Anthony rf	4	0	0	0	1	2	.243					
Gasper 1b	1	0	0	0	2	0	.276					
a-Jones ph	1	0	0	0	0	1	.223					
Kiner-Falefa 2b	0	0	0	0	0	0	.273					
Rutschman c	4	0	1	0	0	1	.237					
Story ss	4	0	1	0	0	0	.237					
Sogard 2b-1b	4	0	0	0	0	3	.261					
Durbin 3b	2	1	0	0	2	1	.247					
Duran lf	4	0	0	0	0	1	.202					
Monasterio dh	4	1	0	0	0	2	.244					
White cf	4	1	2	3	0	0	.280					
Totals	32	3	4	3	5	11						
BALTIMORE	AB	R	H	BI	BB	SO	Avg.					
Alexander 2b	4	0	0	0	0	2	.306					
Alonso 1b	4	0	2	0	0	2	.267					
Mayo dh	4	1	1	0	0	1	.222					
EncarnacionStrnd 3b	4	0	1	1	0	3	.268					
Henderson ss	3	0	0	0	0	1	.220					
Hinds lf	3	0	1	0	0	2	.333					
Taveras rf	2	0	0	0	0	2	.216					
b-Beavers ph-rf	1	0	0	0	1	0	.244					
Narváez c	3	0	0	0	0	1	.160					
Cowser cf	3	0	0	0	0	2	.215					
Totals	31	1	5	1	0	17						
Boston.....				.030	000	—	3	4	0			
Baltimore.....				.100	000	—	1	5	1			
a-struck out for Gasper in 9th, b-struck out for Taveras in 8th, E—Henderson (16), LOB—Boston 8, Baltimore 3, 2B—Rutschman (21), Mayo (14), Encarnacion-Strand (9), Hinds (1), HR—White (1), off Bradish, RISP—Boston 1 for 5, Baltimore 1 for 4.												
Boston	IP	H	R	ER	BB	SO	NP	ERA				
Tolle W 9-6	6	4	1	1	0	12	91	3.15				
Miller	1	0	0	0	0	2	14	0.68				
Morán	1	0	0	0	0	1	10	3.47				
Chapman S 33	1	1	0	0	0	2	19	2.03				
Baltimore	IP	H	R	ER	BB	SO	NP	ERA				
Bradish L 7-13	4	2	3	0	4	3	85	3.91				
Nunez	2	0	0	0	3	22	4.13					
Luis	1	0	0	0	1	0	16	6.75				
Sanders	1	1	0	0	0	3	17	2.81				
Wolfram	1	1	0	0	0	2	14	5.00				
HBP—by Nunez (Gasper). WP—Chapman. Umpires—Home, Dexter Kelley; First, Paul Clemens; Second, Adrian Johnson; Third, Ramon De Jesus. T—2:41. A—27,596 (42,455).												

Angels-Red Sox series thumbnails

At Fenway Park Monday, 1:35 p.m. NESN, WEEI-FM (93.7)			W-L	ERA
RHP Grayson Rodriguez	4-6	6.03		
RHP Brayan Bello	5-7	5.07		
Tuesday, 6:45 p.m. NESN, WEEI-FM (93.7)			W-L	ERA
LHP Reid Detmers	4-8	3.44		
LHP Patrick Sandoval	1-4	4.41		
Wednesday, 6:45 p.m. NESN, WEEI-FM (93.7)			W-L	ERA
RHP Ryan Johnson	3-8	5.17		
LHP Jake Bennett	9-6	3.34		

Head to head: This is the second of two series between these teams. The Red Sox swept three games from July 3-5 out west to begin their 15-game winning streak.

Miscellany: Los Angeles has lost 15 of 21, and fell, 1-0, to the Pirates on Sunday despite an eight-inning gem by Walbert Ureña . . . The Angels have scored just 4.03 runs/game, second-fewest in the majors.

ple-A Worcester.

But the Sox prefer to keep Campbell playing every day in the minors instead of taking a part-time role with the Sox.

Bello to get start

Brayan Bello has not started a major league game since June 4. He'll get another chance on Monday when the Sox open a three-game series against the Angels at Fenway Park. Bello is 1-6 with a 10.35 ERA in eight starts this season and 4-1 with a 2.03 ERA as a long reliever. With the Angels having a predominantly righthanded hitting lineup, the Sox don't see the need for an opener ahead of Bello. **Patrick Sandoval** and **Jake Bennett** are scheduled for the second and third games. . . **Wilyer Abreu** was the latest regular to get a day off as **Roman Anthony** played right field.

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STEPHANIE SCARBROUGH/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Payton Tolle and the Red Sox finished off a four-game sweep of the Orioles.

More fun as Tolle finishes sweep

►RED SOX
Continued from Page C1

Then there was the time in July when he playfully jumped about a foot in the air, pretending he had a chance to catch a ball chopped way over his head.

“There's going to be something every time he pitches,” interim manager Chad Tracy said. “He has to have fun. That's what makes him go.”

The Orioles would have preferred more push-ups than pitches. Tolle allowed one run on four hits and struck out 12 without a walk as the Sox swept the four-game series.

Tolle improved to 9-6 and dropped his earned run average to 3.15. Working with Adley Rutschman for the first time, he diced up the Orioles with a few more curveballs than usual while maintaining his fastball.

Tolle allowed back-to-back doubles by Coby Mayo and Christian Encarnacion-Strand in the first inning. The Orioles did not otherwise come close to scoring against him.

In all, Tolle threw 70 of his 91 pitches for strikes and didn't allow a runner past second base after the first inning.

Erik Miller, Jovani Morán, and Aroldis Chapman followed and retired

nine of the 10 batters they faced, five by strikeout. The save was the 33rd for Chapman this season and the 400th of his career.

It was not an easy save. Alonso singled with one out and advanced to second on a wild pitch. Chapman struck out Mayo with a slider before fanning Encarnacion-Strand with a 101-miles-per-hour fastball.

In all, the four Sox pitchers struck out 17 without a walk. The Sox hadn't done that in a nine-inning game since Sept. 18, 1996, when Roger Clemens struck out 20 Tigers.

The Orioles scored six runs in the series and struck out 44 times. They have lost six in a row, fading out of realistic postseason contention.

“The whole series was an amazing performance by our entire pitching staff,” Tracy said.

Eli White, starting in center field in place of an injured Ceddanne Rafaela for the fourth day in a row, cracked a three-run homer to left-center in the second inning off Kyle Bradish (7-13) to give the Sox all the runs they needed.

It was White's first home run since being obtained from the Braves at the trade deadline. He is 7 for 19 with eight RBIs in his last six games.

Teen prospect Primera turning heads with big bat behind plate

By Alex Speier
GLOBE STAFF

Franklin Primera's numbers seem almost fictional. Between the Florida Complex League and Single-A Salem, the 19-year-old is hitting .367 (the highest average by a Red Sox minor leaguer with at least 200 plate appearances since 2007) with a .499 on-base (the highest since Kevin Youkilis earned the “Greek God of Walks” moniker with a .504 mark in 2001) and a 1.080 OPS (highest since 2006).

He's been a force, crunching 13 home runs in 78 games, rolling out exit velocities north of 110 miles per hour, commanding the strike zone (14 percent walk rate), and rarely striking out (11 percent).

The feedback? “Serious juice,” said FCL hitting coach Junior Zamora. “He has a little bit of Miggy Cabrera. That's a lot to say, but when you watch him — body type, swing — he has a little bit of that. That's a lot, I know.”

“He was so advanced, especially relative to this level, where we kind of saw heroic numbers,” said Red Sox player

development manager Justin Frometa, referencing a ridiculous .427/.549/.718 line in rookie ball that prompted the promotion to Salem. “He makes a ton of contact, he hits the ball hard, he hits the ball in the air, he controls the zone. There's very few flaws.”

When anyone posts those numbers as a teenager, the industry takes notice. When a catcher does so, they command a spotlight — helping to explain why Primera became both a popular target at the trade deadline and why he's now represented by the Boras Corporation.

It's been a remarkable ascent for a player who struggled to get signed before agreeing to a \$10,000 bonus to join the Sox less than two years ago.

“The industry almost overlooked a guy who's now a stud,” noted one evaluator.

Area scout Cesar Morillo identified Primera in his native Venezuela for his obvious feel to hit, giving the Sox meaningful history when Primera shifted his training to the Dominican Republic in 2024.

Despite a strong arm, there were questions about whether he'd have the athleticism to stick behind the plate. Still, the Sox felt he had a chance to re-

main at the position, and their game looks and batted-ball data — at the time, mostly on ground balls and hard liners — were impressive enough for them to take a flyer.

“We always thought that there was a lot of offensive upside, so this was a low-dollar sign that we were really excited about,” said assistant general manager Eddie Romero. “But to this extent? No-body was guaranteeing that.”

Primera put up big numbers (.333/.465/.430) in his 2025 pro debut in the Dominican Summer League, but as an 18-year-old in a league where most positional prospects are 17, and with only one regular-season homer, he remained mostly below the prospect radar. But when an injury opened a spot for Primera to take part in the DSL All-Star Game, he hit a homer to earn MVP honors.

“That kind of started his upward trajectory,” said Romero.

Still, uncertainty about Primera's game persisted, and he didn't rank among the Red Sox' top 30 prospects entering the season. This year's statement, however, has put him prominently on the map.

Primera, who has added perhaps 25

pounds of muscle since signing, impressed at the Spring Breakout Game, when he held his own catching advanced pitching prospects Anthony Eyanson and Kyson Witherspoon. Offensively, Primera commanded at-bats thanks to swing decisions and bat-to-ball skills that yielded few swings and misses.

Primera, who had a tendency to come open too early and thus hit ground balls, worked with Zamora in Fort Myers to improve his posture and stay more closed to the plate, allowing him to better cover pitches on the outer half and letting him stay through balls while driving them in the air.

“He had good swing decisions — he wasn't swinging at balls — and every time he swung, he was making contact,” said Zamora. “If he can control his move, control his posture, every time he's gonna make contact, we're gonna see a good outcome.”

What they saw in the FCL, however, was otherworldly — a player whose skills were beyond rookie ball competition.

“Certain guys are hitter-ish, and he's just got that,” said Romero. “You see how comfortable he looks, his actions in

the box. You combine that with ferocity with his swing, and the ability to know what he's doing damage on, he's just got an advanced feel.”

He's continued to excel in Salem, hitting .329/.466/.494, emerging as a top-three prospect in the system. And he's shown enough improvement — particularly in arm strength — to remain behind the plate for now, where he'd have rare offensive potential as a catcher.

The Sox, of course, are familiar with the idea that a player's amateur profile and signing bonus don't necessarily dictate his future. Many of their best international signings, such as Ceddanne Rafaela (\$10,000) and Brayan Bello (\$28,000), entered the organization with little fanfare.

But few have so quickly asserted themselves in pro ball as Primera, whom Baseball America identified as the top prospect in the FCL this year. The Sox are eager to see more.

“He's a baby. He needs to keep growing up and maturing,” said Zamora. “And if he does, I think we're going to have something special.”

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Baseball

AL

EAST	W	L	Pct.	GB	WCGB	Last 10	Streak
Tampa Bay	85	58	.594	—	—	6-4	L 1
New York	81	62	.566	4	—	6-4	L 1
Boston	79	65	.549	6½	—	6-4	W 4
Toronto	72	72	.500	13½	1	7-3	L 1
Baltimore	69	75	.479	16½	4	4-6	L 6
CENTRAL	W	L	Pct.	GB	WCGB	Last 10	Streak
Chicago	75	68	.524	—	—	5-5	W 1
Cleveland	73	71	.507	2½	—	5-5	W 1
Minnesota	68	75	.476	7	4½	4-6	L 1
Detroit	65	78	.455	10	7½	3-7	L 1
Kansas City	64	80	.444	11½	9	5-5	W 1
WEST	W	L	Pct.	GB	WCGB	Last 10	Streak
Houston	73	71	.507	—	—	6-4	L 2
Texas	71	73	.493	2	2	5-5	W 1
Seattle	67	77	.465	6	6	3-7	W 1
Athletics	57	87	.396	16	16	4-6	L 1
Los Angeles	54	89	.378	18½	18½	2-8	L 1

NL

EAST	W	L	Pct.	GB	WCGB	Last 10	Streak
Atlanta	85	58	.594	—	—	7-3	W 1
Philadelphia	80	63	.559	5	—	7-3	L 1
Miami	72	72	.500	13½	4	4-6	W 1
*Washington	67	77	.465	18½	9	5-5	L 3
New York	65	78	.455	20	10½	5-5	W 1
CENTRAL	W	L	Pct.	GB	WCGB	Last 10	Streak
Milwaukee	88	56	.611	—	—	5-5	L 2
Chicago	81	63	.563	7	—	5-5	L 1
St. Louis	72	72	.500	16	4	6-4	W 1
Pittsburgh	71	73	.493	17	5	6-4	W 1
Cincinnati	69	74	.483	18½	6½	7-3	W 2
WEST	W	L	Pct.	GB	WCGB	Last 10	Streak
*Los Angeles	85	57	.599	—	—	5-5	W 3
Arizona	76	68	.528	10	—	5-5	W 2
San Diego	75	68	.524	10½	½	4-6	W 1
San Francisco	59	85	.410	27	17	4-6	L 1
Colorado	55	88	.385	30½	20½	3-7	L 1

* — Not including late game

RESULTS

SUNDAY

Boston 3	at	Baltimore 1	At Kansas City 6	Toronto 1
At Cincinnati 12	Milwaukee 8	At Texas 8	Tampa Bay 6	
Atlanta 5	at Philadelphia 4	St. Louis 10	at Colorado 8	
At Pittsburgh 1	LA Angels 0	At Seattle 2	Athletics 0	
At Miami 10	Chi. Cubs 3	At San Diego 4	NY Yankees 3	
At Cleveland 3 (10 inn.)	Detroit 2	At Chi. White Sox 10	Minnesota 1	
At NY Mets 4	San Francisco 2	Washington	at LA Dodgers	
Arizona 3	at Houston 2			

SATURDAY

Boston 5	at Baltimore 0	Minnesota 6	at Chi. White Sox 4	
Chi. Cubs 6	at Miami 5	Toronto 4	at Kansas City 3	
San Francisco 9	at NY Mets 5	Arizona 4 (10 inn.)	at Houston 3	
At Philadelphia 4	Atlanta 2	NY Yankees 5	at San Diego 1	
Detroit 6	at Cleveland 0	At Colorado 10	St. Louis 7	
LA Angels 6	at Pittsburgh 1	At LA Dodgers 6	Washington 5	
At Cincinnati 5	Milwaukee 3	Athletics 6	at Seattle 2	
Tampa Bay 6 (10 inn.)	at Texas 3			

MONDAY'S GAMES

	Odds	2026.....	Team	2026 vs. opp.....	Last 3 starts.....						
		W-L	ERA	W-L	IP	ERA	W-L	IP	ERA		
LA ANGELS AT BOSTON, 1:35 p.m.											
Rodriguez (R)	+145	4-6	6.03	4-12	0-0	0.0	0.00	1-1	18.2	2.41	
TBA	-170	—	—	0-0	0-0	0.0	0.00	0-0	0.0	—	
ATLANTA AT PHILADELPHIA, 1:05 p.m.											
Holmes (R)	+140	9-5	3.62	19-7	1-0	10.2	4.22	2-0	14.0	1.93	
Luzardo (L)	-165	13-5	3.02	20-8	0-0	0.0	0.00	2-0	19.1	1.40	
NY METS AT MIAMI, 1:10 p.m.											
Tong (R)	-105	1-1	3.60	0-0	0-0	3.0	0.00	0-0	0.0	—	
Pérez (R)	-115	7-10	3.72	12-13	1-0	12.1	1.46	1-1	12.2	8.53	
CLEVELAND AT BALTIMORE, 1:35 p.m.											
Cantillo (L)	+105	9-8	3.81	18-11	0-0	4.2	5.79	0-1	16.0	3.94	
Rogers (L)	-125	9-9	4.30	13-13	0-1	5.0	9.00	1-1	18.2	5.30	
ARIZONA AT KANSAS CITY, 2:10 p.m.											
TBA	Off	—	—	0-0	0-0	0.0	0.00	0-0	0.0	—	
Cameron (L)	Off	9-8	4.08	9-17	0-0	0.0	0.00	2-0	16.0	3.38	
CHI. CUBS AT MILWAUKEE, 2:10 p.m.											
Boyd (L)	+105	8-3	4.05	11-7	0-0	5.1	5.06	0-1	17.1	4.15	
Gasser (L)	-125	4-5	4.57	10-6	0-0	4.1	4.15	0-1	14.1	5.65	
MINNESOTA AT DETROIT, 3:10 p.m.											
Ryan (R)	Off	6-8	3.65	11-12	1-0	5.0	3.60	0-3	15.1	9.39	
Melton (R)	Off	7-4	2.20	11-6	1-1	10.1	7.84	0-3	18.0	5.50	
WASHINGTON AT SAN DIEGO, 5:10 p.m.											
Irvin (R)	Off	2-8	5.57	9-9	0-0	0.0	0.00	0-1	14.1	4.40	
Vásquez (R)	Off	10-6	4.02	14-8	0-0	0.0	0.00	2-0	16.2	2.16	
ST. LOUIS AT SAN FRANCISCO, 8:10 p.m.											
McGrevey (R)	+115	6-9	3.97	14-13	0-0	0.0	0.00	1-0	15.1	8.22	
Webb (R)	-135	8-8	4.21	9-16	0-0	0.0	0.00	0-1	10.2	13.50	
CINCINNATI AT LA DODGERS, 9:10 p.m.											
Burns (R)	+130	15-3	2.79	19-7	0-0	0.0	0.00	0.00	1-1	14.1	5.65
TBA	-150	—	—	0-0	0-0	0.0	0.00	0-0	0.0	—	
TORONTO AT ATHLETICS, 10:05 p.m.											
Cease (R)	-200	10-5	2.25	18-9	0-0	5.1	1.69	3-0	18.2	0.96	
Lopez (L)	+170	6-4	4.71	9-11	0-0	0.0	0.00	1-0	17.0	2.12	
Team rec. — Record in games started by pitcher this season											

DIAMONDBACKS 3, ASTROS 2													METS 4, GIANTS 2													
ARIZONA													SAN FRAN.													
AB	R	H	BI	BB	SO	Avg.	AB	R	H	BI	BB	SO	Avg.	AB	R	H	BI	BB	SO	Avg.						
Perdomo ss	1	0	1	0	0	.252	Gilbert cf-1f	4	0	0	0	0	3	.232	De La Cruz	4	0	0	0	0	3	.232				
Tawa 1b	4	1	1	0	0	.239	Freeman, LAD	5	1	1	0	0	2	.262	Edgarde 1b	4	1	1	0	0	1	.262				
Marte 2b	4	1	1	0	0	.251	Cox 2b-cf	4	1	1	0	0	1	.289	Lee rf	4	1	1	0	0	1	.289				
Moreno dh	4	0	1	0	0	.300	Lee rf	4	1	1	0	2	0	.280	Basabe 3b-2b	4	0	0	0	0	3	.208				
Arenado 3b	4	1	1	2	0	.233	Young ph	3	0	0	0	0	0	.136	Whitcomb 3b	0	0	0	0	0	0	.132				
Canólf r	4	1	2	0	0	.240	Whitcomb 3b	0	0	0	0	0	0	.132	Cavanaugh c	3	0	1	0	0	0	.246				
Troy lf	2	0	0	0	0	.220	Cavanaugh c	3	0	1	0	0	0	.246	Koss ss	3	0	0	0	0	0	.207				
Nootbaar ph	1	0	0	0	0	.233	Koss ss	3	0	0	0	0	0	.207	Totals	33	2	5	2	0	12					
Waldschmidt lf	0	0	0	0	0	.266	Totals	33	2	5	2	0	12		NY METS	AB	R	H	BI	BB	SO	Avg.				
McCann c	3	0	1	1	0	.296	NY Mets	3	0	0	0	0	0	.228	Soto dh	3	1	1	0	1	0	.274				
Vargas 1b-ss	4	0	1	0	0	.251	Soto dh	3	1	1	0	1	0	.274	Bichette 3b	4	1	1	3	0	1	.264				
Lawlar cf	3	0	0	0	0	.259	Bichette 3b	4	1	1	3	0	1	.264	Benge rf	4	0	1	0	0	1	.276				
Totals	33	3	9	3	0	.258	Benge rf	4	0	1	0	0	1	.276	Vientos 1b	2	0	0	0	0	0	.217				
HOUSTON													LYONS													
AB	R	H	BI	BB	SO	Avg.	AB	R	H	BI	BB	SO	Avg.	AB	R	H	BI	BB	SO	Avg.						
Peña ss	4	0	0	0	0	.271	Lyons	3	0	0	0	0	0	.228	Soto dh	3	1	1	0	1	0	.274				
Alvarez dh	5	1	1	0	1	.314	Bichette 3b	4	1	1	3	0	1	.264	Bichette 3b	4	1	1	3	0	1	.264				
Paredes 3b-1b	3	0	0	0	0	.258	Benge rf	4	0	1	0	0	1	.276	Vientos 1b	2	0	0	0	0	0	.217				
Altuve 2b	4	1	3	0	0	.247	Vientos 1b	2	0	0	0	0	0	.217	Young ph	1	0	0	0	0	0	.267				
Walker 1b	3	0	1	0	0	.227	Young ph	1	0	0	0	0	0	.267	Dejongs ph	1	0	0	0	0	0	.167				
Allen pr-3b	0	0	0	0	0	.275	Dejongs ph	1	0	0	0	0	0	.167	Pache lf	0	0	0	0	0	0	.125				
Velázquez lf	3	0	0	0	0	.210	Pache lf	0	0	0	0	0	0	.125	Semien 2b	3	0	1	0	0	0	.218				
Wade Jr. ph	1	0	1	1	0	.211	Semien 2b	3	0	1	0	0	0	.218	Morabito lf	2	0	0	0	0	0	.105				
Meyers pr-1f	0	0	0	0	0	.213	Morabito lf	2	0	0	0	0	0	.105	Baty ph-1b	1	1	1	0	0	0	.225				
Varsho cf	3	0	0	0	1	.226	Baty ph-1b	1	1	1	0	0	0	.225	Ewing cf	3	1	2	0	0	0	.242				
CaSmith rf	3	0	0	0	0	.213	Ewing cf	3	1	2	0	0	0	.242	Torrens c	2	0	0	0	0	1	.232				
Trammell ph-rf	1	0	0	0	0	.205	Torrens c	2	0	0	0	0	1	.232	Totals	28	4	7	4	2	4					
Vásquez c	3	1	0	0	0	.212	Totals	28	4	7	4	2	4		San Francisco	000	000	000	—	2	5	0				
Díaz ph	1	0	0	0	0	.264	San Francisco	000	000	000	04x	—	4	7	1		NY Mets	000	000	000	04x	—	4	7	1	
Totals	34	2	7	2	2	.212	NY Mets	000	000	000	04x	—	4	7	1		E—Vientos (8). LOB —San Francisco 4, NY Mets 3. 2B —Benge (19), HR —Bichette (16), off Seymour, Baty (9), off Seymour. CS —Morabito (2). S —Torrens. DP —San Francisco 1.									
ARIZONA													SAN FRANCISCO													
AB	R	H	BI	BB	SO	ERA	AB	R	H	BI	BB	SO	ERA	AB	R	H	BI	BB	SO	ERA						
Perdomo ss	1	0	1	0	0	2.55	Kühnel	1	1	0	0	0	0	5.73	De La Cruz	4	0	0	0	0	3	.232				
Morillo	½	1	0	0	0	2.05	Freeman, LAD	5	1	1	0	0	2	.262	Edgarde 1b	4	1	1	0	0	1	.262				
BGarcia	½	0	0	0	0	2.13	Myers BSZ; L0-2	1	3	4	4	0	1	5.79	Lee rf	4	1	1	0	0	1	.289				
Loaísaga	1	3	1	1	0	2.47	NY Mets	IP	H	R	ER	BB	SO	ERA	Basabe 3b-2b	4	0	0	0	0	3	.208				
Ginkel 5 3	1	0	0	0	0	4.07	Scott	4½	4	2	2	2	0	7	3.81	Young ph	3	0	0	0	0	0	.136			
HOUSTON													SAN FRANCISCO													
IP	H	R	ER	BB	SO	ERA	IP	H	R	ER	BB	SO	ERA	AB	R	H	BI	BB	SO	ERA						
Lambert L 8-8	7	3	3	0	6	3.67	Scott	4½	4	2	2	2	0	7	3.81	Whitcomb 3b	0	0	0	0	0	0	.132			
Ullola	1	1	0	0	0	1.36	Lawver	½	0	0	0	0	1	0.00	Cavanaugh c	3	0	1	0	0	0	.246				
Abreu	1	1	0	0	0	1.37	Pintaro	2	0	0	0	0	1	3.81	Koss ss	3	0	0	0	0	0	.207				
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Morgan’s short stint long remembered

►MORGAN
Continued from Page A1

one of the most memorable chapters in the history of this club. The two division titles that followed only strengthened a bond with Red Sox fans that endured for the rest of his life. We extend our deepest condolences to his family and all who loved him.”

While Mr. Morgan spent nearly four decades as a player, coach, scout, and manager, most of them in the minor leagues, his career was defined by the three extraordinary weeks when the Red Sox won 19 of their first 20 games under his direction and soared from fourth to first in the American League East.

“That will never happen again,” he observed. “You won’t get a manager to come in and have that happen.”

The Sox not only went on to win the division that year, they also clinched the title on the final day of the 1990 season, making Mr. Morgan the first Boston skipper to reach the postseason twice in three years since Bill Carrigan in 1915-16-18 during the franchise’s early glory days. Both times, Mr. Morgan’s Sox were swept by Oakland in the playoffs.

Mr. Morgan, who was handed the position at 57 after John McNamara was dismissed at midseason, was the first Red Sox manager with local roots since Charlestown’s Shano Collins oversaw the sagging club in the early 1930s. Mr. Morgan was a lifelong resident of Walpole (“If you don’t live there, you’re just camping out”) whose offseason jobs during his minor league years made him an empathetic figure to the club’s working-class supporters.

“You can all relate to Joe,” club broadcaster Joe Castiglione told an audience, “because at one time or another, he’s probably done the job you do.”

“Tollway Joe,” as Mr. Morgan was dubbed for his snowplowing prowess along the Massachusetts Turnpike, also worked as a carpenter, bricklayer, oil deliveryman, census taker, substitute teacher, truck dispatcher, and mail sorter to augment his modest baseball salary.

“If the snow didn’t come, I’d do everything,” said Mr. Morgan, who had four children. “I’d saw wood, everything, paint, everything. Because I had to work 40 hours a week.”

The son of Irish immigrants from County Clare, Mr. Morgan attended Boston College on a hockey scholarship and was the leading scorer and captain-elect for a varsity that had a 17-3 record in 1952.

“If I was born in Canada, I would have played on the NHL for a long, long time,” he said. “I had the ability. All I needed was more ice time growing up.”

When the hometown Braves offered him a \$22,500 bonus to play baseball, Mr. Morgan left school (returning later to earn his degree in history and government) and began his pro career as a Single-A shortstop in Hartford before spending two years in the Army, laying phone lines at Fort Sill in Oklahoma.

While Mr. Morgan made it to the big leagues in 1959 and went on to play 88 games as a light-hitting infielder for five clubs across four seasons, he spent most of his career riding buses in the bushes, performing for eight

clubs in 13 years in places ranging from Wichita, Kan., to Louisville to San Juan.

“I was bouncing all over hell,” observed Mr. Morgan, who once phoned the St. Louis front office while en route south to ask whether he’d been assigned to Charleston, W.Va., or Charleston, S.C.

His coaching career began in 1966 when the Pirates offered to increase his salary to \$10,000 if he agreed to be player-manager of their Raleigh affiliate. Mr. Morgan spent seven more seasons in the Pittsburgh system, where he was considered by the players to be a straight shooter.

“You can’t meet a more honest guy,” said Richie Hebner, the Norwood star who played for Mr. Morgan in Raleigh. “You’ve got to like to play for the guy. There’s no bull. He won’t con anybody.”

After he was named Minor League Manager of the Year in 1973, Mr. Morgan switched to the Sox’ Triple-A club in Pawtucket, R.I., where he developed a reputation for preparing future stars, among them Jim Rice, Fred Lynn, Wade Boggs, Rick Burleson, Butch Hobson, Bruce Hurst, and Rich Gedman.

“I don’t think he got enough credit for how baseball-smart he was. He played baseball hunches instead of statistics,” Boggs said in a team release Sunday. “He will always be one of my favorites.”

Mr. Morgan spent nine years directing the PawSox, winning more than 600 games during the longest tenure in club annals, yet he attracted no major league offers from other clubs.

“You’d think they’d have noticed by now, but I’m not panicking,” he remarked in 1979. “I really don’t have a timetable. There’s no such animal. But if I’m going to be a big-league manager I’d like to be able to move around a little bit.”

Mr. Morgan later acknowledged that his understated style might have worked against him.

“If you know you can do the job, then you’ve got to sell yourself,” he mused. “I laid back and figured that somebody would see me and they’ll know I’m good, but it didn’t work.”

After spending two years as a scout, Mr. Morgan finally donned a Boston uniform in 1985 when he served as McNamara’s first base coach. He oversaw the bullpen for the 1986 pennant winners, then moved to third base the following year. When McNamara was fired at the 1988 All-Star break, Mr. Morgan was promoted as a fill-in.

“You’ll be the manager while we look around for one,” general manager Lou Gorman told him.

“Don’t look around,” Mr. Morgan replied. “You’re looking at him right now. It’s me.”

The club, which was nine games behind Detroit, responded by winning its next dozen as Mr. Morgan ignored the “interim” label. “I’m the manager of this nine,” he declared following a dugout scuffle with Rice, who’d objected to being pulled for a pinch-hitter.

Mr. Morgan’s old-time expressions were a throwback to the days of flannel uniforms and Sunday doubleheaders. “Hitting one over the

bricks.” “Spinning a beauty.” “Smacking that pea around the yard.” And “six, two, and even” a phrase used by Humphrey Bogart in “The Maltese Falcon.”

“It means que pasa, who gives a hell, anything you want,” Mr. Morgan explained. “It’s just six, two, and even, boys, let’s go.”

While his abrupt elevation to the job (“Definitely a Cinderella deal”) and significant salary boost were gratifying, Mr. Morgan quickly got a dose of the hottest seat in Boston when he opened a letter from a disgruntled fan after the club’s 12th straight triumph.

“You know what the guy said?” Mr. Morgan related. “You’ve got the wrong lineup on the field.”

Mr. Morgan’s laidback approach was a comfortable fit for a club that perennially operated beneath an unforgiving microscope.

“Nobody ever left his dugout mad,” said former Sox star Johnny Pesky, Gorman’s special assistant. “He got along with players and would answer media questions by the hour.”

Mr. Morgan managed primarily by feel, often following his hunches, and airily dismissed comments about his “karma.”

“Karma? I don’t want to talk about that,” he said. “If you win, you’re great. If you lose, you stink. End of story.”

When the Sox slipped to third place in 1989 and some members of what he’d called a “dead-ass club” began complaining about him, Mr. Morgan shrugged off the griping.

“I would say there are a few that don’t give a damn about me, but the rest do,” he reckoned. “I don’t want to get into numbers but it’s usually the guys that aren’t doing good.”

Mr. Morgan’s employers, who gave him multiple extensions and pay raises, were solidly behind him.

“He does it his way,” Gorman said. “He’s unorthodox in his approach, but it works.”

The Sox rebounded in 1990 to reclaim the division title but again were blanked by the Athletics in the playoffs as criticism of Mr. Morgan’s style mounted from inside and outside the clubhouse.

“I’ll tell you this,” Mr. Morgan observed. “If a guy is going to manage in Boston, that guy better have some thick skin on his body.”

While the Sox were in the chase throughout the spring of 1991, they faded in July and collapsed in the final two weeks of the season, finishing seven games behind Toronto in second place. Mr. Morgan, who’d been given a one-year extension and a raise to \$375,000 in June (“Pretty good coin”) and who felt that he’d done a creditable job with a flawed team, was dismissed in October.

“They pay the bills, they can do what they want, and that’s the way it should be,” he said, while telling the front office that the team wasn’t as good as they thought. The Red Sox finished in last place the following season with Butch Hobson as manager.

After turning down an offer to be a special assistant to Gorman, Mr. Morgan bade farewell to the game.

“I didn’t want to manage anymore,” he said. “I did plenty of roaming around the country, in and out of hotels and planes and all that jazz.”

At 60, Mr. Morgan had grown weary of the year-round grind of managing in the majors.

“The worst part of this job is probably the time it takes out of your life, your soul,” he mused. “It’s a demanding job, especially when you live in the area.”

Mr. Morgan went home to Walpole and a retirement of golfing, gardening, and candlepin bowling.

“He was one of a kind. One of my best friends for 41 years,” Castiglione said in a team release. “A great baseball mind with incredible intuition. He would have never needed analytics. A very loyal friend and a great storyteller. He will be missed.”

Mr. Morgan’s wife Dorothy died in 2016. He is survived by his children, Catherine, Joseph Jr., William, and Barbara; six grandchildren and five great grandchildren.

When he returned to Fenway in 2013 for a 25th reunion of the 1988 club, he was asked how he thought he’d do as a present-day manager.

“I’d be dynamite,” Mr. Morgan replied. “What else would you expect?”



EBRAHIM NOROOZI/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Lorela Cubaj (right) and the Italian defense really mucked things up for Aliyah Boston and Team USA.

FIBA WOMEN’S WORLD CUP

US survives big upset bid

By Doug Feinberg
ASSOCIATED PRESS

USA 55 BERLIN — The United States faced its stiffest challenge in nearly two decades in the women’s **Italy 52** FIBA World Cup, and escaped with a win over Italy thanks to a few timely baskets late and a key defensive play by Chelsea Gray.

Jackie Young scored 10 points to lead the struggling offense in Sunday’s 55-52 win. It was the fewest points the Americans had scored in a World Cup win since they beat Australia, 42-38, in 1967.

“You have to be able to win different ways in this tournament because every team stylistically plays a little bit different,” coach Kara Lawson said. “You do have to be able to win when you don’t have your fastball. We didn’t have a fastball tonight, but we figured it out late and we’ll grow from it.”

The Americans (2-0) have won 32 straight Cup games dating back to a loss to Russia in the 2006 semifinals. Only one team had come within single digits of Team USA during this run, when Australia lost by 8 points in 2010.

The Americans trailed, 50-48, with 4:29 left before going on a 7-0 run. Breanna Stewart, who missed her first eight shots, scored her first basket of the game to put the Americans up, 51-50. Young then hit a layup after Gray drew an offensive foul with 3:03 left.

Gray’s jumper with 1:07 left made it a 5-point game, but Matilde Villa scored to get Italy back within three with less than a minute to go. Team USA had a couple of chances to make it a two-possession lead, but couldn’t convert. Italy (1-1) had one last chance to tie it, but Cecilia Zandavasini’s 3-pointer was off at the buzzer.

Italy’s 2-3 zone defense caused Team USA fits, as they couldn’t get into any rhythm and shot 29 percent from the field, including going 1 for 12 from 3-point range.

COLLEGE FOOTBALL NOTEBOOK

Nothing ‘unfair’ about Hail Mary

STAFF AND WIRE REPORTS

Western Michigan president **Russ Kavalhuna** said Sunday that he was told a review clock and the displayed game clock weren’t synched for Saturday night’s game at Michigan, leading to the one-second discrepancy that dominated the weekend of college football.

“It was a known discrepancy,” he said after Michigan got a second shot at a Hail Mary, which it converted to avert a major upset, 13-12, despite the NBC broadcast showing time running out on the first.

On what seemed to be the final play of a game heavily favored Michigan trailed, 12-7, **Bryce Underwood** chucked a pass that sailed beyond the end zone and into the arms of WMU’s **Micah Davis**. TV replays showed the clock hitting zero with the ball still in the air, but officials ruled there was a second still to play.

JJ Buchanan then pulled in Underwood’s 47-yard, second-chance miracle heave for a game-ending, game-winning touchdown in coach **Kyle Whittingham’s** Michigan debut.

The Big Ten stood by the review in a statement released two hours after the game, when it also published a recording of the replay as it was reviewed by the officials that showed the game clock at one second when the ball was touched.

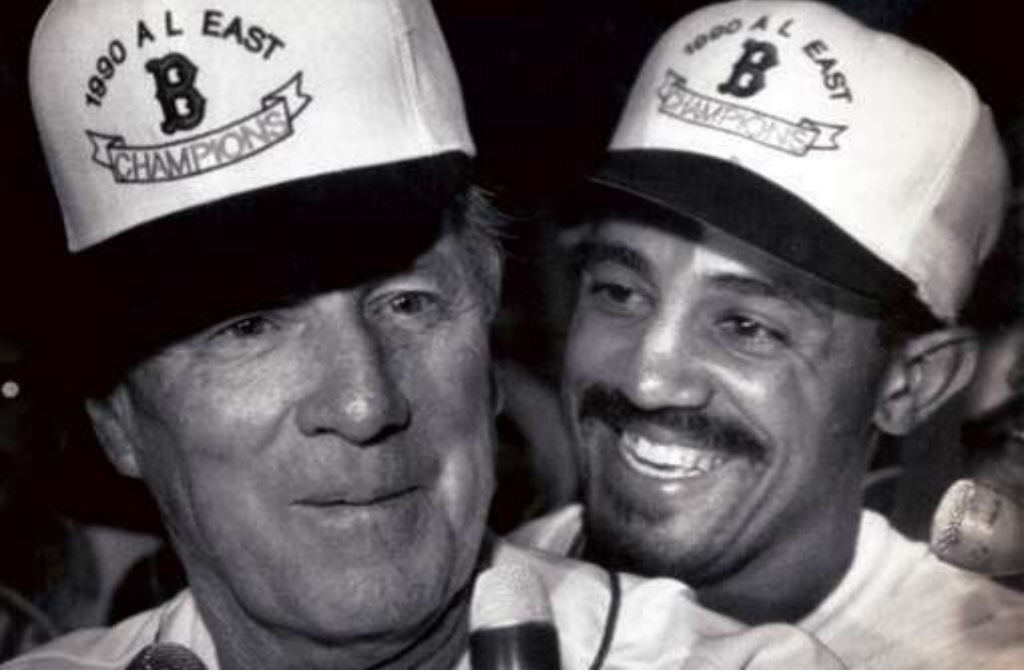
Mid-American Conference commissioner **Jon Steinbrecher** said the conference and school contacted the Big Ten office, seeking clarification on the review, and was provided with an explanation along with video and audio that confirmed it.

Kavalhuna said Sunday there are no appeals in the review process for either the Big Ten or the MAC.

“I don’t discern anything unfair in this process,” he said. “Can the process be improved by having what the viewing public see be the same as what the reviewing officials see? Maybe. Frankly, that’s not for me to decide.”

Washington victorious in Apple opener

Demond Williams Jr. threw for 268 yards and a touchdown, and No. 17 Washington survived offensive struggles for a 24-10 victory over Washington State in a season-opening Apple Cup in Seattle. Williams also scored on a 5-yard keeper in the 118th meeting of the two teams, who were once both part of the Pac-12 and traditionally played the rivalry game over Thanksgiving weekend . . . The much-anticipated first game of the **Lane Kiffin** era at LSU was delayed nearly two hours by lightning on Saturday and did not include **Dae’Quan Wright** and **Zxavian Harris**, whose ongoing effort to return to college football has brought a lot of attention — and no shortage of criticism — upon the Tigers’ lightning-rod coach. The two NFL signees were left off the roster in advance of Saturday night’s 51-10 victory over Clemson, which avoided a confrontation with the Southeastern Conference, which had passed a rule banning players who’d signed with NFL teams, only to see that rule put on hold Thursday by a court in Louisiana . . . Mount Union’s 85-game, regular-season winning streak ended Saturday in Illinois when **Aiden Byrne** blocked a potential tying extra point with 22 seconds left in Wheaton’s 24-23 victory in Division 3.



GLOBE FILE PHOTO

Joe Morgan and catcher Tony Peña celebrate the Red Sox winning the division in 1990.

A manager who was truly one of one, and one of us

►SHAUGHNESSY
Continued from Page C1

bound Sox were winning four straight against the Orioles in their wonderful “new” park at Camden Yards.

Morgan was a New England original. There will never be another.

He was one of us. He understood because he’d grown up in Walpole, gone to BC, and knew everything about the Boston baseball experience. He hitchhiked on the VFW Parkway, drove a snow plow on the Pike, and didn’t need notes on the Beanpot, the Swan Boats, or how every local baseball fan knew as much about the Red Sox as the manager of the Red Sox.

“Everybody played softball or baseball around here, and they’re all managers,” he said this past May.

Morgan went 301-262 and won two AL East titles in his short tenure, has a plaque in the Red Sox Hall of Fame, and in retirement watched every game on TV.

There’s great Morgan-Tracy symmetry in this wonderful 2026 season.

A local hockey and baseball star who made it to the big leagues for parts of four seasons, Morgan was a career minor-league skipper — cresting at Triple-A Pawtucket — who took over as interim Red Sox manager when John McNamara was fired in July 1988. The team won Morgan’s first 12 games and 19 of 20,

vaulting back into the pennant race and eventually coping the division.

Tracy, 41, is the son of big leaguer Jim Tracy and was in his fifth season with Boston’s AAA team at Worcester when the Sox fired Alex Cora and made him interim skipper on April 25. Two months into Tracy’s tenure, the Sox caught fire, winning 15 straight games to tie a record for the franchise and producing the best month in its 126-year history. Unlike Morgan, who was named permanent manager and got a contract extension in his first three weeks on the job, Tracy is still “interim.”

I called Morgan two and a half weeks ago to ask Joe why Tracy was still “interim.”

“It seems like it may be time for this guy,” Morgan said. “Why not?”

He reminded me that when he got his first contract extension to manage the Sox, it meant he would not have to cut his own cordwood for that cold baseball winter.

No one in Walpole needed Morgan’s autograph. At one time or another, Tollway Joe did just about every job in town, and a lot of folks had his signature on canceled checks.

Morgan had rare curiosity — “Ever seen a catcher with a sore arm?” he would ask — and was never afraid to say what was on his mind. He’d predict that Bruce Hurst “is going to spin a beauty;” tell the national media, “If you don’t live in Walpole, you’re just camping out;” and entertain with yarns about walking off Sam

Bowen’s 600-foot minor league homer and managing the 33-inning game between Pawtucket and Rochester.

He famously stood up to fearsome star Jim Rice in his first week on the job; “I’m the manager of this nine!” Joe fumed when Rice didn’t like being subbed for a pinch-hitter. He sometimes called out his team for playing “dead-ass baseball,” and once while at lunch on the road with a table of sportswriters, looked up from his plate and asked, “How many of you guys have smoked marijuana?”

His tenure ended abruptly in October 1991. Even though Morgan had two AL East titles in his pocket and had managed to keep the sloppy ‘91 Sox in the hunt deep into the final month of that season, which they finished 84-78, the Sox said they needed to promote Pawtucket skipper Butch Hobson, who was drawing a “lot of interest” from other teams.

Joe’s parting words: “These guys aren’t as good as everybody thinks they are.”

The Sox went 73-89 the following season, finished in last place, and never had a winning season under Hobson.

Joe Morgan. Red Sox legend. Number one manager of the Local Nine.

Dan Shaughnessy is a Globe columnist. He can be reached at daniel.shaughnessy@globe.com. Follow him @dan_shaughnessy.

Baseball

INTERNATIONAL LEAGUE					EASTERN LEAGUE							
EAST					NORTHEAST							
W	L	Pct.	GB		W	L	Pct.	GB				
Rochester	37	25	.597	—	Reading	35	26	.574	—			
Scranton/W-B	35	25	.583	1	Binghamton	33	29	.532	2½			
Worcester	34	26	.567	2	Somerset	33	29	.532	2½			
Durham	33	28	.541	3½	Portland	31	31	.500	4½			
Syracuse	33	28	.541	3½	Hartford	25	37	.403	10½			
Charlotte	32	30	.516	5	New Hampshire	23	39	.371	12½			
Buffalo	29	31	.483	7	SOUTHWEST							
Lehigh Valley	29	32	.475	7½	W	L	Pct.	GB				
Jacksonville	26	35	.426	10½	Erie	40	22	.645	—			
Norfolk	24	35	.407	11½	Chesapeake	34	27	.557	5½			
WEST					Akron	30	30	.500	9			
W	L	Pct.	GB		Harrisburg	30	30	.500	9			
Indianapolis	35	27	.565	—	Richmond	30	31	.492	9½			
St. Paul	34	28	.548	1	Altoona	24	37	.393	15½			
Columbus	32	28	.533	2	SUNDAY'S RESULTS							
Nashville	32	29	.525	2½	Portland 9.....	at Chesapeake	7					
Toledo	32	30	.516	3	Altoona 8.....	at Harrisburg	4					
Gwinnett	31	31	.500	4	Reading 6.....	at Hartford	2					
Omaha	29	31	.483	5	At Erie 11.....	Somerset	10					
Memphis	28	34	.452	7	New Hampshire 7.....	at Binghamton	6					
Iowa	27	35	.435	8	At Akron 14.....	Richmond	6					
Louisville	20	42	.323	15	SATURDAY'S RESULTS							
SUNDAY'S RESULTS					Portland 6.....	at Chesapeake	4					
At Buffalo 8.....	Worcester	7			At Erie 5.....	Somerset	5					
At Gwinnett 5.....	Charlotte	2			At Harrisburg 8.....	Altoona	5					
Jacksonville 3.....	at Norfolk	1			At Akron 9.....	Richmond	0					
At Columbus 6.....	Iowa	3			At Binghamton 3.....	New Hampshire	1					
At Nashville 4.....	Louisville	2			At Hartford 9.....	Reading	0					
At Scranton/W-B 7.....	Lehigh Valley	3			At Somerset 6.....	at Erie	3					
At Memphis 3.....	Durham	0			Portland, 9-7							
St. Paul 12.....	at Omaha	5			At Prince George's Stadium, Bowie, Md.							
At Syracuse 4.....	Rochester	3										
Indianapolis 8.....	at Toledo	5										
MONDAY'S GAMES					PORTLAND	AB	R	H	BI	BB	SO	Avg.
Scranton/W-B at Rochester.....	4:05				McDonald 3b	5	1	2	3	0	2	.230
Nashville at Durham.....	5:05				Gonzales rf	3	0	0	2	1	2	.163
SATURDAY'S RESULTS					Garcia c	4	1	1	0	1	0	.287
Worcester 4.....	at Buffalo	2			Rosario dh	4	1	1	0	1	0	.261
At Gwinnett 5.....	Charlotte	3			Godbout ss	5	2	0	0	1	0	.286
Lehigh Valley 8.....	at Scranton/W-B	6			White 2b	4	0	2	0	1	1	.189
Rochester 14.....	at Syracuse	9			Turner cf	4	2	1	0	0	1	.292
Jacksonville 11.....	at Norfolk	7			Ferguson 1b	5	1	1	0	0	2	.247
At Columbus 10.....	Iowa	5			Rose lf	3	2	1	0	1	0	.214
At Toledo 5.....	Indianapolis	3			Totals	37	9	17	7	10		
At Omaha 6.....	St. Paul	1			CHESAPEAKE	AB	R	H	BI	BB	SO	Avg.
At Memphis 3.....	Durham	1			Strada 2b	5	0	0	0	1	0	.139
Louisville 5.....	at Nashville	3			Honeycutt cf	5	2	3	1	0	1	.339
Buffalo, 8-7					Anderson c	4	1	1	1	1	0	.269
At Sahlen Field, Buffalo					Aloy ss	4	0	0	0	0	3	.256
WORCESTER	AB	R	H	BI	BB	SO	Avg.					
Ward cf	4	2	1	1	0	1	.238					
Arias ss	5	2	3	1	0	0	.328					
Seigler 3b	3	1	0	1	1	0	.277					
Gonzalez 2b	5	1	3	2	0	1	.348					
Campbell rf	4	0	3	2	1	0	.257					
Castro lf	5	0	0	0	0	0	.236					
Capra dh	4	0	0	0	1	2	.277					
Hickey 1b	4	1	1	0	1	1	.214					
Nido c	4	0	1	0	0	0	.230					
Totals	38	7	12	7	4	5						
BUFFALO	AB	R	H	BI	BB	SO	Avg.					
BUFFALO	AB	R	H	BI	BB	SO	Avg.					
Thomas cf	4	1	2	0	1	0	.400					
Harry ss	5	2	2	1	0	0	.291					
Pinagoo rf	5	0	0	0	0	1	.264					
Goodwin 3b	3	1	1	2	1	0	.271					
Williams dh	3	0	0	0	0	1	.233					
Schnr plr-of	0	1	0	0	1	0	.207					
Munguia lf	4	1	3	3	0	1	.321					
Sosa 1b	4	1	2	2	0	0	.237					
Mendoza 2b	4	0	0	0	0	0	.240					
Stubbs c	3	1	2	0	1	1	.208					
Totals	35	8	12	8	4	4						
Worcester.....	230	200	000	—	7	12	1					
Buffalo.....	100	000	70x	—	8	12	2					
LOB—Worcester 10, Buffalo 7. 2B—Ward, Arias, Campbell, Hickey, Munguia 2. HR—Harry, Sosa. SB—Ward, S—Seigler. DP—Worcester 1.												
Worcester	IP	H	R	ER	BB	SO	ERA					
Worcester	IP	H	R	ER	BB	SO	ERA					
Ziehl	5	3	1	1	1	2	4.30					
Brebba	1	1	0	0	0	2	5.34					
Bastardo	½	4	5	5	1	0	4.88					
Samaniego	¾	3	2	2	1	0	4.13					
Berrios	1	1	0	0	1	0	4.50					
Buffalo	IP	H	R	ER	BB	SO	ERA					
Buffalo	IP	H	R	ER	BB	SO	ERA					
Rogers	3½	10	7	6	1	1	6.34					
Gallagher	2½	1	0	0	0	3	6.75					
Guerra	1	0	0	0	2	1	3.60					
Dallas	1	0	0	0	0	0	3.14					
Cellucci	1	0	0	0	1	0	3.26					
HBP—by Rogers. T—2:38. A—7:398.												

Golf

DP WORLD: MASTERS					
At Crans-sur-Sierre Golf Club, Crans-Montana, Switzerland					
Yardage: 6,830; par: 70					
T. Lawrence.....	64	63	73	62	15
Paul Casey.....	67	64	63	68	16
Harry Hall.....	65	68	67	63	17
Angel Ayora.....	64	68	66	66	18
Angel Hidalgo.....	70	63	67	64	19
F. Laporta.....	67	67	65	65	20
E. Lopez-Chacarr.....	65	67	65	67	21
B. Wiesberger.....	69	68	63	64	22
Joel Gurrbach.....	70	63	67	65	23
Matt Wallace.....	68	66	66	65	24
Nacho Elvira.....	67	62	68	69	25
R. Hojgaard.....	68	66	66	66	26
J. Lagergren.....	66	66	68	66	27
Patrick Reed.....	66	67	67	66	28
A. Halvorsen.....	69	66	68	65	29
Antoine Rozner.....	66	67	67	68	30
M. Steinehrner.....	66	68	63	71	31
Todd Clements.....	64	68	67	70	32
Hootong Li.....	67	68	68	66	33
Marco Penge.....	68	68	65	69	34
Tom Vaillant.....	69	68	67	65	35
Erik van Rooyen.....	67	67	63	72	36
Fred Biondi.....	67	67	69	67	37
Davis Bryant.....	66	66	70	68	38
R. Cabrera Bello.....	66	65	69	70	39
R. Langasque.....	68	67	65	70	40
Keita Nakajima.....	67	63	69	71	41
Brandon Stone.....	69	63	69	69	42
Ashun Wu.....	63	68	70	69	43
Thomas Detry.....	68	64	70	69	44
Sergio Garcia.....	70	63	72	66	45
Ryan Gerard.....	69	68	65	69	46
Jack Yule.....	69	67	67	69	47
Casey James.....	67	69	66	69	48
Zander Lombard.....	69	68	66	68	49
David Puig.....	66	67	67	71	50
Jeremy Paul.....	65	64	72	71	51
Jack Yule.....	69	66	70	68	52
I. C. Gutierrez.....	66	71	67	69	53
Sean Crocker.....	73	64	64	72	54
Joost Luiten.....	67	69	73	64	55
Stefano Mazzioli.....	67	70	69	67	56
Adrian Meronk.....	66	66	72	74	57
Danny Willett.....	69	66	74	74	58
Joshua Berry.....	67	68	71	69	59
Quentin Debove.....	68	67	69	71	60
Estrada 2b.....	5	0	0	0	61
McDonough 3b.....	5	1	2	3	62
Gonzales rf.....	3	0	0	2	63
Garcia c.....	4	1	1	0	64
Aloy ss.....	4	0	0	0	65
Figueroa 1b.....	3	2	1	2	66
O'Ferrall 3b.....	4	0	0	0	67
Josenberger rf.....	4	2	3	0	68
De L Snts dh.....	3	0	1	2	69
Peguero lf.....	3	0	0	0	70
Tuft pf-if.....	1	0	0	0	71
Totals.....	37	9	6	3	72
CHESAPEAKE					
AB	R	H	BI	BB	SO
CHESAPEAKE	AB	R	H	BI	BB
Estrada 2b.....	5	0	0	0	1
McDonough 3b.....	5	2	3	1	0
Gonzales rf.....	3	0	0	2	1
Garcia c.....	4	1	1	1	3
Aloy ss.....	4	0	0	0	3
Figueroa 1b.....	3	2	1	2	1
O'Ferrall 3b.....	4	0	0	0	1
Josenberger rf.....	4	2	3	0	0
De L Snts dh.....	3	0	1	2	1
Peguero lf.....	3	0	0	0	2
Tuft pf-if.....	1	0	0	0	0
Totals.....	36	7	9	6	3
PORTLAND					
AB	R	H	BI	BB	SO
PORTLAND	AB	R	H	BI	BB
Bolden.....	2	2	2	2	1
Carlson.....	3	1	1	1	0
Adams.....	1½	5	3	3	2
Davis.....	2½	1	1	0	3
CHESAPEAKE					
IP	H	R	ER	BB	SO
CHESAPEAKE	IP	H	R	ER	BB
Gongora.....	3	3	1	1	2
Pham.....	1	1	3	0	1
Guasch.....	1	3	4	4	1
Cabrera.....	2	1	0	0	2
Long.....	2	1	1	1	1
SOUTH ATLANTIC LEAGUE					
SUNDAY'S RESULTS					
At Bowling Green 4.....	Greenville	3			
At Rome 12.....	Winston-Salem	4			
At Wilmington 6.....	Hudson Valley	5			
Frederick 6.....	at Brooklyn	5			
At Hub City 1.....	Jersey Shore	0			
Greensboro 6.....	at Asheville	4			
SATURDAY'S RESULT					
Greenville 5.....	at Bowling Green	1			
Jersey Shore 7.....	at Hub City	5			
Frederick 7.....	at Brooklyn	3			
Greensboro 11.....	at Asheville	4			
At Wilmington 5.....	Hudson Valley	3			
At Rome 13.....	Winston-Salem	6			

Remembered

SHARE YOUR MEMORIES ON OUR GUEST BOOK AT [BOSTON.COM/OBITUARIES](http://boston.com/obituaries)

BY CITY AND TOWN

BROOKLINE FORREST, Isabel HOLLOMON, Nancy Gade	NEWTON FORREST, Isabel MARTIN, Austin Randolph
CHESTNUT HILL MARTIN, Austin Randolph	QUINCY JUDGE, Catherine T. (McCarthy)
DORCHESTER JONES, Richard E. JUDGE, Catherine T. (McCarthy)	WATERTOWN MARTIN, Austin Randolph
EAST BOSTON SERINO, Rosemarie	WELLESLEY MARTIN, Austin Randolph
LYNNFIELD O'KEEFE, Assunta	
NEEDHAM MARTIN, Austin Randolph	
NEW ASHFORD JUDGE, Catherine T. (McCarthy)	OUT OF STATE
NEWBURYPORT SERINO, Rosemarie	NEW YORK HOLLOMON, Nancy Gade

FORREST, Isabel



Age 96, passed away peacefully, on September 2, 2026, in Dedham, Massachusetts. Born and raised in Philadelphia, Isabel later made her home in Massachusetts. She will be remembered for her devotion to her family. She is survived by her daughter, Marci and her husband, Michael; granddaughter, Abbe and her husband, Stephen; grandson, Jake and his wife, Jackie; and great-grandchildren, Hunter, Piper, and Willa. Isabel was deeply loved by her family and will be greatly missed. Shiva will be at NewBridge on the Charles, in Dedham, on September 8, from 2–6 p.m. May her memory be a blessing.

Funeral Services



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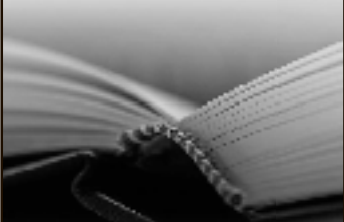
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JONES, Richard E. “Dick”



Of Dorchester, passed away on September 5, 2026.

Richard was the beloved husband of Bonnie (Roberto) Jones and the devoted son of the late Charles and Kathryn Jones. He was the cherished father of Debbie McIntyre and her husband John of Winthrop, Cheryl Marino and her partner David Fasano of Lynnfield, Diane Kyne and her husband Joe of Dorchester, and Michael Jones and his wife Cordae of Milton.

He was the proud Grampy of Julia and Jack McIntyre, Gianna and Nick Marino, Luke, Ava, and Lila Kyne, and Michael and Camden Jones. He held close the memory of his late granddaughter, Allesandra McIntyre.

He was the brother of Virginia Devlin, Charles Jones, and Francis Jones, and the late Kathleen Jones.

Visiting Hours will be held at the Alfred D. Thomas Funeral Home, 326 Granite Ave., MILTON, on Thursday, September 10th, from 4–7 p.m. Funeral Mass at St. Brendan’s Church, Dorchester, on Friday, September 11th, at 12:30 p.m. Burial will be at Blue Hill Cemetery.

In lieu of flowers, donations may be made in Richard’s memory to the Boston Fire Department Relief Fund.

JUDGE, Catherine T. “Kay” (McCarthy)



of Quincy and Nashua NH, formerly of Dorchester passed away on September 1, 2026. She was the beloved wife of 67 years of the late James J. Judge Jr.(BPD), loving mother of James J. Judge III and his wife Mary (Cahill) of Harwich Port and Naples, FL, and Kathy Morrissey and her husband Brian of Nashua, NH. She was a doting grandmother to Courtney (Tim) Ceurvels, James (Lauren), Sean (Carson), and Jack Judge, and Kerry (Brad) Keeler, Brian (Kayla), Andrew (Lexie), Kevin (Kelly) Morrissey and Colleen (Matthew) Sargent. She was also blessed with 18 great-grandchildren, each of whom brought her great happiness.

Visiting hours at the Alfred D. Thomas Funeral Home 326 Granite Ave Milton on Tuesday September 8th from 3-7pm. Funeral Mass Sacred Heart Church in North Quincy on Wednesday September 9th at 10:30. Burial Blue Hill Cemetery, Braintree. For complete obituary please see www.alfreddthomas.com

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Funeral and Memorial Information Council

MARTIN, Austin Randolph



Of Needham, formerly of Watertown, passed away peacefully, on September 2, 2026, after a fierce battle with cancer that did not slow him until his final moments.

He was the husband and steadfast partner of Lindsay (Ruhlmann) Martin; and the immensely proud father of Isabelle and Graham Martin. He was the dear son of Leo and Joan (Donahue) Martin of Watertown; brother of Benjamin Martin and his wife, Brette of Bethesda, Maryland and Joseph Martin and Anne Weiss of Boston; son-in-law of Albert and Audrey Ruhlmann of River Edge, New Jersey; and brother-in-law of Heather Bianchi and her husband, Robert of Haymarket, Virginia and Allison Richardson and her husband, James of Hingham, Massachusetts. He was a loving uncle to Grace, Owen, Avery, Caroline, Bo, and Zoey; and is also survived by the many cousins he chose not only as family, but as friends.

Austin lived according to a deeply held set of values. His faith grounded him. His family came first. He showed up for his friends, always saw the best in people, and made those around him feel welcomed and valued. His home was a place where there was always room for one more person at the table.

The Jesuit ideals that shaped Austin at Boston College High School and Georgetown University: faith, service, community, and being a man for others, remained central throughout his life. He later earned his MBA from the MIT Sloan School of Management.

Austin believed deeply in community and in being present for the people he loved. He found enormous joy in watching Isabelle and Graham grow into themselves. He treasured Sunday dinners with his parents, chose his brothers as some of his closest friends, and maintained lifelong friendships with a loyalty and constancy that were unmistakably his.

Austin brought tremendous energy, discipline, and an intense work ethic to everything he did. He was deeply accomplished, but he measured his life less by achievement than by the strength of his relationships, the commitments he kept, and the people he loved.

He moved through life with unmistakable enthusiasm and an inquisitive nature, deeply interested in people, ideas, and the world around him. Austin made his mark through his generosity, loyalty, faith, humor, determination, and unwavering devotion to those he loved. He will be missed every day, but his influence will remain present, in his children, his family and friends, the communities he helped shape and the countless ways those who loved him will carry forward the values by which he lived.

Visiting Hours will be held at the George F. Doherty & Sons Funeral Home, 1305 Highland Ave., NEEDHAM, on Tuesday, September 8, from 3:00 to 7:00 p.m. A Funeral Mass will be celebrated at St. Ignatius of Loyola Church, 28 Commonwealth Ave., Chestnut Hill, on Wednesday, September 9, at 10:00 a.m. Relatives and friends kindly invited. Interment will be private. In lieu of flowers, donations may be made to the Jimmy Fund in gratitude for the extraordinary care Austin received at Dana-Farber Cancer Institute, which allowed him to live so fully throughout his illness. For online guestbook, gfdoherty.com

George F. Doherty & Sons
Needham 781.444.0687

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Austin brought tremendous energy, discipline, and an intense work ethic to everything he did. He was deeply accomplished, but he measured his life less by achievement than by the strength of his relationships, the commitments he kept, and the people he loved.

He moved through life with unmistakable enthusiasm and an inquisitive nature, deeply interested in people, ideas, and the world around him. Austin made his mark through his generosity, loyalty, faith, humor, determination, and unwavering devotion to those he loved. He will be missed every day, but his influence will remain present, in his children, his family and friends, the communities he helped shape and the countless ways those who loved him will carry forward the values by which he lived.

Visiting Hours will be held at the George F. Doherty & Sons Funeral Home, 1305 Highland Ave., NEEDHAM, on Tuesday, September 8, from 3:00 to 7:00 p.m. A Funeral Mass will be celebrated at St. Ignatius of Loyola Church, 28 Commonwealth Ave., Chestnut Hill, on Wednesday, September 9, at 10:00 a.m. Relatives and friends kindly invited. Interment will be private. In lieu of flowers, donations may be made to the Jimmy Fund in gratitude for the extraordinary care Austin received at Dana-Farber Cancer Institute, which allowed him to live so fully throughout his illness. For online guestbook, gfdoherty.com

Of Lynnfield, Assunta “Tina,” age 71. Loving daughter of the late Francesco and Carmela Silvestri; beloved wife of nearly 51 years to William O’Keefe; loving mother of Christina Minassian and her husband, Michael, Paul O’Keefe and his wife, Rebecca, Timothy O’Keefe and his wife, Kerianne, and William J. O’Keefe; beloved “Mema” to 9 grandchildren; and loving sister to 3, as well as a devoted aunt and niece.

Visiting Hours: Family and friends are invited to attend her Funeral Service on Wednesday, September 9, 2026, at 11:00 a.m. at Calvary Christian Church, 47 Grove Street, Lynnfield. Burial will follow at Puritan Lawn Memorial Park, Lake Street, Peabody.

Visiting Hours will be held on Tuesday, September 8, 2026, from 4:00 p.m. to 8:00 p.m. at Solimine Funeral Homes, 67 Ocean Street (Route 1A), Lynn, MA 01902.

O'KEEFE, Assunta “Tina”



Of Lynnfield, Assunta “Tina,” age 71. Loving daughter of the late Francesco and Carmela Silvestri; beloved wife of nearly 51 years to William O’Keefe; loving mother of Christina Minassian and her husband, Michael, Paul O’Keefe and his wife, Rebecca, Timothy O’Keefe and his wife, Kerianne, and William J. O’Keefe; beloved “Mema” to 9 grandchildren; and loving sister to 3, as well as a devoted aunt and niece.

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Share a memory

Or add a condolencece to the guestbook at boston.com/obituaries

SERINO, Rosemarie



Of Newburyport, Massachusetts, passed peacefully at Portsmouth Regional Hospital on September 2, 2026, surrounded by her loving family, holding the hand of her beloved daughter, Cyndi.

Born on January 22, 1937, in Boston, MA, Rosemarie was born to the late Enrico Renaldo “Henry” and Rosa Maria “Nella” (Fanzilli) Zeuli. Rosemarie spent her early years in their family home at 211 East Eagle Street in East Boston, MA. She attended school in East Boston, during which time she met her late husband of sixty-three years, Robert J. Serino. Theirs was a lasting love, and fifty years later, they renewed their vows.

Rosemarie enjoyed her career as an executive legal secretary at a prestigious law firm in downtown Boston. A proud member of the Newburyport community for 40 years, she later worked at River Valley Charter School until retiring in 2020. Through her work and involvement with the Newburyport Republican Committee, Newburyport Horticultural Society, Newburyport Senior Community Center, and numerous volunteer events, she formed lasting friendships and touched many lives.

Known to her family as Mimi, she brought everyone together through amazing Italian family dinners, joyful holidays and family gatherings, and spirited political discussions around the table. Family was everything to her.

Her life was never boring and full of adventure - world travel, boats, camping, motorcycling, road trips (lots of toys). Even though she experienced travel, Plum Island remained her favorite place.

She was extremely positive and always reminded her family to choose to look up. In many ways, she was like Snow White, who also made her debut in 1937, happy in her backyard gardens while caring for all her critters. Several times a year, she found spiritual renewal at religious retreats at Eastern Point Retreat House in Gloucester, MA. She stayed healthy by walking every day into her early 80s, following various routes from Low Street to High Street and through downtown along the waterfront. Everywhere she walked, people knew her.

Rosemarie was the proud matriarch of four generations, and a devoted wife, mother, grandmother, and great-grandmother. She was predeceased by her husband, Robert; and their son, Steven Serino, who sadly passed away in December 2001. Rosemarie is survived by her son, Dr. Robert M. Serino, and his wife, Patty, as well as her daughter, Cynthia Vaughn, and her husband, David Pompeo. She is also survived by her grandchildren: Robert J.H. Serino and his wife, Amy, Erica Vaughn and her husband, Dane, Alexandra Serino and her husband, Daniel, and Kristen Vaughn-Welch and her husband, Tristan. She especially treasured the closeness she shared with her six great-grandchildren, Olivia, Parker, Grant, Luke, Henry, and Leo, and the joy of seeing four generations of her family together.

Though Mimi would always say, “It is what it is,” it will never be the same without her.

Visiting Hours will be held on Wednesday, September 9, 2026, from 4:00 to 8:00 PM, at Twomey, LeBlanc & Conte Funeral Home, 193 High Street, NEWBURYPORT, MA. Her Funeral Mass will be celebrated at 10:30 AM on Thursday, September 10, 2026, at Immaculate Conception Church, 42 Green Street, Newburyport, MA. Burial to follow at St. Mary’s Cemetery.

For directions or to offer online condolences, please visit www.ticfuneralhome.com

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To submit an obituary for editorial consideration, please send the information and a photo by e-mail to obits@globe.com, or information by fax to **617.929.3186**. If you need further assistance about a news obituary, please call **617.929.3400**.

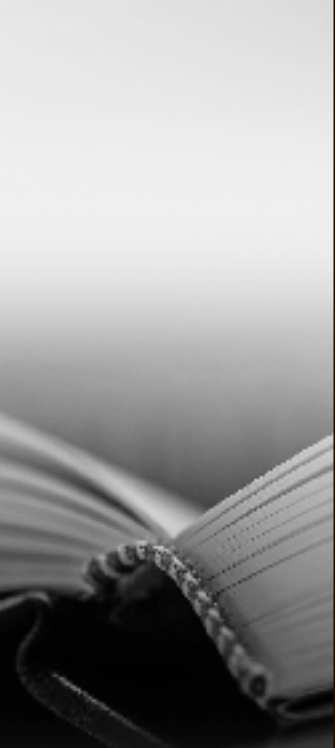
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Obituaries

Ada Yonath, 87, groundbreaking chemist and first Israeli woman to receive a Nobel

By Jonathan Kandell
NEW YORK TIMES

Ada Yonath, a boundary-pushing Israeli chemist whose ingenuity and tenacity helped unlock the inner workings of the ribosome — the microscopic factory inside every living cell that builds the proteins necessary for life — died Monday. She was 87.

The Weizmann Institute of Science, near Tel Aviv, Israel, where Dr. Yonath worked for decades, announced the death but did not provide further details.

Dr. Yonath's career was defined by a question that had long bedeviled scientists: What does the ribosome actually look like? Determining its three-dimensional structure at the molecular level was considered one of biology's most elusive challenges.

Her work, once dismissed as impractical, ultimately earned her a share of the 2009 Nobel Prize in Chemistry and opened new pathways for designing antibiotics at a time when drug resistance has become a global threat.

In her Nobel acceptance speech, Dr. Yonath, the first Israeli woman to receive a Nobel, recalled the years of skepticism and ridicule that greeted her research. Distinguished colleagues, she said, insisted that all that could be learned about ribosomes was already known, and warned that her project was a “dead end.” She said some even added: “You will be dead before you get there.”

For decades, scientists knew in broad terms that if DNA is the blueprint of life, ribosomes act as the construction crew. They understood that ribosomes translate genetic information encoded in DNA and assemble proteins accordingly.

But they could not see how the process worked at the molecular level, because ribosomes are extraordinarily complex and are constantly in motion as they perform their task. Capturing their structure — especially in action — seemed nearly impossible.

Working at the Weizmann Institute, Dr. Yonath set out in the 1970s to use X-ray crystallogra-



MICHAEL PROBST/ASSOCIATED PRESS/FILE

Dr. Ada Yonath (right), and Harry Noller from the University of California, Santa Cruz, after they were awarded the Paul Ehrlich and Ludwig Darmstaedter science prize in 2007.

phy to map the ribosome's structure. The method requires coaxing molecules into forming crystals, which can then be bombarded with X-rays to reveal their atomic arrangement. It had worked for simpler molecules, but most experts believed ribosomes were too large, too fragile, and too dynamic to crystallize.

Dr. Yonath disagreed. Her approach combined ingenuity with stubbornness. She turned to extremophile bacteria — organisms that live in harsh environments like hot springs and salt flats — reasoning that their ribosomes might be more stable and therefore easier to crystallize. She also developed techniques to freeze ribosomal crystals at very low temperatures, preserving their structure long enough for analysis.

Progress was slow and often discouraging. Yet she persisted, refining her methods step by step.

By the 1980s and 1990s, her laboratory began producing increasingly detailed images of the ribosome. Around the same time, other researchers — nota-

bly Venkatraman Ramakrishnan, an India-born, British American structural biologist, and Thomas Steitz, an American biochemist — entered the field. All three of their efforts culminated in the first high-resolution images of the ribosome's structure at the turn of the 21st century.

For this achievement, they shared the Nobel Prize. In announcing the award, the Nobel committee highlighted their roles in clarifying “fundamental and medically important aspects of ribosome function” that led to “the development of novel antibiotic drugs in the ongoing medical struggle against the ever emerging drug resistance among bacterial pathogens.”

Dr. Yonath, chosen among the three to deliver the Nobel acceptance speech because of her resolve and her pioneering methodology for ribosome crystallography, said that the earliest inspiration for her research came from the polar bear.

“Polar bears pack their ribosomes in an orderly way in their cells just before hibernation,” she said, “and these stay intact

and functional for months. I said: ‘If polar bears know how to do it, we can do it too.’”

Ada Esther Lifshitz, the elder of two sisters, was born on June 22, 1939, in Jerusalem, then under British Mandate rule. Her parents, Hillel and Esther Lifshitz, were Polish immigrants who had arrived six years earlier.

Her father barely made a living as a rabbi and neighborhood grocer, and the family was forced to share a cramped apartment with her mother's sisters and their families.

After the death of Ada's father when she was 11 years old, the family moved to Tel Aviv, where her mother became a low-paid clerk in Israel's finance ministry.

To the publication The Conversation, she recalled being “shocked” when her mother, newly widowed and filling out forms, seemed unable to perform basic calculations.

“This really stuck with me,” she said. “Knowledge and understanding and skills of this nature became important for me.”

Because of her excellent test scores, Ada was accepted to

Hideki Shirakawa, who helped turn a lab error into a Nobel, at 90

By Dylan Loeb McClain
NEW YORK TIMES

Hideki Shirakawa, a Japanese chemist who shared the Nobel Prize in 2000 for the discovery of plastics that can conduct electricity, a breakthrough that had commercial applications including making new types of semiconductors and inexpensive solar panels, died Aug. 24 in Yokohama, Japan. He was 90.

His death, at a hospital, was from liver cancer, according to the University of Tsukuba, where he was an emeritus professor.

The initial discovery of plastics that can conduct electricity was the result of a mistake.

One day in 1967, Dr. Shirakawa and other scientists were in a laboratory at the Tokyo Institute of Technology (now the Institute of Science Tokyo) working on synthesizing polyacetylene, a type of organic polymer.

Organic polymers are long chains of molecules with central strands of carbon atoms that have alternating single and double bonds of shared electrons between the carbon atoms. Polyacetylene is made by adding a catalyst to acetylene to create those bonds. Though polyacetylene had first been synthesized

in 1958, chemists had not studied it much.

Whether it was an error in the instructions or an error in reading them, someone accidentally added 1,000 times too much catalyst to the reaction to create the polyacetylene. Instead of getting a black powdery substance, as expected, the result was a silvery film that looked more like metal than plastic. Dr. Shirakawa was intrigued by the result and began studying the unusual material to better understand its properties.

Seven years later, during a conference at the institute, Dr. Shirakawa met Alan MacDiarmid, a chemistry professor at the University of Pennsylvania who had also been studying metallic-looking films made of polymers. MacDiarmid invited Dr. Shirakawa to come to Penn for one year to collaborate on their research.

The two scientists exposed the silvery-film polymer to iodine vapor, which oxidized it. Aware that oxidation can change the optical properties of film, they asked Dr. Alan Heeger, a physicist at Penn whose specialty was understanding the macroscopic properties of matter, to analyze it.

Plastics are normally stable

compounds and do not conduct electricity, which makes them good insulators on wiring, for example. But Dr. Shirakawa and C.K. Chiang, one of Heeger's postdoctoral students, measured the conductivity of the oxidized film anyway and found something completely unexpected: Its conductivity had increased 10 million times.

The electrical surge was so sudden and so violent that Dr. Shirakawa hinted in his Nobel biography that the experiment damaged the equipment they were using to measure it. The oxidation had changed the normal properties of the polymer by removing some of its electrons, a change known as “doping,” allowing the remaining electrons to migrate freely just as they do on a copper wire.

The scientists had discovered electricity-conducting plastic, and they announced their findings in a 1977 article in the Journal of the Chemical Society, Chemical Communications.

It took some time for the scientific community to develop products based on their discovery. But by 2000, when the three scientists shared the Nobel in chemistry, the conductive plastics were being used to protect

electronics and photographic film from static electricity and to make new kinds of light-emitting diodes. New products were also in development, including innovative types of solar panels and TV screens.

Hideki Shirakawa was born in Tokyo on Aug. 20, 1936. He was the third of five children of Hatsutarou Shirakawa, a doctor, and Fuyuno Shirakawa, the daughter of the chief priest of a Buddhist temple. The family moved for his father's work and because of World War II before eventually settling in Takayama, his mother's hometown.

In junior high school, Hideki and the other students were asked to write essays about their aspirations. In his Nobel biography, Dr. Shirakawa recalled, “I wrote something about my wish to be a scientist in the future and to conduct research on plastics useful for ordinary people.”

His ambition was perhaps not surprising, as postwar Japan was then undergoing a boom in the production of products made from plastic — a sign of Japan's rapidly stepping into a more modern society.

Much to his surprise, the day after his Nobel win was announced, a copy of the essay he

Tichon Hadash, an elite high school. With her mother unable to cover the fees, Ada helped cover tuition by tutoring fellow students in math.

Following two years of mandatory military service, Ada returned to Jerusalem to earn a bachelor's degree in chemistry in 1962 and a master's degree in biophysics in 1964, both at the Hebrew University. In 1968, she received a doctorate at the Weizmann Institute in X-ray crystallography. She spent the next two years in postdoctoral positions at Massachusetts Institute of Technology and Carnegie Mellon University in Pittsburgh.

Her marriage to Moshe Yonath ended in divorce. They had a daughter, Hagith Yonath, who is a physician and medical director at Sheba Medical Center in Israel, and a granddaughter.

Dr. Yonath's lengthy ribosome quest began in 1970 when she established Israel's only protein crystallography laboratory at the Weizmann Institute. With funding low and skepticism from colleagues rising, she looked for support abroad.

In 1986, she began a 17-year collaboration with the famed Max-Planck Research Unit in Hamburg, Germany, where she ran a research unit for ribosomal structure in parallel to the ribosome research unit she headed at the Weizmann Institute.

This arrangement was facilitated by a long-term ribosome research collaboration with Heinz-Günter Wittmann of the Max Planck Institute for Molecular Genetics in Berlin. Wittmann helped Dr. Yonath secure funding in Germany. He also provided her access to a synchrotron — a large, circular particle accelerator that produces high-intensity X-ray beams required to determine the precise, complex, three-dimensional atomic structure of the ribosome.

From 1986 to 2004, Dr. Yonath commuted frequently between Germany and Israel to oversee both her research teams and manage the intensive efforts involved in ribosome crystallization, a process of over 25,000

painstaking experiments.

In the end, scientists were able to see exactly how the ribosome reads genetic code and links amino acids together to form proteins. The process, once abstract, became vividly concrete.

The significance of Dr. Yonath's work extended far beyond basic science. It had immediate and practical consequences for medicine — especially in the fight against infectious disease.

Many antibiotics work by binding to specific sites on a bacterium's ribosome and disrupting protein production, effectively killing the bacteria or stopping it from multiplying. The challenge, however, is that human cells also have ribosomes. A successful antibiotic must attack bacterial ribosomes without harming human ones.

Before Dr. Yonath's work, drug designers were operating partly in the dark. They knew that certain antibiotics were effective, but not precisely how they interacted with their targets. With detailed ribosome structures in hand, scientists could now see where antibiotics bind and how they interfere with protein synthesis.

This insight made it possible to design drugs more effectively. Researchers could modify existing antibiotics to make them more potent against resistant bacteria. They could also identify entirely new binding sites — new vulnerabilities in the bacterial machinery — and develop drugs to exploit them. In an era when antibiotic resistance threatens to outpace drug development, such advances have been crucial.

“Ribosomes are alive and kicking, and so am I,” Dr. Yonath said in her Nobel acceptance speech. She added with delight that her research stimulated “the imagination of many youngsters, including my granddaughter, Noa, who is showing continuous interest, and invited me at the ages of 5 and 13 to explain to her classes what the ribosome is.”



TSUGUFUMI MATSUMOTO/AP

Dr. Shirakawa, shown in 2000, discovered that plastics can conduct electricity.

be shared, and teams of people have to work side by side. “All of this has meant that uniqueness had to be suppressed.”

That characteristic was opposed to what is necessary to be successful in science, Dr. Shirakawa said in an interview with the Nobel Institute after the prize was announced. “A good scientist,” he said, “has to have a personality that is curious and asks, ‘Why?,’ and asks, ‘What happened?,’ and has an interest in everything.”

Jerry Stovall LSU football coach, All-America player

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Jerry Stovall, a former LSU football coach and an All-America player nicknamed “Mr. Everything,” died Aug. 31, the school said. He was 85.

LSU announced that Mr. Stovall died in Baton Rouge without disclosing a cause.

Mr. Stovall went 22-21-2 in four seasons with the Tigers, leading the team to an 8-3-1 record and an Orange Bowl appearance in 1982.

A West Monroe native, Mr. Stovall was a two-way standout for LSU from 1960-62. He finished his collegiate career with 1,081 rushing yards and 13

touchdowns.

Mr. Stovall earned All-America honors and was named the Southeastern Conference player of the year in 1962.

Mr. Stovall was selected by the St. Louis Cardinals with the No. 2 pick in the 1963 NFL draft. He played nine seasons in the league as a safety and punter, earning Pro Bowl honors three times.

Mr. Stovall later returned to Baton Rouge as an assistant under Charles McClendon. He was promoted to head coach after McClendon's replacement, Bo Rein, died in a plane crash in 1980.



HARRY HARRIS/ASSOCIATED PRESS/FILE/1967

Above, New York Giant Ernie Koy was brought down by Mr. Stovall, a St. Louis Cardinal, in New York. At right, LSU football players hoisted Mr. Stovall after their victory during an NCAA game in New Orleans.



BILL FEIG/ASSOCIATED PRESS/FILE/1983

The Boston Globe

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Interior courtyards, restaurants, and a museum

Inside Fidelity’s massive, newly renovated Seaport headquarters

By Jon Chesto
GLOBE STAFF

What a way to come back to the office.

Fidelity Investments employees will return on a full-time basis this week to the company’s new Boston headquarters for the first time since before the pandemic. They’ll be working — and wandering around — inside a building that must be unlike any other corporate office they’ve seen.

That’s because Pembroke, Fidelity’s real estate arm, just wrapped up a six-year-long renovation project at its massive Commonwealth Pier property in the Seaport. How massive? This century-old building, formerly known as the

Boston World Trade Center, is nearly 1,500 feet from end to end, much longer than the Hancock Tower (sorry, 200 Clarendon) is high.

Fidelity is announcing that this 840,000-square-foot building will be its official headquarters. It had been unclear when the company announced its new return-to-work policy in April whether the old headquarters, at 245 Summer St. next to South Station, would still be designated as such — or if the honor would go to the redesigned waterfront building with the harbor views and new ferry stop.

About 3,200 employees will report to 245 Summer now, compared with 2,100 at the pier complex/headquarters, and another 1,000 at an expanded location

at Seaport West, a Pembroke-managed office tower across from the pier. The new headquarters officially opened for employees last week, but most will begin working on-site this week.

For many employees, it’s not just a change in venue, but also a change in commuting days. Most Fidelity employees in Boston were required to be in the office for two full weeks out of every four, essentially 10 days a month. Now, they need to come into the office every week.

Fidelity and Pembroke reworked the former warehouse for freight trains and steamships into a bright and airy workspace with natural light — and mini-cafes — at nearly every turn. To ensure all

FIDELITY, Page D2



JASON O’REAR PHOTOGRAPHY LLC

Commonwealth Pier will offer a retail corridor along Seaport Boulevard, a historic headhouse, and the Harbor Plaza, which includes green spaces, a variety of seating areas, art, fire pits, Daily Provisions, and the Museum of American Finance.

Robot news assistants



PHOTO ILLUSTRATION BY LUIS G. RENDON/GLOBE STAFF; ADOBE AND HANDOUT

Former NBC 10 Boston reporter Eli Rosenberg has launched an AI-powered tool to help journalists find story ideas.

By Aidan Ryan
GLOBE STAFF

When NBC 10 Boston reporter Eli Rosenberg returned earlier this year after a dream assignment covering the Winter Olympics in Milan, he began experimenting with artificial intelligence and how it might help him find more stories.

Six months later, he’s leaving TV news altogether to transform his personal reporting tool into a new startup aimed at helping newsrooms identify local stories that no one else has. The tool, called Your Assignment Desk, uses AI to scrape dozens of public sources for information, then provides a list of possible story ideas and suggestions of who to interview.

TV
newsman’s
startup aims
to help local
stations use
AI to find
stories

“We’re not looking to replace journalists,” Rosenberg, 47, said. “We’re trying to make everyone’s life easier, and use a very powerful tool that the industry is fully embracing day-by-day to help.”

It’s unclear how much the tool will appeal to stations, which could decide to build their own internal tools to track public updates or may be skeptical of using AI as a reporting tool. But Rosenberg said he hasn’t found a comparable product, and hopes that his nearly 22-year career as a TV news reporter can help shape the inevitable evolution of how reporters and editors use AI in local news.

“The more that journalists can be involved in this process

AI NEWS, Page D3



SAMUEL CORUM/GETTY IMAGES

President Trump’s One Big Beautiful Bill Act cut funding for Medicaid, food assistance, and other social safety net programs.

STAT

Hospitals are plotting a long-shot push to roll back \$1 trillion in Medicaid cuts

By Daniel Payne
STAT

WASHINGTON — Hospital leaders, stung by the passage of a law that will cut nearly \$1 trillion in Medicaid funding over the next decade, have been racing to remake their systems.

And in Washington, some are building a long-shot plan to turn back the clock.

Hospital lobbyists and leaders have begun laying the groundwork to delay, roll back, or mitigate the unwelcome health care spending cuts used to help fund President Trump’s tax cut bill, ac-

cording to four people familiar with the efforts.

“They see an opening,” said one lobbyist hired by hospital systems of their clients. “I don’t know if I do.”

It’s a difficult target, with a potentially lengthy timeline. The cuts were passed as part of President Trump’s signature tax cut law, and even potential Democratic majorities would have to win the president’s approval to change them. It would also mean coming up with substantial money to pay for the changes — and possibly finding a handful of Republican lawmakers who are willing to undo one of their landmark

legislative achievements.

But health system leaders think they can harness the growing political power against the cuts — on full display as the midterms near, with Democrats believing they’re odious enough to voters to help swing an election.

They could start with small changes — carveouts, delays — while building momentum to a long-term goal worth waiting for: boosted funding should Democrats win the White House and Congress in 2028.

The efforts, according to the people involved in them, have remained vague

HOSPITALS, Page D3

TALKING POINTS

FOOD

TRUMP’S TACTICS TO LOWER BEEF PRICES AND APPEASE RANCHERS CAUSE BLOWBACK

The Trump administration has rolled out several programs intended to pacify consumers frustrated with high beef prices and ranchers angered by beef imports. Last Monday, Agriculture Secretary Brooke Rollins opened a “Ranchers First Initiative” to provide more financial certainty to ranchers who chose to invest in growing their cattle herds. The actions came days after President Trump said he was “authorizing legal documents” to allow farmers and ranchers to process their own food, a potential challenge to large meatpacking companies. The president’s announcement followed his signing of a proclamation in August that would allow 300,000 metric tons of lean beef trimmings to enter the United States at a reduced tariff rate over the next three months. That triggered immediate blowback from ranchers and even a number of congressional Republicans, concerned that foreign beef would eat at domestic profits. Beef imports this year are already up 13 percent from 2025, according to Agriculture Department data. Industry groups representing ranchers and meat processors said the moves could threaten food safety, and agricultural economists said they would cause chaos in the cattle market and do little to bring down the high cost of beef. A pound of ground beef cost \$6.89 on average in July, according to the Bureau of Labor Statistics, up 10 percent from a year earlier. With the midterm elections two months away, Trump is quickly trying to appease both consumers concerned with affordability and ranchers who form an important voting bloc that benefits from high cattle prices.

— NEW YORK TIMES

FINANCE

MORGAN STANLEY TAKES AIM AT X ACCOUNTS POSTING ITS RESEARCH

Morgan Stanley complained to X about posts on the social media site using the bank’s charts and research, leading to at least two accounts getting temporarily locked. The bank has filed Digital Millennium Copyright Act complaints citing at least 16 posts that offered screenshots from the bank’s research, according to a document shared with Bloomberg News by Ryan Detrick, chief market strategist at Carson Group Holdings LLC, and Nicholas Brown, a correspondent at Stock Trader Network, whose accounts were locked on Wednesday. Detrick said in an interview with Bloomberg that the post cited by X included a chart from a research report written by Mike Wilson, Morgan Stanley’s chief US equity strategist and chief investment officer. Like other bank research, many Morgan Stanley reports are sent to clients and not circulated publicly. Detrick, who has 222,400 followers on X, said he was puzzled because Morgan Stanley didn’t reach out to him directly about the post, which had been online since April and cited Wilson and the bank. Brown also published his post in April and gave credit to the bank. “If they had just reached out, I would’ve taken it down,” said Detrick, who has posted research and ideas from banks and other sources for years, and has not faced a similar situation in the past. The emails that Detrick and Brown received from X included the original request from Morgan Stanley, which claimed that the “copyrighted work is, in full or part (reports, graphs & charts), a proprietary Morgan Stanley Research Report.” The buzzing world of financial social media, or Fintwit, is filled with finance enthusiasts who post charts and research they see online, often leading to lively discussions on the market news of the day. Detrick said Morgan Stanley’s actions show that they don’t understand this is “just how the industry works.”

— BLOOMBERG NEWS

BOX OFFICE

‘SPIDER-MAN: BRAND NEW DAY’ MAKES IT 6 WEEKS IN A ROW AT NO. 1

“Spider-Man: Brand New Day” remained the No. 1 movie in theaters over the weekend, becoming just the second film this decade to top the box office for six straight weeks. Since the end of July, the Sony superhero movie has ruled over cinemas with rare dominance. The last release to enjoy such a long stretch leading the box office was 2022’s “Avatar: The Way of Water.” “Brand New Day,” the fourth standalone Spider-Man film starring Tom Holland, collected \$18 million over the weekend, according to studio estimates Sunday. Sony is forecasting \$23.3 million for the four-day holiday weekend. “Brand New Day” has grossed \$2.4 billion worldwide. Universal Pictures’ “The Odyssey,” as it has for much of the “Spider-Man” run, remained in second place. Christopher Nolan’s epic added \$13 million domestically over the weekend, bringing its global haul to \$1.63 billion. More than \$1 billion of that has come from overseas sales, making “The Odyssey” the first to achieve that international milestone since 2009’s “Avatar.” Both blockbusters — “Spider-Man: Brand New Day” and “The Odyssey” — helped lead Hollywood to its best summer since before the pandemic. Through Aug. 31, the domestic box office totaled \$4.6 billion for the season, according to Rentrak, an increase of 26.1 percent from 2025 and just shy of 2013’s record summer. On Sunday, Rentrak forecast that, including the Labor Day weekend, the summer will end up with \$4.759 billion, a whisker above the \$4.758 billion of summer 2013.

— ASSOCIATED PRESS

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US businesses pull out all stops to woo Canadians back

By Rio Yamat
ASSOCIATED PRESS

LAS VEGAS — Appeals from American tourism organizations seemed to be everywhere Josh Loewen looked over the last year. Billboards and banners proclaimed a state’s or city’s love for Canada. Online and social media ads offered special deals for travelers from north of the border.

As a Vancouver resident and marketing executive himself, Loewen said he understands the conciliatory overtures. The number of Canadians traveling to the United States plunged after President Trump returned to office with remarks about making Canada the 51st state. An acrimonious trade war between the two countries now is threatening to reinforce the informal boycott just as it appeared to be easing slightly.

“It’s such a big ask right now,” Loewen, 45, said of the US tourism industry’s attempts to woo Canadians like him back before a new president occupies the White House. “It’s just a wasted effort.”

Relations between the US and Canadian governments have deteriorated sharply since their trade negotiations collapsed last month. Trump imposed import taxes of up to 50 percent on a range of Canadian products. Canada’s government responded in kind. Trump ordered the US government to change the name of border-spanning Lake Ontario to “Lake America.” Canadian Prime Minister Mark Carney dismissed insults from members of Trump’s Cabinet as childish and undignified.

The bilateral rift has not stopped state and local tourism officials and popular destinations such as Graceland from trying to persuade Canadian visitors to return.

New York state launched a “NY Loves Canada” promotion this summer, offering discounts at hotels, restaurants, and attractions. Some downtown Las

Vegas hotels are treating the Canadian dollar as equivalent to the US dollar to give Canadian visitors more value for their money. Las Vegas tourism officials went to Canada last month to meet with travel advisers, tour operators, and airline representatives.

“We’re here to make sure you know that we care about Canada,” Steve Hill, president of the Las Vegas Convention and Visitors Authority, said while in Vancouver.

The outreach is happening at the national level, too. Brand USA, the US tourism industry’s marketing organization, is bringing its Travel Week trade-event series to Canada for the first time in October, expanding and rebranding an earlier program known as Canada Connect.

Travel to the US from Canada remains well below 2024 levels.

Canada traditionally sent more overnight international visitors to the United States than any other country. Amid last year’s consumer-led backlash, both same-day trips and longer stays nosedived. Canadian residents made 25 percent fewer return border crossings and spent about \$2.4 billion less on travel to the US in 2025 than they had the year before, according to Canada’s national statistical agency, Statistics Canada.

The retreat coincided with other headwinds, including a weaker Canadian dollar that made traveling to the US more expensive and rising prices for fares and hotels. Canadian air travel to the US started declining in September 2023, Statistics Canada data shows.

But the abrupt pullback in stateside travel that accompanied Trump’s second presidency and extended into this year signaled “a persistent shift away from the United States by Canadian residents in their travel preferences,” agency analysts said in a July report.



COURTESY OF PEMBROKE

The revitalization of the historic pier restored its original clerestory windows, bringing natural light deep into the center of the industrial floor plates. The site offers four interior courtyards, with a central walkway spine (called the Tradeway). Commonwealth Pier first opened in 1913.



COURTESY OF FELIX SPELLER

Fidelity workers will return full time to new headquarters

►FIDELITY
Continued from Page D1

that sunlight, the company broke up the building with four interior courtyards, as well as a fifth outdoor courtyard that’s open to the public, and replaced shabby exterior walls in many places with glass facades that extend up to three stories high.

The building was redesigned by Pembroke, with assistance from Schmidt Hammer Lassen, a Danish architectural firm. A Fidelity spokesperson describes it as “designed to foster collabo-

ration and innovation, while expanding public access and community space along Boston’s waterfront.”

Toward that end, Pembroke quadrupled the amount of public-facing retail spaces, adding new restaurants, and spruced up the forlorn Harbor Walk around the perimeter. Plus, to fulfill requirements under the city’s permitting requirements and the state’s Chapter 91 tidelands law, there’s a new home for the Museum of American Finance as well as a community meeting room.

It’s a far cry from the dark recesses of the former building, where Fidelity had many offices but also shared the complex with various convention-style spaces for outside organizations including the vast, windowless exhibition room known as Commonwealth Hall, now long gone.

Fidelity won’t say how much the company spent on the dramatic renovation, but construction projects of this magnitude easily run into the hundreds of millions of dollars.

Through it all, the century-

plus history of the site is visible. The exposed brick and stonework of the original headhouse remains, steel beams supporting the structure are now unveiled, and the original wooden roof decking was refurbished and exposed to the space below.

When Commonwealth Pier first opened in 1913 in what was then a busy industrial section of South Boston, the Globe described it as the largest pier in the country.

Over the 20th century, though, the demands for freight

use at the site ebbed, as ships docked instead at the nearby Conley Terminal to offload for truck transport, instead of trains. In the 1980s, developers envisioned carving up the building into a “computer mart,” nicknamed Boscom, to house tech companies. That plan didn’t work out. The pier reopened under Fidelity ownership instead as a “World Trade Center”: a back-office lair for Fidelity workers, but also with room to host other tenants and trade shows.

Fidelity executives took a big

bet on the future of what’s now called the Seaport, though it took decades for the area around Fidelity’s Seaport complex, which includes a hotel and two office towers, to take on its new shape. The trade center complex looked outdated among all the shiny new office buildings that sprung up on nearby parking lots in the past decade. Not anymore.

Jon Chesto can be reached at jon.chesto@globe.com. Follow him @jonchesto.

Tool latest in AI-powered disruption in media world

► **AI NEWS**
Continued from Page D1

when AI impacts journalism, I think the better we all are,” he said.

Rosenberg joins the growing list of TV journalists who in recent years have decided to leave local stations for something new. Surveys show that local TV is still among the most popular sources of local news, but it faces mounting competition from social media, podcasts, and upstart local digital outlets.

While many of Rosenberg’s former peers joined public relations firms, political campaigns, and real estate agencies, the former NBC reporter hopes to be part of what he sees as the future of news.

The name of the startup is a nod to the assignment desk, a critical part of any TV newsroom responsible for assembling a list of potential stories by making calls, reading through press releases, and listening to police scanners. Assignment editors build a list of potential stories and then meet with producers to assign them to reporters.

During a demo with the Globe, some of the AI-suggested pitches included covering a surge of abandoned vehicles in Boston, a State House bill to appoint special police officers in Somerville, and a Federal Aviation Administration ground delay at Logan Airport.

None of these are major scoops, and some ideas might not turn out to be news at all. But Rosenberg hopes that the tool can help identify some stories through publicly-accessible information in order to free up more time for assignment editors to chase tips and work the phones.

Rosenberg, who is so far the company’s only employee, built the tool using Anthropic’s chatbot Claude. At the core of the product is what he calls the “truth doctrine,” which he described as the guardrails that ensure any information delivered

to users is backed up by actual records such as police reports, meeting agendas, or court filings. This is a key part of the tool, as AI is known to make errors and hallucinate responses, something that Rosenberg experienced when he first started using AI.

“The truth doctrine is that brain,” he said. “It is everything that a journalist needs to know in terms of what makes a good story, what doesn’t, what does this story need to get verified so that it can go on air.”

‘You can put a lot more potential content onto the buffet line, but you really need someone who can sort through that.’

ED KEOHANE, *former morning producer at WCVB and CNN*

When users receive pitches, they get the primary sources that the information came from, a sample pitch, the types of people they could interview, and even a first draft of an on-air script for the story. It also flags specific details that still need to be confirmed by an actual reporter.

Ed Keohane, a former morning producer at WCVB and CNN who founded the health care media startup uplitMD, said that if the tool can actually help identify original stories, it could “supercharge the assignment desk.” But it’s crucial to keep actual journalists involved in the entire process.

“You can put a lot more potential content onto the buffet line, but you really need someone who can sort through that,” Keohane said.

As use of AI grows, so do con-

cerns about how it could disrupt an already struggling media industry.

Scripps, which owns more than 60 stations across the country, has done away with local anchors in at least 12 markets and replaced them in part with pre-recorded segments that are partially helped by AI.

Beyond replacing familiar faces, there are concerns about how reliable AI is when it comes to providing accurate news. Alan Miller, a former WHDH-TV (Channel 7) assignment manager and Globe video director, said there are real limitations to what an AI-driven platform can do.

“AI is not going to make phone calls for you,” he said, adding that a lot of helpful information comes from developing relationships with sources. “You’re not going to get that with an AI.”

Rosenberg stressed that Your Assignment Desk is meant to be a tool, not the final product. Users can’t copy and paste the script draft, for example, and actual journalists need to verify the information.

The tool can also be completely unique to each newsroom, including for stations in the same market. Rosenberg said that he can customize Your Assignment Desk to focus on different story topics that may appeal to different demographics.

Rosenberg has had conversations with journalists about the tool, but hasn’t yet signed on any clients, worked out a price, or taken any outside investments. (He declined to give an estimate on how much it has cost to build, but said it’s “considerable.”) He’s hoping to hire more staff to help with coding, finances, and marketing.

“I think I have a good game plan on how to grow it in the next couple of months that would welcome investment.”

Aidan Ryan can be reached at aidan.ryan@globe.com. Follow him @aidanfitzryan.

Health systems’ power fades across political spectrum

► **HOSPITALS**
Continued from Page D1

so far, and are focused on driving home how much the cuts will hurt health systems. Executives and lobbyists hope that message will create the opportunity for carveouts to the cuts, favorable tweaks to the legislation, or boosted payments from other parts of the federal health care enterprise.

Some lawmakers are listening.

Democrats have begun discussing how they would roll back cuts should they retake the Senate in November, Senator Tim Kaine, a Virginia Democrat, told STAT. The top Democrat on the Senate Finance Committee, Senator Ron Wyden of Oregon, included the rollback of GOP cuts and boosting coverage across the population among the priorities in a document seeking ideas for his party’s health care agenda.

One hospital-friendly Democratic leader — Senate minority leader Chuck Schumer of New York — pledged to give hospitals “a seat at the table” should they (and he) return to power.

“Exactly what we would do, what we would choose to roll back, and to what degree — we’re starting those conversations, but we don’t have any decisions made,” Kaine said in July. “I do know that there are some Republicans interested.”

Senator Josh Hawley, a Republican from Missouri, is among the Republicans interested despite having voted for the bill that created the cuts. Senators Lisa Murkowski of Alaska, Susan Collins of Maine, and Jerry Moran of Kansas each have a history of voicing concerns about the Medicaid cuts that were included in the law. Hawley introduced legislation last year that would repeal some of the reductions to state Medicaid funding and double the funding and timeline for the Rural Health Transformation Fund.

“I’m hoping that I’ll be able to convince my colleagues a little

closer to the implementation date: ‘Listen, we shouldn’t do this,’” he told STAT. “In fact, we should be funding rural hospitals directly, and we shouldn’t be messing around with these programs.”

The high-stakes battle over the future of Medicaid and insurance subsidies will not only determine the financial sustainability of health providers — it could also determine the political viability of some candidates and health providers’ business-as-usual approaches to Washington.

The push comes as many health systems nationwide are remaking how they deliver — and pay for — care: considering major mergers, new revenue sources, artificial intelligence implementation, or cuts to services or facilities.

Hawley thinks he can persuade colleagues to change parts of the bill they championed, and he said he and his colleagues particularly focused on rural hospitals have been successful before: delaying implementation deadlines for the cuts and creating the rural health funding in the law.

A few providers told STAT they have faith a rollback is on the way, holding out on overhauling their systems while anticipating a fix.

Others aren’t so sure. “I’ve certainly heard bipartisan talk about: ‘We’ve got to do something,’” said James Jarvis, president of the Maine Medical Association. “Unfortunately, I think it’s going to take a catastrophe.”

The political salience of the cuts to health care is undeniable.

In May 2025, a Democratic Congressional Campaign Committee memo declared the issue would be “the defining contrast of the 2026 election cycle.”

Democrats tested integrating the cuts into their affordability messaging in off-cycle races that year, pointing out the looming pain of rising insurance costs and coverage losses because of

Medicaid rollbacks. Success in those campaigns is likely to encourage that approach across the midterm campaigns this fall.

So far this cycle, Democrats have spent nearly \$15 million on political advertising specifically mentioning health care cuts, according to an analysis from Punchbowl News and AdImpact. Meanwhile, Republicans have largely tried to shift attention elsewhere, recognizing that even a boost from lowering tax bills may not outweigh the unpopularity of the cuts.

Lawmakers and their staffs have been hearing from hospital leaders constantly about their fears about the implementation of the cuts.

“All of the political capital that I and my colleagues extend every day with our members of Congress will be wholly and fully focused on delaying that and mitigating that,” said Lisa Harvey-McPherson, vice president of government relations at Northern Light Health in Maine.

Those kinds of calls ordinarily would have real sway: Hospitals are often major employers in a district, and voters have traditionally been thought to like their hospitals more than other parts of the health system, from insurers to pharmaceutical companies.

But that power has greatly deteriorated. Before the Medicaid cuts passed, a huge lobbying campaign to spare hospitals didn’t stop the law — and the cuts in some ways became more severe as lobbyists pressed lawmakers to reel them back. A year after the stinging loss, some hospital leaders still feel uncertain about how to break through in the current environment, several people involved in their lobbying efforts said.

STAT’s coverage of health inequities is supported by a grant from the Commonwealth Fund. Our financial supporters are not involved in any decisions about our journalism.

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The Boston Globe

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The City of Boston, acting by the PUBLIC WORKS DEPARTMENT, 400 FRONTAGE ROAD, BOSTON, MA 02118, herein-after referred to as the Awarding Authority, hereby invites sealed bids for the project listed above.

Bids will be solicited from interested vendors through the City of Boston’s Supplier Portal: boston.gov/departments/procurement.

All bids for this project are subject to all applicable provisions of law and in accordance with the terms and provisions of the contract documents entitled: BRIDGES SNOW REMOVAL & SALTING SERVICES ON AN AS-NEEDED BASIS.

Bids must be submitted before 11:00 A.M., Boston time, THURSDAY, SEPTEMBER 24, 2026 and opened forthwith.

The IFB documents will be available on or about MONDAY, SEPTEMBER 7, 2026 after 9:00 A.M., Boston time.

The scope of work is detailed in the bid package. This project is exempt from M.G.L. c. 30, pursuant to c. 30B, s. 1 (b) (17). General Bids must be accompanied by a 5% Bid Bond.

CHRISTOPHER OSGOOD, INTERIM CHIEF OF STREETS
(SEPTEMBER 7, SEPTEMBER 14, 2026)

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UNIVERSAL CROSSWORD PUZZLE

ON THE RIGHT FOOT BY JOE MARQUEZ | EDITED BY DAVID STEINBERG

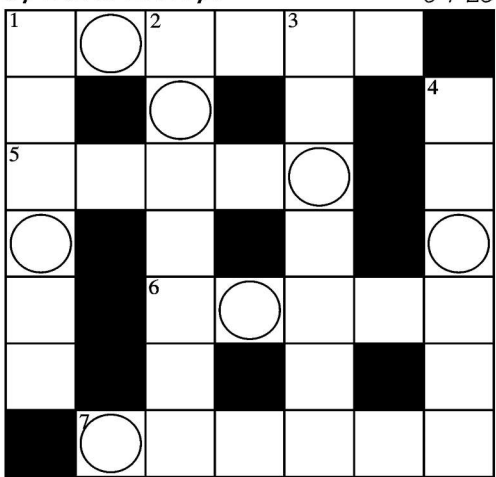
- ACROSS**
- 1 Noodle dish with a shio variety
6 Buddy
10 Safari beast
13 Battle site to remember
14 Pickling liquid
15 Grain in a yogurt bowl
16 Tallest accessible structure in Missouri
18 Life phase, in slang
19 Word before "research" or "friendly"
20 One who defies social norms
21 Per person
22 Site of a sleeve tattoo
24 Provokes
26 51-Across predecessor
31 Marker that's dry when not in use?
32 Intoxicating
33 Fish often cooked meuniere
37 Ctrl-___-Del
38 ___ out (scooping water from)
40 Award recognition, for short
41 It isn't played off the grid!
43 Calculus calculation
45 Help in a puzzle hunt
46 Makes more tempting, as a deal
48 "For real!"
50 People often subscribe to see fewer of them
51 2001 Apple debut

- 52 One of two won by "KPop Demon Hunters"
56 Letter before Bravo
60 Jacuzzi nozzle
61 Actress portrayed by Nicole Kidman in "Being the Ricardos"
63 "You ___ so busted!"
64 Banded stone
65 ___ buddies
66 Some college degs.
67 (Gasp!)
68 Storage units
- DOWN**
- 1 Meaty pasta sauce
2 "So sad ..."
3 Game-ending chess move
4 Green Minecraft gem
5 "Both Sides, ___" (Joni Mitchell song)
6 "Imitation" meat
7 Bring aboard
8 Aunt May's husband, in "Spider-Man"
9 So-so
10 "I'm still new to this"
11 DEA agent
12 Like the Osmonds, geographically
14 Competitive event pass?
17 Troop group
21 Obstacles in group projects
23 Popular sunglasses
25 Made a bubbling sound
26 Convo
27 Hero's home?
28 Documentation of a video game update



JUMBLE CROSSWORDS™

by David L. Hoyt 9-7-26



- CLUE**
1. Brief rainfall
5. Sun-dried brick
6. ___ boom
7. Denver ___
- ANSWER**
- HWR SOE
EAD BO
NCSO
LEOTEM

- CLUE**
1. Not likely to change
2. Nocturnal marsupial
3. Without end
4. Lynx relative
- ANSWER**
- ETLBAS
PUOSOMS
NELTERA
BTOABC

CLUE: He has four stars on the Hollywood Walk of Fame.

BONUS

How to play Complete the crossword puzzle by looking at the clues and unscrambling the answers. When the puzzle is complete, unscramble the circled letters to solve the BONUS.

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ANSWERS: 1A-Shower 2D-Opium 3P-Boom 4B-Bomb 5A-Adob 6A-Bonic 7A-Omelet 1D-Subtle 2D-Opium 3P-Boom 4B-Bomb 5A-Adob 6A-Bonic 7A-Omelet
Send comments to DLHoyt@HoytInteractiveMedia.com

Boston's forecast

TODAY

6 A.M. NOON 6 P.M.

HIGH 77-82

Sunny and pleasant; best day of the holiday weekend. Winds NW 8-16 mph. Clear to partly cloudy tonight. Winds W 7-14 mph.

TUESDAY

6 A.M. NOON 6 P.M.

HIGH 78-83

Sunny to partly cloudy. Winds NW 7-14 mph. Partly cloudy at night. Winds N 6-12 mph.

WEDNESDAY

6 A.M. NOON 6 P.M.

HIGH 74-79

Cloudy. Winds SSE 7-14 mph. Overcast and breezy at night with a shower possible late. Winds SW 10-20 mph.

THURSDAY

6 A.M. NOON 6 P.M.

HIGH 81-86

Sun, then cloudy with a thunderstorm; breezy. Winds W 10-20 mph. Mostly cloudy at night. Winds W 7-14 mph.

FRIDAY

6 A.M. NOON 6 P.M.

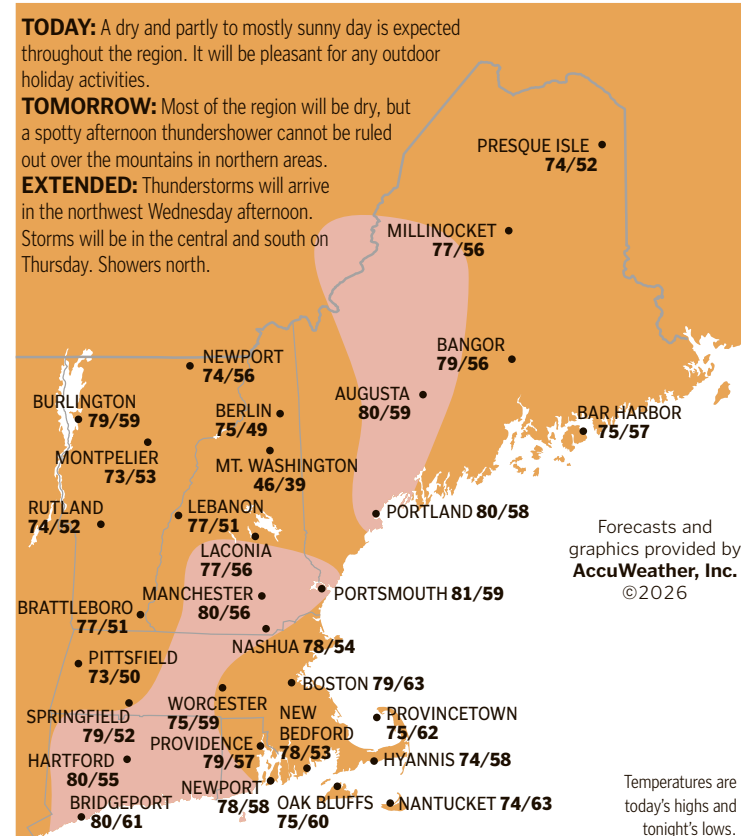
HIGH 72-77

Partly sunny, pleasant and less humid. Winds WNW 8-16 mph. Mainly clear at night. Winds NW 6-12 mph.

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New England



Cities

Forecast high and low temperatures and conditions				Legend: ● Travel delays possible, C Clouds, F Fog, H Haze, I Ice, Pc Partly Cloudy, R Rain, Sh Showers, S Sun, Sn Snow, Fl Flurries, T Thunderstorms, W Windy			
Today		Tomorrow		Today		Tomorrow	
● Atlanta	85/71 T	87/74 Pc		Los Angeles	92/75 Pc	94/77 Pc	
Atlantic City	79/56 S	83/63 S		● Miami	92/78 T	90/80 T	
Charlotte	79/65 C	84/67 Pc		● New Orleans	94/78 T	91/78 T	
Chicago	80/65 Pc	86/73 S		New York City	79/63 S	82/66 S	
Dallas	100/81 S	101/80 S		Philadelphia	81/62 S	84/68 S	
● Denver	90/62 T	86/57 T		Phoenix	106/86 Pc	109/88 S	
Detroit	77/60 Pc	80/68 Pc		Salt Lake City	74/57 Pc	81/59 S	
● Fort Myers	92/77 T	92/75 T		San Francisco	77/57 S	81/64 S	

Almanac

Yesterday's high/low	68°/59°
Sunrise today	6:16 a.m.
Sunset today	7:08 p.m.
Moonrise today	1:43 a.m.
Mount Washington (5 p.m. yesterday)	
Weather	Dense fog
Visibility	1/16 of a mile
Wind	north-northwest at 30 m.p.h.
High/low temperature	39/36
Snow depth at 5 p.m.	0.0"

24 Hr. Precipitation

Yesterday	0.11"	Month to date	0.83"	Year to date	18.42"
Precip days in September	4	Norm. month to date	0.64"	Norm. year to date	28.68"

Climate data are compiled from National Weather Service records and are subject to change or correction.					
Tides	A.M.	P.M.	High tides	A.M.	P.M.
Boston high	8:20	8:37	Gloucester	8:27	8:46
Height	8.9	10.4	Marblehead	8:20	8:37
Boston low	2:05	2:18	Lynn	8:23	8:40
Height	0.4	1.2	Scituate	8:29	8:49
High tides			Plymouth	8:31	8:54
Old Orchard ME	8:14	8:32	Cape Cod		
Hampton			Canal East	8:18	8:38
Beach NH	8:28	8:46	Cape Cod		
Plum Island	8:40	9:00	Canal West	7:17	
Ipswich	8:16	8:32	Falmouth	8:04	8:21

New England marine forecast

	Wind	Seas	Temp		Wind	Seas	Temp
Boston Harbor	NW 7-14 kts.	1-3 ft.	79/63	Martha's Vineyard	NW 7-14 kts.	1-2 ft.	75/55
East Cape				Nantucket	NW 8-16 kts.	1-3 ft.	74/63
Cod Canal	NW 7-14 kts.	1-3 ft.	75/57	Provincetown	NW 7-14 kts.	1-3 ft.	75/62
Buzzards Bay	NW 6-12 kts.	1-2 ft.	76/56				

For current Charles River Basin water quality, call (781) 788-0007 or go to http://www.charlesriver.org.			
Today		Tomorrow	
Jerusalem	87/71 S	88/69 S	
London	76/57 C	70/52 Pc	
● Moscow	54/45 Sh	60/43 Pc	
● Paris	82/62 Sh	71/56 Sh	
Rome	88/69 S	88/71 S	
● San Juan	92/80 T	92/79 Sh	
Stockholm	61/55 C	64/51 Sh	
● Tokyo	81/78 R	86/80 Pc	

HOROSCOPES

HAPPY BIRTHDAY for Monday, Sept. 7, 2026: You're energetic, independent, and ambitious. You're tenacious about pursuing your goals. This year will bring benefits from all your hard work. Expect power and leadership. It's time for major decisions and accomplishments. You'll be busy. Seize opportunities and deal with them. Awards, kudos, and acknowledgment are yours.

ARIES (March 21-April 19)

Hang in there. As this day progresses, it becomes more light-hearted and fun-loving. Admittedly, power struggles with a friend or a member of a group might squelch things. Be patient with kids. Basically, this is a friendly and productive day. Tonight: Be playful. **TAURUS (April 20-May 20)** Home and family are your focus today, and you will be wise to avoid power struggles with parents and older family members. Instead, seek out supportive, gentle interactions with others, and all will be well. Enjoy the company of children. Enjoy socializing. You're in the mood to teach. To-

night: Relax at home.

GEMINI (May 21-June 20)

Like Taurus, home and family are a strong focus for you. Family discussions and home repairs will take place. Be very clear in all your communications with others. Don't be demanding. Take a gentle approach. (You catch more flies with honey than with vinegar.) Tonight: Friendly discussions. **CANCER (June 21-July 22)** The secret to this day is to surround yourself with kind, gentle, supportive people. Avoid ego battles about money and possessions, because you won't like it. However, with Mars in your sign, you can take care of yourself. Seek out people you like today! Entertain at home. Tonight: Check your money. **LEO (July 23-Aug. 22)** After the Moon moves into your sign, things will tend to go your way if you align yourself with friendly, caring people. Avoid power struggles with partners, spouses, and friends. You don't need this angst. Discussions about money, cash flow, and earnings are on the table. Tonight: You win! **VIRGO (Aug. 23-Sept. 22)** Protect yourself today by avoiding emotional vampires and peo-

ple who bring you down. You don't need this, especially today. On the other hand, you have a strong need to talk to someone so you can share your ideas. Find a sympathetic ear. (It's out there.) Tonight: Enjoy solitude. **LIBRA (Sept. 23-Oct. 22)** Today is a mixed bag when it comes to dealing with friends, members of groups, and organizations. You might bump into power-hungry people who are too aggressive and off-putting. Or you might be lucky enough to find agreeable, sympathetic friends. That's your best choice. Tonight: Be friendly. **SCORPIO (Oct. 23-Nov. 21)** Steer clear of power struggles with parents and authority figures today, which could arise. Ironically, a boss or authority figure might be sympathetic to you at work or with issues related to your health or a pet. (Go figure.) Tonight: You're admired. **SAGITTARIUS (Nov. 22-Dec. 21)** This is a terrible day to get involved in controversial discussions about politics, religion, or racial issues. Don't do it. Instead, explore romantic connections, playful times with kids, socializing and the arts. Let your imagi-

nation soar! Tonight: Explore and learn. **CAPRICORN (Dec. 22-Jan. 19)** Tread carefully with financial discussions today or talks about mortgages, loans, or shared property, because you could reach an impasse with someone. However, a family member might be helpful if you are sensitive and receptive. That choice is a no-brainer. Tonight: Check your finances. **AQUARIUS (Jan. 20-Feb. 18)** Be your own best friend today and surround yourself with people who are friendly and supportive. Avoid people who are difficult — it's that simple. Explore ideas that require imagination and a sympathetic resonance with your surroundings. Tonight: Listen and cooperate. **PISCES (Feb. 19-March 20)** Work-related issues, as well as anything to do with your health or a pet, could be challenging today. However, if you choose to be with generous, thoughtful people, it will be a whole different story. It's all about who you surround yourself with. Be discerning. Tonight: Get organized.

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SUDOKU

				6		2		
	3	9			8	6		4
	5			1	4			9
1		3						
	7						3	
						4		6
7				1	3		6	
3		4	2			1	8	
		1		5				

Fill in the grid so that every row, every column, and every 3X3 box contains the digits 1 through 9. Puzzle difficulty levels: Easy on Monday and Tuesday, more difficult on Wednesday and Thursday, most difficult on Friday and Saturday. Tips and computer program at www.sudoku.com.

DAILY BRIDGE CLUB

BY FRANK STEWART

South dealer — E-W vulnerable

North

♠ K 2
♥ 7 3
♦ A J 9 7
♣ 10 9 8 5 3

East

♠ A Q 10 8 4
♥ A Q 10
♦ 5 3
♣ Q 7 4

South

♠ 6 3
♥ K 9 6 5 2
♦ K Q 10 8 6 2
♣ None

South	West	North	East
Pass	Pass	Pass	1 ♠
2 ♦	4 ♣	4 ♦	4 ♣
5 ♦	Pass	Pass	Dbl
All Pass			

Opening lead — ♠ K

"That Millard is a sweet guy," a player said to me in the club lounge, "but if he has both oars in the water, they're on the same side of his boat."

Millard Pringle tends to get lost in the maze of defensive "rules." He was today's East in a penny game. West's passed-hand jump to four clubs logically implied spade support. Against five diamonds doubled, West led the king of clubs, and declarer ruffed, drew trumps and led a heart from dummy.

"Millard huddled," my friend said. "He couldn't recall whether the rule was 'second hand low' or 'second hand high.' Finally, he compromised: He played 'second hand middle' with the queen."

"South's king won, but when he led another heart, West put up the jack and led a spade, and Millard took two spades. Down one."

South makes the contract if Millard plays the ace or ten on the first heart. If he plays the ten, he must win the next heart, and then South sets up the hearts to discard dummy's spades and ends with 11 tricks.

DAILY QUESTION You hold: ♠ K 2 ♥ 7 3 ♦ A J 9 7 ♣ 10 9 8 5 3. Your partner opens one spade, you respond 1NT, he bids two hearts and you return to two spades. Partner next bids three diamonds. What do you say?

ANSWER: Partner is trying for game despite your weak two-spade preference, His three diamonds improves your hand. You have three useful honors and no club "waste" opposite his shortness. Bid four diamonds or four spades.

ZIPPY "Human Emulsion" by Bill Griffith



BIZARRO by Wayno & Piraro



MOTHER GOOSE & GRIMM by Mike Peters



ADAM@HOME by Rob Harrell



ROSE IS ROSE by Pat Brady & Don Wimmer



Today's Crossword Solution

S	E	I	A	B		A	W	H	O		S	V	B			
M	O	S	O	B		E	I	V	G	V		E	R	V		
T	T	A	B	E		T	I	C	O		T	E	I			
A	F	T	V			R	A	C	S	O		D	O	I		
					S	D	V			L	S	E	N	O	H	
S	N	E	I	E	M	S		L	N	I	H					
T	I	W	I	T		E	O	L	C	O	V	L	C	I	L	
M	O	N			E	N	I	T	I	V	B		L	T	V	
E		L	O	S	R	E	V	A	O	D		A	D	V	E	H
			A	O	N	B		R	E	A	V	T	D	D	O	
N	O	S														
H	C	V	E		T	E	B	E	R		R	E	S	S	N	
V	R	E			H	O	R	V	A	V	M	E	L	V	G	
T	V	O			E	N	I	R	B		O	W	A	T	V	
U	N	G			M	U	C			N		A	M	E		

Today's Sudoku Solution

3	4	7	9	5	8	1	2	6
5	8	1	7	6	2	4	9	3
2	9	6	3	1	4	5	8	7
9	2	4	1	3	7	8	6	5
1	3	5	4	8	6	2	7	9
7	6	8	5	2	9	3	4	1
6	7	3	2	4	1	9	5	8
4	1	9	8	7	5	6	3	2
8	5	2	6	9	3	7	1	4

TV CRITIC'S CORNER

BY LISA WEIDENFELD



APPLE TV

Patrick Brammall in “Last Seen,” out Wednesday on Apple TV.

‘Last Seen,’ the return of ‘The Paper,’ and more new and streaming TV

Animated comedy “**DANGI!**” premieres Tuesday on Netflix. Co-dependent siblings Eunice (Poppy Liu) and Andrew (Andrew Law) are startled when their overachieving older sister Ruthie (Stephanie Hsu) shows up in New York, pregnant and having left her husband, who's not the father of the baby.

Stavros Halkias appeared in “Tony” this summer as one of the cooks in the Provincetown kitchen where a young Anthony Bourdain begins to find his way as a chef. But he's still best known as a podcast host and comedian, and drops the special “**Stavros Halkias: Uncle Stav**” Tuesday on Netflix.

The Australian actor Patrick Brammall has been popping up in quite a few things in recent years: If you didn't catch his charming rom-com “Colin from Accounts” alongside real-life partner Harriet Dyer, you might have seen him as the ill-

fated husband on “Evil” or as Anne Hathaway's architect boyfriend in “The Devil Wears Prada 2.” Now he takes the lead on the Australian thriller “**Last Seen**,” out Wednesday on Apple TV. Here, he's a dispatcher who becomes convinced that an agitated teen who calls in is his long-lost daughter.

The second season of “**The Paper**,” a spinoff of “The Office” that takes place at a struggling newspaper in Toledo, Ohio, comes to Peacock on Wednesday. Domhnall Gleeson stars as Ned, the idealistic editor in chief who imagines returning the publication to its glory days, and who tries to rally his staff of half-interested workers to join him. Season 1 saw the crew winning awards for their nascent attempts at serious journalism; season 2 sees them trying to figure out what's next, while Ned figures out what comes next in his burgeoning relationship with star reporter Mare (Anderson native Chelsea Frei).

Lisa Weidenfeld can be reached at lisa.weidenfeld@globe.com. Follow her on X @LisaWeidenfeld and Instagram @lisaweidenfeld.

ASKING ERIC

Congregant finds pastor on dating app

Q. I saw my pastor on a dating app. This is mostly fine, because he is single and hasn't taken a vow of chastity (that I know of). He even said in his profile that he leads a faith community.

We matched and I messaged something silly. I guess he didn't remember who I was because he messaged back and we got to talking. I was curious and a little nosy so I didn't tell him that I knew him from the real world. To be fair, I only go to church sporadically and I can't recall us ever talking. That's part of why I was curious about his “dating app personality.”

We've messaged on and off a few times. Nothing inappropriate. But now he wants to go on an actual date, and I don't know what to do. I can't tell him now, can I?

LOVE IN THE PEWS

A. Indeed, you can tell him now and you should.

It would be responsible of him, to say the least, to studiously avoid relationships with congregants, so if you do consider yourself a congregant, even sporadically, you need to let him know. Failing to do so could put his job at risk and imperils the success of any relationship you might have together.

It's also important to begin any potential relationship with as much integrity as possible. You don't have to tell people on dating apps every detail of your life, of course. (In fact, you absolutely should not.) But because you have a pre-existing connection, one that comes with healthy boundaries, it's better to be forthcoming.

There's nothing wrong with being curious about what you see on dating apps. But when you purposefully withhold information that might change the interaction, it starts to cross the line.

Q. What's your advice when someone asks you to donate to a charity you do not believe in supporting? This happened to me many years ago, but I'm still at a loss of what I should have done versus what I did do.

I refused and offered to donate to something else. My mother-in-law, the honoree, was not at all pleased with me. What's your advice in this situation?

HAPPY TO DONATE TO SOMETHING I BELIEVE IN

A. It's OK to keep your checkbook closed rather than starting a conflict.

If the organization or cause is really abhorrent to you (rather than simply something you wouldn't normally support), you also might consider giving money to the celebrant directly or

choosing to forgo a money gift at all in favor of a card and/or a meaningful item.

While it's important to stand up for what one believes, this kind of gift request doesn't seem like an area that warrants a lot of debate. Ultimately, when a celebrant asks that guests donate to a charity in lieu of gifts, they're stating a preference. While they'd like for you to honor their preference, side-stepping the request but still showing up or sending congratulations accomplishes the larger goal — honoring their achievement.

Q. During a recent visit, my brother revealed that he has intentionally distanced himself and cut off communication with me because I have chosen not to have a relationship with our half-sister. While he maintains a relationship with her, I have made a personal choice not to, and he is now treating me differently as a result.

I would appreciate hearing your thoughts on my brother's decision to distance himself based on my choice regarding our half-sister.

CUT-OFF SISTER

A. You can't control your brother's behavior, unfortunately.

While it's not clear from your letter why you've chosen to cut off contact with your half-sister nor why he's taken this decision personally, it is clear that he believes that your choice is incompatible with his life right now. That is his right, though it may be painful to you.

A helpful next step might be to ask him for more information, presuming you don't already have it. Does he feel you're being unfair or cruel? Does he think this reflects poorly on your character? Does he wish for a different solution for all of you? And what do you want? Would you be happy to have a relationship with him but not with her?

Finding out more about what he thinks will then empower you to have a conversation about what you can both do to solve this difference of opinion. His answer may be that you need to connect with your half-sister. That may be a deal-breaker for you.

I'm not saying that either of you has to compromise. But simply ceasing contact doesn't get to the root of the issue. If you want anything to change in this situation, you have to talk about it.

R. Eric Thomas can be reached at eric@askingeric.com.

Monday September 7, 2026

Movies Sports

	7 pm	7:30	8 pm	8:30	9 pm	9:30	10 pm	10:30	11 pm	11:30
2	WGBH PBS BBC News	R. Steves	Antiques "Vintage Indianapolis"	Antiques "Vintage San Diego"	POV "Remake" Ross McElwee reflects on the bond between him and his son. (N)					
4	WBZ CBS Wheel of Fortune	Jeopardy!	America's Tailgate on CBS (N)		FBI "3 Up, 3 Down"	News (N)	(:35) Comics			
5	WCVB ABC News (N)	Chronicle	Jeopardy! Masters	Jeopardy! Masters "Semifinals 1 & 2"	Jeopardy! Masters "Semifinals 3 & 4"	NewsCenter 5 (N)	(:35) J. Kimmel			
6	WLNE ABC Videos		Whose	Whose	Whose	Whose	Saturday Night Live	Saturday Night Live		
7	WHDH Inside (N)	Extra (N)	Family Feud	Family Feud	7 News at 9PM (N)	7 News at 10PM (N)	7 News at 11PM (N)	Inside		
9	WMUR ABC Chronicle	News (N)	Jeopardy! Masters	Jeopardy! Masters	Jeopardy! Masters	News	J.Kimmel			
10	NBC Boston Boston News (N)	Hollywood	MLB Baseball St. Louis Cardinals at San Francisco Giants From Oracle Park in San Francisco. (N) (Live)			Boston News (N)	(:35) J. Fallon			
10	WJAR NBC Debate		MLB Baseball St. Louis Cardinals at San Francisco Giants From Oracle Park in San Francisco. (N) (Live)			News (N)	(:35) J. Fallon			
11	WENH PBS Week-ends	Rosendo	Antiques "Vintage Indianapolis"	Antiques "Vintage San Diego"	POV "Remake" Ross McElwee reflects on the bond between him and his son. (N)					
12	WPRI CBS Wheel of Fortune	Jeopardy!	America's Tailgate on CBS (N)		FBI "3 Up, 3 Down"	12 News at 11 (N)	(:35) Comics			
25	WFXT FOX ET (N)	TMZ (N) (SP)	Beat Shazam "I Need a Hero!; Beat Shazam's 100th Episode!" (N) (SF)		Boston 25 News at 10PM (N) (Live)	News (N)	(:35) News (N)			
27	WUNI Rosa "Mi corazón es un nido" (N)		Tan cerca de ti, nace el amor (N)	Tierra de amor y coraje (N) (P)	Corazón "Abusos de poder" (N)	Noticias Univisión	(:35) Noticiero			
36	WSBE PBS R. Steves	Week-ends	Nature	Martin Clunes: Islands of America	TURN: Washington's Spies		PBS News Hour			
38	WSBK Big Bang	Big Bang	WBZ News 8p (N)	Patriots	Friends	Perfect	Perfect	Flip Side	Flip Side	
44	WGBX PBS Test Kitchen	Antiques	Midsomer "The Green Man: Part 1"	Inspector George Gently "Gently Liberated"		Antiques	PBS News Hour (N)			
50	WWJE How Not to		How Not to	How Not to	How Not to		How Not to			
56	WLVI CW Young Sheldon	Young Sheldon	All Amer "All That I Got Is You" (N)	Penn "Alyson's Smart Ass"	7 News at 10PM on CW56 (N)	Modern Family	Modern Family			
64	WNAC FOX Family Feud	Family Feud	Beat Shazam "I Need a Hero!; Beat Shazam's 100th Episode!" (N) (SF)		12 News on Fox Pr (N)	Seinfeld	Seinfeld			
68	WBXP ION S.W.A.T. "Vagabundo"		S.W.A.T. "Madrugada"	S.W.A.T. "Guacaine"	S.W.A.T. "Twenty Squad"		S.W.A.T. "Life"			

PREMIUM CABLE

Cinemax	(6:05) I Love Yo...	(:35) Birds of Prey (and the Fantabulous Emancipation of One Harley Quinn)	(:25) ★★ Joker ('19) Robert De Niro, Zazie Beetz, Joaquin Phoenix.	Joker: Folie à D...
Flix	(5:55) ★★ Marathon Man ('76)	★★★★ The Untouchables ('87) Sean Connery, Robert De Niro, Kevin Costner.	★★★ Match Point ('05) Jonathan Rhys-Meyers, Scarlett Johansson.	
HBO	(5:15) ★★ Dune: Part Two ('24)	Lanterns	(:40) ★★ Gran Turismo ('23) Orlando Bloom, Archie Madekwe, David Harbour.	
HBO 2	(6:00) Zombiel...	(:25) ★★ Zombieland: Double Tap ('19) Woody Harrelson. (P)	(:05) To Be Announced	(:45) Lanterns (:35) Monsters
Paramount-Sho	(6:00) ★★ Patriot Games ('92)	Lioness (N)	★★★ Argo ('12) Bryan Cranston, Alan Arkin, Ben Affleck.	★★★ True Grit ('10) Jeff Bridges.
Showtime 2	(6:30) ★★ Carriers ('09)	★★ Homestead ('24) Dawn Olivieri, Bailey Chase.	★★★ Dunkirk ('17) Fionn Whitehead.	(:50) Termina...
Starz!	(6:05) Resurrection Road ('25)	(:10) Fightland	(:05) ★★ The Italian Job ('03) Charlize Theron, Ed Norton, Mark Wahlberg.	★★ Non-Stop ('14) Liam Neeson.
TMC	(6:00) Not Without Hope ('25)	Old Guy ('24) Lucy Liu, Cooper Hoffman, Christoph Waltz.	(:35) ★★ No Country for Old Men ('07) Javier Bardem, Tommy Lee Jones.	(:40) The Machinist

SPORTS

CBSSN	Course Record With Michael Breed (N)	Golf (N)	Club Life	My World With (N)	Poker Night (N)	Athletes Unlimited Pro Softball
ESPN	Count-down (N)	College Football SMU at Florida State (N) (Live)			SportsCenter (N)	SportCtr (N) (Live)
ESPN2	2026 US Open Tennis Men's & Women's Round of 16 From the USTA Billie Jean King National Tennis Center in Flushing, N.Y. (N) (Live)					
Fox Sports 1	(6:30) IndyCar Racing Indycar Grand Prix of Monterey	NHRA Drag Racing U.S. Nationals, Finals From Indianapolis.				SPEED With (N)
Golf	(4:30) Col. Central	Golf (N)	PGA (N)	College Golf Folds of Honor Collegiate, First Round		
NBA	Stories	Stories		The Association Summer Special		
NBC Sports	Early Edition	Best of Felger & Mazz	Best of Zolak and Bertrand	Boston Sports (N) (Live)	Boston Sports	
NESN	(5:30) Ch..	Red Sox	MLB Baseball	Chat (N)	The Varsity (N)	

FAMILY

Cartoon	Burgers	Burgers	Burgers	FamilyGuy	FamilyGuy	FamilyGuy	FamilyGuy	FamilyGuy	RickMorty	RickMorty
Disney	Descendants: Wicked Wonderland ('26)			(:45) Camp Rock 3 ('26) Jonas Brothers, Francis Burgos, Malachi Barton.		Big City Greens	Big City Greens	Big City Greens	Big City Greens	Big City Greens
Encore Family	(6:25) Imagine That	(:15) Red Dog: True Blue ('16)	(:45) Finn on the Fly ('08)							Movie
Nickelodeon	★★★ Harry Potter and the Sorcerer's Stone ('01) Daniel Radcliffe.			Big Bang	Big Bang	Big Bang	Big Bang	Big Bang	Big Bang	Big Bang
Nick Jr.	PAWPatr..	PAWPatr..	PAWPatr..	PAWPatr..	Peppa Pig	Peppa Pig	Peppa Pig	Peppa Pig	PAWPatr..	PAWPatr..

Content Ratings: TV-Y Appropriate for all children; TV-Y7 For children age 7 and older; TV-G General audience; TV-PG Parental guidance suggested; TV-14 May be unsuitable for children under 14;

TV-MA Mature audience only Additional symbols: D Suggestive dialogue; FV Fantasy violence; L Strong language; S Sexual activity; V Violence; HD High-Definition; (CC) Close-Captioned